

IN BRIEF

NCLT rejects plea of Jet Airways seeking ₹500 cr from Boeing

The National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) has dismissed the plea of grounded air carrier Jet Airways’ liquidator seeking a refund of ₹500 crore from global aerospace manufacturer Boeing, observing that the matter involves a contractual dispute. A two-member Mumbai bench of NCLT said there was a contractual dispute over the pre-delivery/advance payments, requiring detailed adjudication and evidence, and therefore could not be decided by the tribunal under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC). Jet Airways, which is under the liquidation process from November 26, 2024, had entered into agreements with Boeing in 2013 for purchase of two aircraft 737-8 and 787-9 aircraft and paid \$92.13 million as advance/pre-delivery payments. However, Boeing suspended the agreements in May 2019 over payment delays, months before Jet went into the Corporate Insolvency Resolution Process (CIRP) in June 2019.

Jaypee Infratech to invest ₹3,000 cr to finish stalled projects

Realty firm Jaypee Infratech, acquired by Suraksha Group through insolvency, on Monday said it will invest about ₹3,000 crore over the next two years to complete all stalled housing projects and asserted that all stuck home-buyers would get their apartments by September 2028. The company also announced plans to develop three new townships on Yamuna Expressway totalling more than 450 acres. On June 4, 2024, Suraksha Group took control of Jaypee Infratech Ltd (JIL) following insolvency appellate tribunal NCLAT’s decision upholding its bid to acquire the bankrupt real estate company. In a press conference, Suraksha Group Promoter Sudhir Valia highlighted that in the last two years, it has completed 84 towers comprising 7,913 units out of the total 159 towers that were stalled when it took over the JIL operations.

Emami considers share buyback, calls board meeting on Sep 17

Homegrown FMCG major Emami on Monday said its board will meet this week to consider a buyback of the company’s fully paid-up equity shares. The Kolkata-headquartered company did not disclose the size or price of the proposed buyback. “Notice is hereby given... that the meeting of Board of Directors of the Company is scheduled to be held on September 17, 2026 to consider, inter alia, a proposal of buyback of the fully paid-up equity shares of the company, including matters related/incidental thereto,” Emami said in a regulatory filing. The company said it will intimate the stock exchanges of the outcome of the board meeting after its conclusion on September 17.

Jimny, Fronx, eVitara cross 100K export mark to Japan: Maruti Suzuki

Maruti Suzuki India on Monday said cumulative exports of the Made-in-India Jimny 5-door, Fronx, and e Vitara to Japan have surpassed 100,000 units. Maruti Suzuki India began exporting the Fronx to Japan, one of the world’s most competitive and advanced automobile markets, in August 2024, followed by the Jimny 5-door in December 2024. The Company’s first Battery Electric Vehicle (BEV), e Vitara, joined this export portfolio in September 2025, further strengthening India’s role as a global manufacturing hub for Suzuki. Jimny 5-door and e Vitara are manufactured exclusively in India. With growing acceptance of Made-in-India vehicles, Japan stood as Maruti Suzuki’s second-largest export market by volume in FY26, the company said.

Reliance Industries’ arm METL appoints Manish Jaiswal CEO

Reliance Industries Ltd’s arm Model Economic Township Ltd (METL) has appointed Manish Jaiswal as Chief Executive Officer. The METL is developing a large integrated township, ‘Reliance MET City’, spread over 8,250 acres, in Jhajjar, Haryana. Prior to joining the METL, Jaiswal served as CEO of Eldeco Group, the company said. In his new role, Jaiswal, who has over 20 years of experience, will lead the overall business and growth strategy for Reliance MET City. He would be responsible for driving industrial, residential and commercial development, attracting new investments, strengthening the development pipeline and expanding the integrated ecosystem across multiple asset classes.

Sikkim’s Temi Tea eyes global markets, franchise expansion

Sikkim-based Temi Tea is eyeing greater presence in overseas markets including Japan, Germany, the US and South Korea while exploring a franchise model and new products to attract younger consumers, its managing director Radha Pradhan said on Monday. Pradhan said Temi Tea was committed to maintaining quality standards, as it explores “innovative products” and marketing strategies to appeal to the youth.

Škoda India rules out Kylaq exports to Europe after FTA

DEEPAK PATEL
New Delhi, 14 September

Škoda Auto Volkswagen India Private Limited (SAVWIPL) on Monday ruled out exporting its India-developed compact sport utility vehicle (SUV) Kylaq to Europe, even though detailed terms of the India-EU free trade agreement (FTA) released earlier this month offer Indian-origin cars preferential access to the European market.

“After careful consideration, this will not be the case for the Škoda Kylaq,” SAVWIPL said in response to questions from *Business Standard* on whether the FTA could make it more attractive to export the Kylaq or other India-made models to the European Union (EU).

SAVWIPL, which has six automotive brands in India – Škoda, Volkswagen, Audi, Porsche, Lamborghini, and Bentley – stated that the group continues to explore opportunities to use its Indian portfolio in international markets. The Kylaq is manufactured and sold by Škoda brand.

The aforementioned decision comes after Škoda had publicly said that exporting the Kylaq to Europe was being evaluated. In June, Škoda Chief Executive Officer (CEO) Klaus Zellmer had said bringing the India-made SUV to Europe was “very much on the table”. As recently as August, media reports mentioned the company was evaluating a European export version, potentially with a 1.5-litre TSI engine.

SAVWIPL, however, has not closed the door on taking other India-developed products to international markets. It said the group is continuously “exploring sensible business



Changing track

- The decision comes after Škoda India had publicly said it was evaluating exporting the Kylaq to Europe
- However, SAVWIPL has not closed the door on taking other India-developed products to global markets
- The firm said the FTA nevertheless creates opportunities for the auto industry
- The FTA provides greater visibility for businesses operating across the two markets
- Launched in Nov 2024, Kylaq accounted for around 62% of the brand’s sales in the first 8 months of 2026

opportunities to grow its international footprint and to offer customers more choice for affordable mobility”.

“One of the options would be to evaluate how to leverage the brand’s successful Indian portfolio for other regions of the world,” it added. SAVWIPL currently manufactures five passenger-vehicle (PV) models in India: Kylaq, Kushaq and Slavia under the Škoda brand, and Taigun and Virtus under the Volkswagen brand.

The Kylaq, which was launched in November 2024, has emerged as a major success for Škoda in India. Škoda sold 72,665 cars in 2025, its highest ever annual sales in the country, registering 107 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) growth. About 61 per cent of Škoda’s total sales in India were Kylaq.

Its demand continues to remain strong. Kylaq accounted for around 62 per cent of the brand’s sales in the first eight months of 2026. Škoda’s overall India sales stood at 50,253 units during the January–August period, up 7.6 per cent Y-o-Y.

The company said the FTA nevertheless creates opportunities for the auto industry and provides greater visibility for businesses operating across the two markets.

“As a global company, we strongly support FTAs across markets and geographies. The FTA provides greater long-term visibility and opens up opportunities for the industry. But it is important to distinguish between the opportunity created by the FTA and an immediate change in our portfolio,” SAVWIPL said.

The company reiterated that India would remain an important development and manufacturing base for the group.

“We remain firmly committed to India as a development and manufacturing hub. The FTA does not change our commitment to building a strong, sustainable, and increasingly localised business in India,” it said. SAVWIPL also emphasised that the group’s commitment to its Indian operations extends beyond exports.

“What remains certain is the group’s unwavering commitment to offering high-quality, safe, and competitively priced vehicles backed by exceptional service and ownership benefits,” the company said.

“We remain committed to developing and manufacturing products in India, for India and the world,” it added.

The India-EU FTA negotiations were formally concluded on January 27, 2026, but the detailed tariff schedules and annexes were published earlier this month after the legal revision process. The detailed terms are particularly significant for automobiles. The EU will initially allow up to 250,000 Indian-origin cars into its market annually at preferential tariffs, with the quota rising to 400,000 vehicles by the 10th year. The preferential tariff for eligible Indian cars will fall from 8 per cent to zero over five years.

The agreement also opens India’s PV market to European manufacturers through a quota-based mechanism. India will allow 100,000 EU-made internal combustion engine (ICE) and non-plug-in hybrid passenger cars in the first year, with the quota rising to 160,000 by the 10th year.

Rosmerta group targets 30-35% growth in FY27

ANJALI SINGH
Mumbai, 14 September

The Rosmerta group, an Indian automotive technology and e-governance organisation, is targeting 30-35 per cent growth in financial year 2026-27 (FY27) after closing FY26 with a revenue of around ₹1,200-1,250 crore, as it expands beyond its traditional auto-ancillary business into technology-led and mobility solutions.

The group is betting on businesses such as telematics, connected-vehicle platforms, government-service digitisation, and road-safety solutions, while also expanding its manufacturing footprint. “We are not a typical auto ancillary,” Rosmerta group President Karn Nagpal said, highlighting the group’s presence across technology platforms, connectivity management, telematics, and government and private services, besides manufacturing.

The company plans to add two diesel exhaust fluid (DEF) plants this year, as it expects the business to nearly double during FY27. It is also shifting one of its main plants to a larger facility in Manesar in the next couple of months. The group currently has 7-8 plants across businesses, including telematics, high-security registration plates (HSRP), DEF, and vehicle recycling.

The DEF and vehicle recycling businesses, which are relatively new for the group, have emerged as key growth areas. The company said it expects to double its DEF business this year, following strong growth in the previous year.

Nagpal said the group’s growth is increasingly linked to the shift towards connected and software-enabled vehicles. Rosmerta has been in the telematics business for nearly a decade now and supplies



Karn Nagpal, Rosmerta group president

connectivity solutions to both after-market and original equipment manufacturers (OEMs). As connectivity expands beyond electric vehicles (EVs) to internal combustion engine (ICE) vehicles, the company expects demand for telematics and connected-vehicle platforms to increase. It has nearly 200,000 electric two-wheelers (e2Ws) on its platform, following its recent acquisition. The company expects the rising penetration of e2Ws and the increasing need for connected features and software updates to create further opportunities.

Rosmerta also expects growth from its new road-safety vertical, which includes fire suppression and fire-alert systems for buses. The company is currently piloting these systems with electric and ICE bus manufacturers, while supplies of fire extinguishers for passenger vehicles (PVs) have already begun.

Nagpal further said the company is betting on the growing adoption of connected vehicles, with connectivity increasingly becoming an integral part of both electric and ICE vehicles.

The company closed FY26 with 35-40 per cent growth and is now targeting another 30-35 per cent growth in FY27.

Charging infra should be in place before ebuses: Eka

DEEPAK PATEL
New Delhi, 14 September

The biggest bottleneck for electric bus (ebus) deployment in India is no longer the availability or delivery of buses but the readiness of depots, Eka Mobility Founder and Chairman Sudhir Mehta said on Monday, calling for depot and charging infrastructure development to be taken out of the bus tendering process.

In an interview with *Business Standard*, Mehta said charging infrastructure should be tendered before the ebuses, as it takes longer to build than to manufacture the buses.

A depot needs electricity connections, charging equipment and civil infrastructure, with transmission capacity also playing a pivotal role as large numbers of ebuses are deployed. “Depot infrastructure requires a separate scale,” he said.

Eka was the second-largest winner in India’s recent ebus tender. In December 2025, it secured orders for 3,485 buses in the Centre’s 10,900-bus tender under the Prime Minister Electric Drive Revolution in Innovative Vehicle Enhancement

(PM eDRIVE) scheme.

He said ebus procurement itself has become faster as the industry has matured. Bus formats and products have become more standardised, while procurement and financing processes are now better understood. This means governments can reduce the time between awarding a bus contract and actually putting vehicles into service if infrastructure is handled separately.

Mehta proposed that governments should first map the depot and charging infrastructure required over several years. “Ideally, we should map out the charging infrastructure requirement for the next five years and tender it first. That process can take 12 to 24 months. Once the infrastructure is ready, deploying the buses is a matter of a few months,” he said.

The delay in depot readiness has also affected Eka’s production planning. Mehta said the company had buses ready at its plant but could not send them because the depots were not ready. Eka now plans production based on when the depots are expected to be ready. “We are now monitoring depot



“WE ARE NOW MONITORING DEPOT AVAILABILITY AND ONLY PRODUCING THE BUS WHEN THE DEPOTS ARE READY”

Sudhir Mehta
Founder and Chairman, Eka Mobility

availability and only producing the bus when the depots are ready. This is one of our learnings because we discovered that we had ended up with too much stock (ready ebuses in the factory),” he said.

Under the current system in India, the tender usually involves

an original equipment manufacturer (OEM), which makes the buses, and an operating partner, which deploys them. Eka is only the OEM. It makes and services the buses but does not operate them.

The operating partner must arrange financing, chargers, electricity connections, depot work, and drivers. There can also be a delay of six to eight months before a state issues the letter of award (LoA), which allows the project to move ahead.

After the LoA, the operator has to secure financing and prepare the depot. But banks also want charging infrastructure in place before financing the buses. Mehta said this creates a cycle that can delay deliveries.

“The bank will not give them a loan for the bus until the charging infrastructure is ready. If the bank does not give them the loan, I cannot give them the bus without payment... This is a vicious cycle,” he said. Eka currently has an order book of almost 10,500 ebuses. It has delivered more than 1,500 and has around 9,000 ebuses left to deliver over the next 18-24 months. The orders cover more than 40

cities. The company is completing a 750-bus order for Rajasthan and has also started operations in Andhra Pradesh and Bihar. Mehta said Eka’s ebus deliveries could rise from around 500 last financial year (2025-26/FY26) to about 1,800 this financial year (2026-27/FY27). For the following financial year (2027-28), the company is targeting 4,000-4,500 ebus deliveries. The company delivered about 200 ebuses last month and expects to reach deliveries of about 400 per month by March.

Mehta said the next major opportunity for Eka would be electric trucks (etrucks), where the company has already completed trials with more than 50 customers. Its etrucks are homologated, meaning they have received regulatory approval for sale, but commercial sales have not yet begun.

The company is initially setting up capacity to produce about 3,000 etrucks a year. Mehta said this capacity could be expanded quickly because Eka’s plants are modular and can be configured for ebuses or etrucks depending on demand. He said the company

would first focus on validating the business case before rapidly scaling truck volumes.

Mehta expects the etruck market to expand sharply over the next five years. He sees the opportunity in etrucks at eight to 10 times the size of the ebus opportunity. He also expects heavy etrucks to account for 30-50 per cent of the market within five years, provided the right products, financing, and charging infrastructure become available.

“Trucks are a very unforgiving game. People have to be convinced from the unit economics. Once they are, the numbers will come. And five years down the line, I think the Indian market will be shocked at the size of the Indian market of etrucks,” he said.

Eka is also expanding beyond India, with ebuses already operating in Zanzibar and South Africa. Mehta said the company has 50 buses running in Zanzibar and is looking to deploy another 100 there next year. It is also exploring assembly facilities with partners in Africa, where he sees Indian electric commercial vehicles as competitive.

Essar Energy Transition Retail acquires SGN, a UK forecourt network

SUDHEER PAL SINGH
New Delhi, 14 September

Essar Energy Transition Retail (EET Retail), part of Cheshire-based Essar Energy Transition Fuels (EETF), on Monday announced an agreement to acquire 100 per cent of SGN Retail, a large UK independent forecourt operator.

Essar did not disclose the deal value but said it will be funded through a combination of cash and a new £250 million senior debt facility arranged by a bank group comprising First Abu Dhabi Bank, Macquarie Bank, Mizrahi Tefahot Bank, Natixis, OakNorth Bank, Royal Bank of Canada, SMCB Bank International and Sound Point Capital Management.

“The transaction adds 118 high-quality forecourt locations to EET Retail’s portfolio. Combined with EET Retail’s existing estate of 117 sites, the transaction establishes a scaled, nationwide mobility plat-

form of 235 fuel forecourts with annual throughput exceeding 650 million litres,” the company said in a statement.

Essar Energy Transition said it is committing to a model in the UK that integrates the manufacture of fuels with the sale of fuels to consumers in an efficient and reliable way. “The transaction creates the second-largest UK forecourt network that is backwardly integrated with fuel production,” it said.

The acquisition of SGN Retail is expected to accelerate EET Retail’s long-term roadmap to expand its footprint to supply domestic fuel directly to 800 forecourts by 2031, representing around 9 per cent UK market share.

“EET Retail believes that the combination of demographic growth, the rise of multi-car households and the declining number of forecourts in the UK create an attractive outlook to invest in the forecourt sector,” the company said.



Himadri eyes 70% exports with full capacity utilisation at Birla Tyres

HEMANT KUMAR ROUT
Bhubaneswar, 14 September

A year after acquiring 100 per cent of Birla Tyres, Himadri Speciality Chemical is all set to scale up its tyre business over the next four years, with plans to take capacity utilisation from the current 15-20 per cent to 100 per cent and make exports of off-the-road (OTR) and off-highway tyres (OHT) a major growth driver.

Anurag Choudhary, chairman and managing director and chief executive officer of Himadri, said Birla Tyres, which resumed production on May 29 last year, has been ramping up output every month and is expected to see a substantial increase in revenue as utilisation improves. The company achieved a top line of ₹126 crore in the first quarter and expects the business to grow quarter-on-quarter.

Birla Tyres has an installed capacity of around 400 tonnes per



Anurag Choudhary, MD and CEO of Himadri, said the strategy is aimed at moving Birla Tyres into higher-value and more specialised tyre categories

day, with current production at about 80-100 tonnes per day. “The idea is to ramp up in every quarter. The biggest shift in the business will come from a change in product mix. We are moving in phases from its traditional truck and bus bias tyre (also known as a cross-ply tyre) business towards OTR and OHT tyres, with agriculture and mining identified as the

principal growth segments,” he said in an interaction with *Business Standard*.

Choudhary said the transition would take around four years, during which the company will introduce around 400 new stock-keeping units to address specific customer requirements. The strategy is aimed at moving Birla Tyres into higher-value and more specialised tyre categories with stronger demand in global markets.

Exports will be central to this strategy. The company has already started exporting, although volumes are currently small because production is still at an early stage of rampup. It is initially targeting African markets and some countries in West Asia, while also developing opportunities in Europe and the US. The international footprint is expected to expand substantially over the next five years. Himadri expects more than two-thirds of the OTR and OHT tyre volumes produced in India to be exported

to international markets. “We aspire to export more than 70 per cent of our production to the global market for agriculture and mining tyres. We are building a robust international distribution network,” Choudhary said.

The product portfolio is also set to widen further. While OTR and OHT will remain the key near-term focus, Himadri is preparing for a subsequent entry into passenger car radial (PCR) tyres, particularly in the electric vehicle (EV) and sport utility vehicle categories, with a dedicated PCR facility being readied for commissioning in 2028 at its factory in Odisha’s Balasore district. “We will have all the products. We have OTR, OHT, bias for trucks and buses, then we have PCR and EV,” he said. The firm is simultaneously investing in modernising the Birla Tyres plant through automation, machinery upgrades, and new equipment.

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PSG Equity raises over €4.4 bn for software, tech bets



PSG Equity has raised over €4.4 billion (\$5.1 billion) for a new fund targeting European software and technology firms, a vote of confidence from investors in a sector that suffered a heavy selloff earlier this year. PSG Europe III is around 70 per cent larger than its predecessor vehicle, which the firm raised in 2023, people familiar with the matter said, asking not to be identified. The fundraising comes as the software sector recovers from a selloff brought on by the emergence of new AI models that are threatening to replace many incumbent systems. BLOOMBERG

Intel-backed construction AI firm Buildots raises \$130 mn

Buildots, a startup that uses AI to help speed up construction of expensive mega-projects like data centres, chip factories and hospitals, has raised \$130 million in new financing. The investment was led by billionaire Eyal Ofer's OG Venture Partners, with participation from Lightspeed Venture Partners, Intel Capital, and others, the US-Israeli startup said in a statement on Monday. The firm has raised \$297 million since its founding in 2018. With new investment round, the startup's valuation is approaching \$1 billion, CEO Roy Danon said in an interview. Buildots' platform compares actual construction progress against design plans and schedules, according to the firm. BLOOMBERG



Legal education must evolve with technology: Keralam CM
Keralam Chief Minister V D Satheesan on Monday said legal education must evolve with technological changes to prepare a new generation of professionals to deal with emerging issues, particularly those arising from the rapid growth of AI. Inaugurating the graduation ceremony of the 2026 pass-out batch of Government Law College in Malappuram, the CM said technological advancement would continue to create new legal possibilities and challenges. PTI

Firmus seeks to raise up to \$5 billion in Australian IPO

Australian AI infrastructure company Firmus Technologies is seeking to raise up to \$5 billion in its initial public offering (IPO), aiming to launch next month, two people with knowledge of the matter said. At \$5 billion, the IPO would rank as the fourth largest globally so far this year, behind SpaceX, CXMT Corp and Cerebras Systems, according to Dealogic data. It would also be the second largest Australian-listed IPO on record, behind only Telstra Corp's \$10 billion flotation in 1997. Firmus targets an IPO launch in October, with a debut on the Australian Securities Exchange expected as early as late October, the people said. REUTERS

COFORGE CHAIRMAN'S EXIT

O P Bhatt's extension hit shareholder wall

AVIK DAS Bengaluru, 14 September

Coforge reportedly lost confidence in its chairman before its shareholders denied a special resolution at the annual general meeting (AGM) to extend O P Bhatt's tenure till 2032, that led to him receiving the lowest ratings by other board members as part of the board evaluation report, according to people familiar with the matter.

The ratings, which the company says Bhatt did not disclose or discuss with the board, led to a fallout between the career banker and one of India's fastest-growing mid-tier information technology (IT) services companies, resulting in Bhatt stepping down last week. That was followed by the resignation of D K Singh, the head of the nomination and remuneration committee.

"It's more of an integrity and governance issue; whether you have the right facts or not. Obviously, we are not happy with what has happened. It's caught us by absolute surprise. We've always held Bhatt and Singh in high regard," said a board member who did not wish to be named.

People in the know added that the evaluation exercise applied to every member, including Chief Executive Officer Sudhir Singh. Some of the parameters, they said, to evaluate the performance of the chairman included questions about his contribution, whether he facilitated board meetings properly, if he was able to contribute effectively as the head, whether he had a good appreciation of the industry and if he understood the business in detail.

Sudhir Singh, incidentally, recorded the highest possible score of 5 out of 5 for the performance of the executive director (CEO), with the rating coming from four independent directors and one executive director. The fact that Bhatt scored the lowest shows the doubts of other members about him, said one of the persons. Private equity firm Advent International, which holds about 20 per cent stake in Coforge, was not part of the evaluation process, the people confirmed. Advent International voted against Bhatt's extension last month.



Questions remain on why Bhatt, who was also an independent director at TCS, fell out of favour with the board

Questions remain on why Bhatt, who was also an independent director at Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), fell out of favour with the board. The people quoted above said that while he was supportive and there was no dissent on anything in the meetings he chaired, he failed to make his mark as an effective head.

Bhatt did not respond to calls. Repeated text and WhatsApp messages sent to him asking for his response to the board's view went unanswered.

Speaking on the condition of anonymity, some analysts said this could perhaps be traced back to Bhatt's career trajectory of heading relatively conservative companies — such as State Bank of India (SBI) and being on TCS' board — which are not on a tearaway growth path such as Coforge.

Amazon Now hits \$1 billion annualised gross sales in India

PEERZADA ABRAR Bengaluru, 14 September

Amazon said its ultra-fast delivery service Amazon Now has reached \$1 billion in annualised gross sales in India over the past three-month period. The firm said Amazon Now orders have doubled every quarter since launch, making it the fastest-growing ecommerce business in Amazon India's history. The development comes ahead of the festival season, as the company faces intensifying competition from quick-commerce rivals, including Blinkit, Zepto, Swiggy Instamart and Flipkart Minutes.

The company has expanded Amazon Now to 4X more cities in less than 10 weeks, taking delivery-in-minutes to over 60 Indian cities and towns ahead of the festival season. Apart from the metros, this service is available to customers in towns such as Padubidri and Dharwad in Karnataka, Tirupati and Guntur in Andhra Pradesh, Gurdaspur and Jalandhar in Punjab, Vellore in Tamil Nadu, Warangal

Amazon ramps up India network

Amazon announced the biggest-ever expansion of its operations network ahead of the festival season, with the launch of 20 fulfilment centres, 6 sort centres and 150 last-mile delivery stations. The expansion raises Amazon's total storage capacity by 50 per cent to 64 million cubic feet — equivalent to over 720 Olympic-sized swimming pools. PEERZADA ABRAR

in Telangana and Berhampur in Odisha among others. These orders are delivered within minutes through a network of over 750 micro-fulfilment and urban fulfilment centres.

"In a short period of time, Amazon Now has crossed \$1 billion in annualised gross sales in India, making it the fastest-growing ecommerce business unit in Amazon India's history.

We are humbled by the customer response, with orders doubling every quarter," said Samir Kumar, country manager, Amazon India. "We are on track to expand to 100 cities by Diwali, taking delivery-in-minutes from Gurdaspur and Hoshiarpur in the north to Vembayam and Alamcode in the south. Customers across the country can look forward to the widest selection delivered at the fastest speeds this festive season," said Kumar.

People familiar with the development said Amazon Now's average order value is around ₹540, with the company handling about 700,000 orders a day. They said Amazon Now has a 10 per cent market share by orders and 14 per cent by value. In June 2026, Amazon had announced plans to build India's largest "delivery-in-minutes" network by scaling Amazon Now to customers in over 300 cities. The firm said it continues to scale up its specialised fulfilment infrastructure to offer the largest selection of products by sellers to customers across the country.

HORIBA India may chip in with local semicon gear as demand builds

AASHISH ARYAN New Delhi, 14 September

HORIBA India, a manufacturer and provider of precision analytical and measurement systems, is open to setting up domestic manufacturing units for mass flow controllers and other specialised semiconductor manufacturing equipment in India once the overall silicon chip fabrication and packaging ecosystem grows, Dan Horiba, executive director and general manager of the group strategy division at Horiba, said.

"It depends on the local needs. If we have enough volume in the Indian market, then we can probably have local production. Internally,



Dan Horiba, executive director and general manager, HORIBA India

we have global capabilities for markets in Europe, Singapore and other areas. We have product research and development (R&D) in France, Japan, and the US," Horiba told Business Standard at a press conference marking two decades of

HORIBA India's operations.

Though India has ample talent for R&D in semiconductor chip manufacturing and packaging, the country should also focus on building a complete, end-to-end semiconductor value chain to create more intellectual property (IP) that stays with Indian companies and researchers, Horiba said.

"That (creating a value chain) is always a big driver of IP. For example, in Japan, when you look back 20 or 30 years, we had very strong chip manufacturers. At that time, component and material makers like us contributed to that strong global value chain," he said.

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CUBICAL FINANCIAL SERVICES LIMITED	
Corporate Identification Number: L65993DL1990PLC040101 Registered Office - 456, Aggarwal Metro Heights, Netaji Subhash Place, Pitam Pura, New Delhi-110034 Tel: 011-47057757; Website: www.cubical90.com; Email Id: cubfinser@yahoo.com	
Recommendations of the Committee of Independent Directors ("IDC") on the Open Offer by Mr. Manoj Agrawal (Acquirer-1) And Mr. Amit Kumar Saraogi (Acquirer-2) (hereinafter collectively referred to as "Acquirers") together with 'Mrs. Shikha Agrawal' (PAC-1), 'M/S Manoj Agrawal HUF' (PAC-2) and 'Mrs. Kanchan Saraogi' (PAC-3) (hereinafter referred to as "PACs") to the Eligible Equity Shareholders of Cubical Financial Services Limited ("CUBIFIN") "Target Company" "TC" for the acquisition of upto 3,77,44,200 Equity Shares of the Target Company representing 26.00% of the Emerging Equity and Voting Share Capital under Regulation 26(7) of SEBI (Substantial Acquisition of Shares and Takeovers) Regulations, 2011 and subsequent amendments thereto ("SEBI (SAST) Regulations, 2011") ("Regulations")	
1	Date Monday, September 14, 2026
2	Name of the Target Company ("TC") Cubical Financial Services Limited
3	Details of the Offer pertaining to TC The Offer is being made by the Acquirer and PAC in terms of Regulation 3(1) and (4) of the Takeover Regulations for acquisition of upto 3,77,44,200 Equity Shares of the face value of Rs. 2/- each ("Offer Shares"), representing 26.00% of the Emerging Equity & Voting Share Capital of the Target Company at an Offer Price of Rs. 2.50/- (Rupees Two point Fifty Paise only) ("Offer Price") along with applicable interest of upto Rs. 0.021 per fully paid-up Equity Shares ("Applicable Interest") payable in cash.
4	Name of the Acquirer(s) and the Person Acting in Concert (PAC) with the Acquirers Acquirer(s): Mr. Manoj Agrawal (Acquirer-1) and Mr. Amit Kumar Saraogi (Acquirer-2) PAC (s): Mrs. Shikha Agrawal (PAC-1), M/S Manoj Agrawal HUF (PAC-2) and Mrs. Kanchan Saraogi (PAC-3)
5	Name of the Manager to the Offer Corporate Makers Capital Limited Address: 611, 6 th Floor, Pragati Towers, Rajendra Place, New Delhi - 110091 Contact Number: +91-11-41411600 Email: info@corporatemakers.in Investor Grievance Email : compliance@corporatemakers.in Contact Person: Mr. Rohit Pareek SEBI Registration Number: INM000013095
6	Members of the Committee of Independent Directors Mr. Subhash Kumar Changoiwala Member of the Committee and Non-Executive and Independent Director and; Mr. Ram Gopal Dalmia - Chairperson of the Committee and Non-Executive and Independent Director
7	IDC Members relationship with the TC (Director, Equity Shares owned, any other contract/ relationship), if any None of the Members of the IDC hold any Equity Shares in the TC nor have they any relationship with the other Directors of the TC and apart from being the directors of the TC they are not related to each other in any manner.
8	Trading in the Equity shares/ other securities of the TC by IDC Members None of the IDC Members have traded in the Equity Shares of the Target Company during 12 months prior to the date of the Public Announcement of the Offer.
9	IDC Member relationship with the Acquirers and PAC(s) (Director, Equity Shares owned any other contract/ relationship), if any None of the IDC Members have any relationship with the Acquirers and PAC(s).
10	Trading in the Equity Shares/ other securities of the Acquirers by IDC Members Not Applicable
11	Recommendation on the Open Offer, as to whether the offer is fair and reasonable Based on the review of documents and materials as placed before the IDC as mentioned below: 1. Public Announcement by Acquirer(s) and PAC(s) dated May 15, 2026 ("PA"); 2. Detailed Public Statement (DPS) by Acquirer(s) and PAC(s) dated May 21, 2026; 3. Draft Letter of Offer (LoFo) by Acquirer(s) and PAC(s) dated May 29, 2026; and 4. Letter of Offer (LoFo) by Acquirer(s) and PAC(s) dated September 09, 2026 in which offer price if Rs. 2.50/- per equity share along with applicable interest of Rs. 0.021 per Equity Share. Based on the above and the relevant information (as set out in summary of reasons for recommendation), the IDC Members is of the opinion that the offer price is fair and reasonable and in line with SEBI SAST Regulations, 2011. Further, IDC Members confirm that the Target Company has not received any complaint from the shareholders regarding the Open Offer process, valuation price or method of valuation.
12	Summary of reasons for recommendation The IDC Members has evaluated the PA, DPS, LoFo and LoF issued / submitted by Corporate Makers Capital Limited (Manager to the Offer) for and on behalf of the Acquirer(s) and PAC(s) and has also noted that the equity shares of the Target Company are frequently traded and that the offer price has been determined in accordance with the applicable provisions of the SEBI (SAST) Regulations. The IDC has considered, inter alia, the following factors while making its recommendation: a) The Applicable interest of Upto Rs. 0.021 per Equity share computed at 10% per annum has been offered by the Acquirer(s) and PAC(s) for the delay in making the payment to the public shareholders in accordance with the requirements under SEBI (SAST) Regulations, 2011. b) The Offer price of Rs. 2.50/- per Equity Share is in accordance with Regulation 8(2) of SEBI SAST Regulations; c) The Offer Price of Rs. 2.50/- per Equity Share is higher than the highest negotiated price per share of the Target Company under the agreement attracting the obligation to make the Open Offer i.e. Rs. 2.05/- per Equity Share; and d) The Offer Price of Rs. 2.50/- per Equity Share is higher to the volume weighted average market price of Equity Shares of the Target Company for a period of sixty trading days immediately preceding the date of the PA as traded on the BSE Ltd ("BSE"), being the stock exchange where the maximum volume of trading in the shares of the Target Company are recorded i.e. Rs. 2.18/- (Indian Rupees Four Hundred and Sixty Nine point Nine Seven) per Equity Share; e) The Offer Price of Rs. 2.50/- per Equity Share is higher than the price payable under the proposed preferential issue i.e. Rs. 2.44/- per equity share. Considering the market price at a given point of time, the public shareholders of the Target Company are, however, advised to independently evaluate the Open Offer and take an informed decision about tendering the Equity Shares held by them in the Open Offer. The statement of recommendation will be available on the website of the Target Company at www.cubical90.com.
13	Disclosure of voting pattern These recommendations were unanimously approved by the Members of the IDC.
14	Details of Independent Advisors None
15	Any other matter(s) to be highlighted None
To the best of our knowledge and belief, after making proper enquiry, the information contained in or accompanying this statement is, in all material respect, true and correct and not misleading, whether by omission of any information or otherwise, and includes all the information required to be disclosed by the TC under the Takeover Regulations.	
For Cubical Financial Services Limited Sd/- Ram Gopal Dalmia (Chairman of the IDC) DIN- 07368463	
Place: Delhi Date: September 14, 2026	

PUBLIC NOTICE

This notice is for the general public regarding the proposed registration of a political party named Aasha Pragati Party. The party office is located at Village Bihari ki Gotiya, Majra Bhaismal, Post Binawar, Tehsil and District Budaun, Uttar Pradesh. This party has submitted an application for registration as a political party to the Election Commission of India, New Delhi, under Section 29A of the Representation of the People Act, 1951. The names of the party officials are given below: President/ Chairman: Santosh Kumar, son of Shri Abilash, Resident of Village Bihari ki Gotiya, Majra Bhaismal, Post Binawar, Tehsil and District Budaun (U.P.). General Secretary/ Secretary: Nand Kishor, son of Shri Abilash, Resident of Village Bihari ki Gotiya, Majra Bhaismal, Post Binawar, Tehsil and District Budaun (U.P.) Treasurer: Pramod, son of Shri Omkar, Resident of Village and Post Singraura, Tehsil and District Budaun (U.P.) If anyone has any objection to the registration of Aasha Pragati Party, they should send it along with reasons to the Secretary (Political Party), Election Commission of India, Nirvachan Sadan, Ashoka Road, New Delhi-110001, within 30 days from the publication of this notice.

OFFICE OF THE RECOVERY OFFICER-II
DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL-II, DELHI
4TH FLOOR, JEEVAN RAJA BUILDING, PARLIAMENT STREET, NEW DELHI110001
RC 184/2024 IN OA/460/2022

Notice under Rule-2 of Second Schedule to the Income Tax Act, 1961 read with Section 29 of Recovery of Debts and Bankruptcy Act, 1993

HDFC Bank Ltd
Certificate Holder

Vs

Sunita Dhania
Certificate Holder

To, 1. SUNITA DHANIA Kalawati Saran Children's Hospital, Bangla Sahib Road, New Delhi - 110001. Also, at 432, RML Hospital, C.P. Baba Kharg Singh Marg, New Delhi. Also At, H. No. 63, Site-3, Vikas Puri, New Delhi

Whereas the above-named Certificate Holder has instituted RC proceedings for recovery of Rs.30,35,544.04 (Rupees Thirty Lakh Thirty-Five Thousand Five Hundred Forty-Four and Four Paise Only) against you and whereas it has been shown to the satisfaction of the Tribunal that it is not possible to serve you in the ordinary way. Therefore, this notice is given by advertisement directing you to make appearance before Ld. Recovery Officer-II on 28.10.2026 at 11:00 AM. (for further details kindly visit DRT website www.drt.gov.in Phone Number: 011-23748473). Take notice that in case of your failure to appear on the above-mentioned day before this Tribunal, the case will be heard and decided in your absence. All the matters will be taken up through Video Conferencing and for that purpose: - (I) All the Advocates/Litigants shall download the "Cisco Webex" application/Software, (ii) "Meeting ID" and "Password" for the next date of hearing qua cases to be taken by Registrar/Recovery Officer-I and Recovery Officer-II shall be available one day prior to the next date at DRT Official Portal i.e., "https://drt.gov.in" under the Public Notice Head. (iii) In any exigency qua that, the Advocates/Litigants can contact the concerned official at Ph. No. 011-23748473

Respondent may contact under mentioned Phone number for further enquiry.
Ld. Recovery Officer-II, DRT-II, New Delhi.
Phone No: 011-23748473, Email: drt2delhi-dfs@nic.in

By order of this Tribunal

INTERNATIONAL COMBUSTION
(INDIA) LIMITED
CIN: L36912WB1936PLC008588
Registered Office: Infinity Benchmark, 11th Floor, Plot No. G-1, Block EP & GP, Sector V, Salt Lake Electronics Complex, Kolkata 700 091
Phone: +91(33) 4080 3000
e-mail: info@internationalcombustion.in ; Website : www.internationalcombustion.in

NOTICE TO SHAREHOLDERS

SPECIAL WINDOW FOR TRANSFER AND DEMATERIALISATION OF PHYSICAL SHARES

SEBI vide its Circular no. HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MIRSD-POD/1/3750/2026 dated 30th January 2026, has opened a special window for transfer and dematerialisation of physical securities purchased or sold prior to 1st April 2019, including cases where transfer requests were earlier rejected, returned or not attended due to deficiencies. This special window is opened from 5th February 2026 to 4th February 2027. Securities transferred under this window will be credited only in demat form and will be subject to a one-year lock-in period from the date of transfer registration. Shareholders may submit their requests along with the requisite documents to the Registrar and Share Transfer Agent of the Company i.e. MUFG Intime India Private Limited (Formerly CB Management Services Pvt. Ltd.), Rasoi Court, 5th Floor, 20 Sir R. N. Mukherjee Road, Kolkata - 700001, Tel: 033-69066200, and Email: investor.helpdesk@in.mpmc.mufig.com and Email: secretarial@internationalcombustion.in or with the Company Secretary of the Company at the Registered Office of the Company at Infinity Benchmark, 11th Floor, Plot No. G-1, Block EP & GP, Sector - V, Salt Lake Electronic Complex, Kolkata-700091, West Bengal.
For International Combustion (India) Limited
Kundan Jaiswal
Place : Kolkata
Date : 15th September 2026 Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

SREI EQUIPMENT FINANCE LIMITED
CIN: U70101WB2006PLC109898
Registered Office & Head Office: 7th Floor, Unit No. - 704, Godrej Waterside - I, Plot - 5, Block - DP, Sector - V, Salt Lake, Kolkata - 700091
Email: sefi@srei.com; Website: www.srei.com

Notice is hereby given to the public at large and the customers of Srei Equipment Finance Limited ("SEFL") regarding the Shifting of the Hyderabad Branch office of the Company, The Hyderabad Branch office, which is operating from the present addresses mentioned herein, has been Shifted to a new location with effect from 1st September 2026.

Branch Office	Old Address	New Address	Contact Person
Hyderabad	Om Chambers, Door No.1-10-74/TF, Ward Block 1st, 3rd Floor, Dwarkadas Colony, Begumpet, Hyderabad - 500016	Ashoka Bhoopal Chambers, Flat No. 607, Ward Block 1-8, Sindhi Colony, SP Road, Begumpet, Hyderabad, Telangana - 500003	Mr. Kaushik Mazumdar @ 990308891, Email - kaushik.mazumdar1@srei.com

Date : 15.09.2026
Place : Kolkata

Subir Roy Chowdhury
Chief Human Resource Officer

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CIN: L99999HR1994PLC034146
Registered Office : Plot No. 31, Echelon Institutional Area, Sector 32, Gurugram-122001, Haryana
Ph. : + 91-124-4675500, Fax No. : + 91-124-4370985
E-mail : corporate@hbestate.com, Website : www.hbestate.com

Special Window for Re-lodgement of transfer requests of physical Shares

Pursuant to SEBI Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MIRSD-POD/1/3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026, shareholders of HB Estate Developers Limited (the Company) are hereby informed that special window has been opened from February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027 for re-lodgement requests for the transfer of shares and is specially applicable to cases which were lodged prior to deadline of April 01, 2019. The original share transfer requests which were rejected/returned/not attended due to deficiencies in documentation or were not processed due to any other reason. Eligible shareholders may submit their transfer request along with the requisite documents to the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent (RTA) at RCMC Share Registry Private Limited at their office address at B-25/1, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase 2, New Delhi, India, 110020, Tel: 011-35020465,66 or send an email at investor.services@rcmcdelhi.com within stipulated period.
If all the documents are found to be in order by the Company/RTA, the share transfer shall be processed only in dematerialized form and shall be under lock in for a period of 1 (one) year from the date of registration by the Company / RTA and shall not be transferred /marked/ pledged during the said lock-in-period. Accordingly, the transferee(s) must have a demat account and provide a copy of their Client Master List (CML), along with the requisite documents, at the time of lodging the transfer request with the Company/RTA.

For HB Estate Developers Limited
Sd/-
NVK Rao
Date : September 14, 2026
Place : Gurugram

Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Membership No. A35382

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SBI may soon issue sanction letter to Vi for its share of ₹35,000 cr funding

SUBRATA PANDA
Mumbai, 14 September

India's largest lender, State Bank of India (SBI), which is spearheading the proposed ₹35,000 crore funding for the country's third-largest telecom operator, Vodafone Idea (Vi), is likely to soon issue a sanction letter for its portion of funds to the telco.

This move may prompt other lenders involved in the discussion to move forward with their decision to back the company, people familiar with the matter said.

However, SBI will release the funds only after Vi ties up the financing with other participating lenders.

The funding process is moving in the right direction and the entire package is expected to see the light of day soon, the sources said.

Earlier, SBI had agreed to sanction its share of the loan after the Aditya Birla group-backed telecom services provider agreed to provide guarantees through its promoter companies.

This issue had been a sticking point and led to a deadlock, with disbursement also tied to the com-



ILLUSTRATION: AJAYA MOHANTY

In context

- SBI is likely to give 20% share (₹7,000 crore) of the total funding
- Remaining amount is expected to come from other lenders including Bank of Baroda, Union Bank of India and Canara Bank, along with a few private sector lenders and the NaBFID
- SBI will release the funds only after Vi ties up the financing with the other participating lenders

pany securing financing from other lenders.

However, the company is now said to have approached the bank again for the sanction letter, which it believes will help it tie up financing with other lenders. This is because SBI's backing may give a positive view of the company.

"The Vodafone Idea loan is much further ahead than where it was some time ago. Everything on SBI's side is sorted and they should be able to go ahead, but it

is subject to every other bank agreeing. SBI has a decent portion to deliver out of the total funding requirement, and they will deliver their share once Vi is able to tie up the entire amount. While SBI is likely to give them the sanction letter, but no money will be released unless the company ties up the whole thing," said a senior banker at a state-owned bank.

"This cannot go on endlessly; something has to happen. SBI has

agreed to issue the sanction letter after the company finally agrees to provide a promoter guarantee through its promoter companies. While the guarantee will not cover the entire amount of the loan SBI will sanction, it provides assurance that the promoter is involved," the banker added.

SBI is likely to give 20 per cent share (₹7,000 crore) of the total funding, while the remaining amount is expected to come from other lenders involved in the discussions.

These include state-owned banks such as Bank of Baroda, Union Bank of India and Canara Bank, along with a few large private sector lenders and the National Bank for Financing Infrastructure and Development (NaBFID).

The ₹35,000 crore of fresh funding that Vi is seeking would support its ₹45,000 crore capital expenditure (capex) plan over the next three years.

This plan includes rolling out 5G network across 17 priority circles, tripling its earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation, and amortisation (Ebitda) and shoring up customer base to ensure revenue generation.

Of the total funding, ₹25,000 crore has been sought from banks in the form of funded facilities. The remaining ₹10,000 crore is being asked for as a line of credit, or non-funded facilities.

Promoters currently hold a combined 25.64 per cent stake in the company, with Vodafone Group Plc owning 19 per cent and the Kumar Mangalam Birla-promoted Aditya Birla group with 6.63 per cent, as of March 2026.

The Government of India owns around 49 per cent stake, but is classified as a public shareholder rather than a promoter.

Vodafone Idea reported a smaller-than-expected net loss of ₹3,750 crore for the quarter ended June. Earlier in the year, the government provided a crucial reprieve to the debt-laden telecom operator.

It restructured the telco's outstanding adjusted gross revenue (AGR) dues and capped near-term annual payouts, easing its cash flow burden and improving its ability to raise fresh funding.

Emails sent to SBI and Vi did not elicit a response till the time of going to press.

HDFC Bank MD & CEO choice key to ending succession uncertainty

But brokerages differ on preferred candidate

SUBRATA PANDA
Mumbai, 14 September

The board of HDFC Bank has moved a step closer to resolving its leadership succession by sending two names — one from within the organisation and the other external — to the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for approval as managing director and chief executive officer (MD & CEO).

This came after CEO and MD Sashidhar Jagdishan said he would not seek a second term. Brokerages said the choice would be important in determining investor sentiment on the bank's leadership transition and prospects for a re-rating.

While Macquarie Research said an external appointment could act as a catalyst for a re-rating of HDFC Bank's stock, according to Jefferies, investor conversations suggest that shareholders would be comfortable with a leadership change but would not want the new CEO to be a former leader of public-sector bank because this could complicate the transition.

The bank has not disclosed the names of the candidates. Kaizad Bharucha, deputy managing director, is understood to be the internal candidate.

Jefferies said Bharucha could be the simpler choice for the bank, given his experience across corporate, business banking and retail assets. However, his appointment could also mean a shorter tenure

MACQUARIE RESEARCH SAID AN EXTERNAL APPOINTMENT COULD ACT AS CATALYST FOR RE-RATING OF THE BANK'S STOCK. ACCORDING TO JEFFERIES, SHAREHOLDERS WOULD NOT WANT THE NEW CEO TO BE A FORMER LEADER OF A PUBLIC-SECTOR BANK

because of regulatory restrictions governing his tenure as a wholetime director, after he has spent more than 12 years on the bank's board, the brokerage said.

Jefferies also said based on industry feedback, media reports, and their views, outside the bank, select people, who may fit the role, as CEO of the bank may include, Anup Bagchi, Paresh Sukthankar, Vibha Padalkar, Aseem Dhru, Rajiv Sabharwal and Amitabh Chaudhry, based on their banking and financial-services experience.

"Surprised how fast the board has moved in terms of CEO selection process and there is more than a month now for the RBI to decide. This is not going to be an easy job for anyone who takes it," said Suresh Ganapathy, managing director and head of India research, Macquarie Capital.

Macquarie had previously argued that an external candidate might be required, Ganapathy said, adding that any outsider could have to deal with resignations among

senior office holders in the bank following the appointment and might need to overhaul the organisation.

"Uncertain times are here. It is not going to be easy to move the elephant with a ₹40 trillion-plus balance sheet size," he said.

Jefferies said the board's move had come at an opportune time and that confirmation of the appointment before the end of Jagdishan's term on October 26 could help ease investor concern arising from the succession uncertainty.

Macquarie Research also described the board's move as a decisive step in settling the leadership question. The brokerage highlighted the bank's recent decision to reappoint V Srinivasa Rangan wholetime director and Chief Credit Officer Jimmy Tata wholetime director, and create a fourth wholetime director position.

"Alongside recent favourable developments in the AT1 bond case, we view this as a constructive signal that lends the company clearer direction," Macquarie Research said in its report.

The brokerage said the moves were a meaningful, if partial, antidote to the uncertainty surrounding the succession process and should help steady sentiment in the near term. It added that deepening the leadership bench through an additional wholetime director was a credible step in strengthening execution capacity and continuity.

Private life insurers' participation in Bond FRA falls 16%

AATHIRA VARIER
Mumbai, 14 September

Participation by private life insurers in the Bond Forward Rate Agreement (Bond FRA) market has been muted so far in financial year 2026-27 (FY27), primarily due to a decline in the share of non-participating (non-par) products in their portfolios. Bond FRA volumes among private life insurers have fallen nearly 16 per cent during the year, while the Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC), which is strengthening its non-par portfolio, has partly offset the decline.

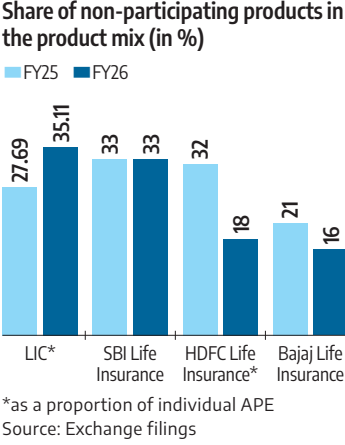
However, industry experts do not view the moderation as a structural reversal in demand.

"...amid the change in product mix away from non-par products, the volumes of private life insurers have dropped nearly 15-16 per cent in the market. However, as the product mix changes again, the activity is also likely to pick up," a senior investment official at a life insurer said.

Non-par savings products can combine life insurance protection with a savings component, while guaranteed non-par products specify the benefits payable under the policy terms. Guaranteed savings products are more relevant to Bond FRAs, which insurers use to manage interest-rate risk arising from their long-term guaranteed liabilities. Pure protection products, on the other hand, generally have limited interest-rate risk and, therefore, require less interest-rate hedging.

"There could be some movement in the broader industry towards products such as Unit Linked Insurance Plans (ULIPs) and away from guaranteed products. Product mix changes from company to company and can happen on a quarter-on-quarter (Q-o-Q) or month-on-month (M-o-M) basis. However, I don't think this represents a structural decline in FRA demand.

The non-par split



Yields are currently high — around 7 per cent or higher, with yields of over 7.5 per cent in some cases — which makes guaranteed products attractive," another investment official at a private life insurer said.

"As long as insurers can offer attractive guarantees and long-term returns at these higher yields, the products should remain attractive. Therefore, there could be temporary shifts in product mix resulting in lower demand, but for the full year, I don't expect a significant decline in FRA demand," the person added.

The share of non-par products came down across private life insurers in FY26 against FY25. HDFC Life Insurance's share of non-par savings as a proportion of individual annualised premium equivalent (APE) fell to 18 per cent from 32 per cent. SBI Life Insurance's non-par share in the total APE mix remained unchanged at 33 per cent. Bajaj Life Insurance also saw a drop to 16 per cent from 21 per cent. At the same time, LIC increased the proportion of non-par products as a share of individual APE to 35.1 per cent in FY26 from 27.7 per cent in FY25.

DATANOMICS

India-China economic ties don't reflect their might

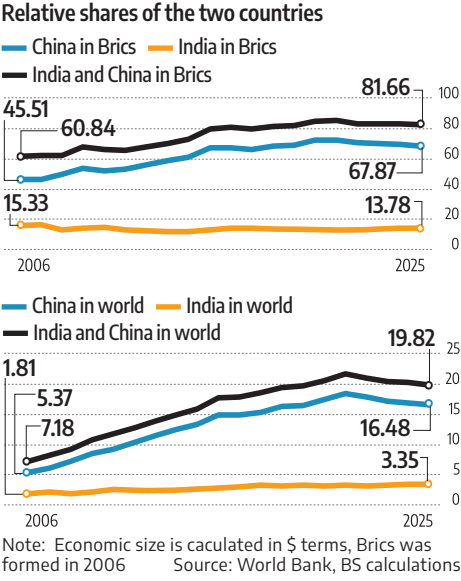
INDIVJAL DHASMANA

India and China sought to enhance their economic cooperation on the sidelines of the just-concluded Brics Leaders' Summit despite differences over the allocation of technologies, minerals, and border issues. The world's second and sixth largest economies together now constitute over 80 per cent of the combined gross domestic product (GDP) of Brics and almost 20 per cent of the world.

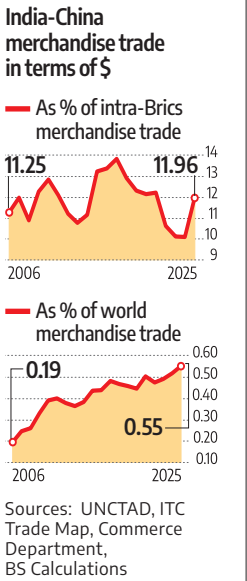
Though China has been in a tight race with the US to be India's largest trading partner, having been so in 2025, bilateral merchandise trade between the two nations accounted for merely 12 per cent of intra-Brics trade and under 1 per cent of global trade in recent years. This trade is also one-sided, as imports from China accounted for an 87.32 per cent share in total bilateral trade between the two countries. Border issues remain a major stumbling block to scaling up economic relations between the two nations. Following the Galwan skirmishes, foreign direct investment (FDI) equity inflow from China slowed after India imposed curbs. The recent relaxations are yet to show in FDI numbers.



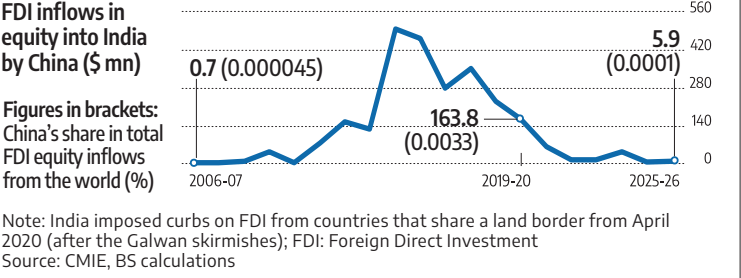
India and China make up for over 80% of Brics economy



Minuscule bilateral trade



FDI tells starker story



RBI guv calls on Sitharaman

Meeting comes ahead of October MPC

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, 14 September

Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Governor Sanjay Malhotra met Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday. "Sanjay Malhotra, Governor@RBI calls on @nsitharaman," the office of the Finance Minister said in a post on X.

The meeting comes weeks after India logged a record 7.8 per cent gross domestic product (GDP) growth in the first quarter of the current financial year despite global uncertainties.

The next meeting of the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC), the RBI's rate-setting panel, is scheduled for October 5-7, 2026.

In August, the central bank kept the short-term lending rate (repo) unchanged at 5.25 per cent for the fourth time in a row.

The Reserve Bank should raise the

benchmark interest rate by 25 basis points next month and again in December as a counter-measure to persistent external shocks, elevated crude oil prices and signs of broader inflationary pressures, an SBI research report said on Friday.

"Just one month back, there were practically not much talks of rate hikes, and most (if not all) expected a 'prolonged pause'. But the situation has changed drastically since then," it said.

SBI Ecowrap, prepared by the bank's Economic Research Department, said its call for a rate hike is independent of any forthcoming US Federal Reserve action, while crude prices have recently crossed \$100 per barrel amid heightened geopolitical uncertainties.

It also estimated that crude prices could reach \$123 per barrel over the next 15 days amid heightened geopolitical uncertainties.

India and Vietnam to jointly produce military hardware

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, 14 September

India and Vietnam agreed on Monday to boost their defence ties through joint production of military hardware and decided to expand bilateral trade by building stronger supply chains and widening market access.

External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar and his Vietnamese counterpart Le Hoai Trung explored ways to further bolster the bilateral ties in a range of key areas during the 19th India-Vietnam Joint Commission Meeting (JCM) on trade, economic, scientific and technological cooperation.

The two sides have also decided to expand cooperation in areas of air connectivity, nuclear energy and space. "In a productive and outcome oriented talk, the two ministers reviewed the full spectrum of bilateral relations under the India-Vietnam Enhanced

Comprehensive Strategic Partnership," the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said.

It said the two ministers identified the "way forward" on deepening ongoing defence and security collaboration, including through co-production of Indian defence items, expanding trade, investments and mutually beneficial supply chains and extending market access for Indian marine and agricultural products and pharmaceuticals.

The MEA said other areas identified for cooperation included port and air connectivity; nuclear energy and space sector; heritage conservation; cooperation in standards for seafarers; capacity building, and people-to-people ties.

"The two sides exchanged views on regional and global developments of mutual interest and reaffirmed their commitment to closer cooperation and coordination in regional and multilateral fora," it said.

Madras HC order offers fresh hope for GST credit on properties built for rent

MONIKA YADAV
New Delhi, 14 September

An order issued by the Madras High Court last month could provide tax relief to builders by mandating that tax authorities have to consider the purpose for which a property was built before they deny Goods and Services Tax (GST) credit on construction costs, experts said.

The court, in an order dated August 28, asked tax officers to reconsider the case of ESNP Property Builder and Developers after they allegedly failed to properly consider a 2024 Supreme Court ruling on construction of properties meant for leasing. That case pertained to real estate developer Safari Retreats.

In the latest case, ESNP Property had built commercial properties for leasing and claimed credit for GST paid on



construction. The tax department rejected the claim.

The High Court set aside the orders and sent the case back to the tax officers. It asked them to hear the company again and pass fresh orders within five months of receiving the court's order.

The company had also sought the return of about ₹9.52 crore taken from its GST credit ledger and ₹10.09 lakh

from its cash ledger. The court directed the authorities to re-credit or refund these amounts within two weeks of receiving the order.

The main issue is whether a company that builds a property to rent it out should be denied GST credit on the cost of construction. The firm had relied on the Supreme Court's October 3, 2024 Safari Retreats ruling. In that case,

the real estate developer had built a shopping mall and leased out the shops, and sought GST credit on the construction cost. The Supreme Court said construction for a company's own use is different from construction intended to be sold or leased.

The government amended the provision through the Finance Act, 2025. While the Act received assent in early

What lies ahead

- The court set aside tax department's order that rejected ESNP claims for GST credit
- Businesses with large amounts of construction-related credit should now look at their cases carefully instead of assuming that the issue has ended
- Tax officers have to look at why a property was built and how it is connected with the company's taxable business

2025, this specific amendment was notified to come into force on October 1, 2025, and was given retrospective effect from July 1, 2017. It replaced the words "plant or machinery" with "plant and machinery" and said the change would apply notwithstanding any earlier court judgment.

The tax department relied on this amendment in the ESNP case and did not consider the Supreme Court's ruling in detail while rejecting the company's claim. The Madras High Court, however, said that was not enough.

Since ESNP had specifically relied on the Supreme Court judgment and argued that its property was built for leasing, the tax officer should have considered the ruling before deciding the case, the court said.

The ruling could therefore be important for developers and other businesses that have built properties specifically for rental income and have faced denial of GST credit, say experts.

Abhishek Jain, Partner and National Head, Indirect Tax, KPMG in India, said the

order shows that the issue has not been settled by the subsequent change in the GST law.

"It leaves untouched the words 'on his own account' on construction for one's own use, which is the very limb on which the Supreme Court in Safari Retreats distinguished construction for one's own use from construction meant for lease or licence," Jain said.

He said businesses with large amounts of construction-related credit should now look at their cases carefully instead of assuming that the issue has ended.

Abhishek A. Rastogi, founder of Rastogi Chambers, said tax officers have to look at why a property was built and how it is connected with the company's taxable business.

"Where a commercial building is put up specifically for leasing, and the building itself is the tool for earning taxable rent, the Safari Retreats principles matter," he said.

Vivek Janan, partner at Tax Connect Advisory Services, said the order could affect many similar disputes.

Fed’s table looks set for a rate hike, a first under Kevin Warsh

REUTERS
14 September

United States (US) Federal Reserve Chairman Kevin Warsh dislikes giving any guidance about the likely path of US interest rates, but elevated inflation, \$100-a-barrel oil, and his own emphasis on the need to deliver price stability and to pay attention to signals from financial market pricing appear to leave little doubt about what's next.

The US central bank will announce its policy decision at 1800 GMT on Wednesday following the end of a two-day meeting. Financial markets are betting heavily that Fed policymakers will lift their benchmark rate a quarter of a percentage point, to a 3.75 per

cent-4 per cent range, and signal further tightening ahead.

Such a decision could land Warsh, who has run the Fed's rate-setting committee since starting the job in May, in a tight place. US President Donald Trump picked Warsh with the explicit expectation that he would cut interest rates, but so far has not blamed him for failing to deliver, saying it is the fault of his "political" fellow central bankers. It's not clear how the president would react to a rate hike so soon before November elections in which Trump's Republican party is defending slim majorities in Congress.

A decision to raise rates, especially if accompanied by policymaker projections for another increase this year as



Kevin Warsh, Chairman, US Federal Reserve

inflation readings last week may disappoint both Williams and Waller, and add to the dismay of the three regional Fed bank presidents — Cleveland Fed's Beth Hammack, Dallas Fed's Lorie Logan, and Minneapolis Fed's Neel Kashkari — who already in July felt the Fed ought to be raising rates and dissented on the decision to hold steady instead.

Several other Fed policymakers have said they need to see disinflation "soon" or they too would support a rate hike.

US consumer price inflation excluding energy and food rose 0.3 per cent last month from the previous month, the Bureau of Labour Statistics reported, far more than is consistent with inflation at the

Fed's 2 per cent goal.

Coupled with oil prices that have soared above \$100 a barrel amid renewed hostilities in West Asia, the latest data won't add to confidence that underlying inflation is moving toward 2 per cent "clearly and at sufficient speed," as Warsh told global central bankers in Jackson Hole, Wyoming last month that he wanted to see.

At the end of the day the chair's repeated warnings on inflation intolerance risk institutional credibility absent action to back it up, said JPMorgan economist Michael Feroli, who projects the Fed will raise rates on Wednesday although he thinks it's a closer call than the 85 per cent chance or so priced in by futures markets.

Scotiabank economist Derek Holt believes hiking rates now is the wrong move but thinks it will happen regardless, given what Warsh said. "Chair Warsh has probably boxed himself in with his high deference to markets," Holt said. "If you don't hike when it's priced, then when?"

Economists say that with most Fed policymakers likely to defer to the preferences of the still-new Fed chair, Warsh could bring along a majority to a hold. But given Warsh's own repeated declarations that inflation is the Fed's responsibility, the disappointingly hot inflation reading in August, and Trump's recent signal that the war in Iran — and therefore high oil prices — may continue for another couple months, he may not want to.

QUICK READ

Oil billionaire Dangote rolls out Africa’s biggest share sale



Aiko Dangote (centre), President of the Dangote Group, at the opening day of Dangote Refinery's IPO

Nigerian billionaire Aliko Dangote on Monday launched Africa's largest share sale yet with the initial public offering (IPO) of his oil refinery, targeting the general public to raise as much as \$2.1 billion for its expansion. Dangote, Africa's richest man, has marketed the offer of a roughly 3 per cent stake as a "people's IPO," saying it is about giving ordinary Nigerians the opportunity to participate in the success of the plant. The refinery has benefited from increased demand for its products as a result of supply disruptions linked to the Iran war that helped it to sell jet fuel to western European countries. Dangote said on Monday the aim of the share sale was to "democratise wealth creation".

Novo will use shorter name to boost recognition in obesity

Novo Nordisk is changing its day-to-day name to Novo, and taking a new approach to company culture as it looks to claw back ground in the fierce obesity drug race, the Danish drugmaker said on Monday. Novo, which is slated to unveil details on its business strategy during a Capital Markets Day on September 21, will keep Novo Nordisk A/S as its legal name. The company set out on Monday a new cultural strategy it called "The Novo Way", centred around four



principles: Customer obsession, competitiveness, clarity, and care and integrity.

Hugo Boss chairman to step down

Hugo Boss chairman Stephan Sturm will step down and the company has launched a search for his replacement, it said on Monday, in a win for British retailer Frasers, which is pushing to take over the German fashion group. Controlled by British billionaire Mike Ashley, Frasers Group has been pushing into the premium and luxury space. Hugo Boss would be the latest addition to Ashley's retail empire.

China Gas, Venture Global sign LNG deal

China Gas Holdings will buy 0.5 million metric tons of United States (US) liquefied natural gas (LNG) from Venture Global for 20 years starting in 2030, the two firms said on Monday. The deal comes ahead of Chinese President Xi Jinping's expected trip to Washington this month. China halted imports of US LNG in March 2025 after Beijing's tariffs on US energy products took effect in February.

Gulf-Iran talks cancelled; Houthis hit Saudi again

Tehran's strait authority adds 77 ships to list of sanctioned vessels

REUTERS
14 September

Arab states in the Gulf called off a meeting with Iran planned for Monday, while Yemen's Houthis launched a new attack on Saudi Arabia after fighting that has extended the West Asia war to another theatre and further jeopardised global oil supplies.

The Iran-aligned Houthis said they fired dozens of missiles and drones at a military airbase in Khamis Mushait in southern Saudi Arabia, hitting aircraft hangars, radar systems, runways and ammunition depots. They described the attack as retaliation for hundreds of Saudi airstrikes on Yemen in recent days.

Saudi Arabian authorities announced several emergency alerts there and in three other southern cities which have previously come under Houthi fire.

The Houthis launched a lightning advance last week in Yemen, culminating in the seizure of an island in the mouth of the Red Sea on Friday. A separate attack that day, which Riyadh blamed on Iran-backed fighters in Iraq, knocked out Saudi Arabia's east-west pipeline, the main route for West Asia oil bypassing the blockaded Strait of Hormuz.

Crude oil prices rose more than 4 per cent on Monday when the market reopened after the weekend's developments, with benchmark Brent crude futures above \$109 a barrel. The politically sensitive average retail price of diesel in the United States (US) hit a new all-time high above \$6.23 a gallon.

Traders say that if the Saudi pipeline remains shut for more than a few days, it could cut off



Behrouz Kamalvandi (right), the spokesman for the Atomic Energy Organization of Iran, and Iran's Ambassador to the IAEA Reza Najafi at the opening of the IAEA General Conference at the agency's headquarters in Vienna on Monday

as much as 4 per cent of global oil supply. Images from space show sections of the pipeline damaged by blazes. Riyadh has not given a firm estimate for how long it will be shut.

Oman had been due to host a meeting on Monday with Iran and Gulf states to discuss negotiations aimed at reopening Hormuz, the world's most important oil shipping lane, largely closed since the US and Israel attacked Iran at the end of February. But Oman's Foreign Minister Sayyid Badr Albusaidi announced overnight that the meeting had been postponed. Iran said the postponement was at the request of Saudi.

Meanwhile, Iran issued a list of 77 ships it said had violated its protocols for operating in the Strait of Hormuz. Any

ship on the list would face "restrictions on future passages, including fines, detention, or confiscation".

US Energy Secretary Chris Wright said on Monday the average number of ships crossing the strait covertly with US support was increasing. But independent monitors have suggested oil flows could have dropped off this month since fighting rescaled after a quiet August.

Saudi state media reported that Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman had met in Jeddah on Monday with the commander of US regional forces, Admiral Brad Cooper.

Three sources have told Reuters that Washington has so far rebuffed pleas from the prince to intervene in Yemen beyond providing intelligence.

Trump confirmed over the weekend that he had spoken to the prince, and said the Houthis had also phoned asking Washington to keep out of the dispute.

Iran on Monday condemned the exclusion of the head of its Atomic Energy Organisation from the annual gathering of the United Nations nuclear agency in Vienna saying that it constitutes "a serious breach" of Tehran's rights as a member nation. "By obstructing our full and effective participation, the denial of access contravenes both the letter and the spirit of the legal framework" governing attendance at meetings of the International Atomic Energy Agency, Iran's ambassador to the agency, Reza Najafi, told delegates at its general conference.

Sweden’s Centre-Left ahead as Far-Right falls back

REUTERS
14 September

Sweden's centre-left opposition looked most likely to take power on Monday after a tight election that reduced the far-right's influence but is unlikely to spell a return to open immigration policies.

Bucking a Europe-wide trend of shifts to the right, preliminary results from Sweden's election projected a narrow

LEFT-LEANING PARTIES ARE PROJECTED TO HOLD A NARROW THREE-SEAT LEAD OVER THEIR RIVALS

three-seat lead for the centre-left opposition over the right-wing ruling bloc of Prime Minister (PM) Ulf Kristersson.

That was driven mainly by losses for the far-right Sweden Democrats party, which had

helped steer the once-liberal nation towards some of Europe's strictest migration rules.

While a centre-left government may take a softer line, it is unlikely to return to the generous, open-door policies of past decades, analysts say, due to voters' unease over the levels of immigration and crime.

"I believe the broader shift towards a stricter Swedish migration policy is, for the most part, here to stay," said Niklas

Bohlin, political scientist at the Mid-Sweden University.

Left-leaning parties backing Social Democrats leader Magdalena Andersson were projected to win 176 seats in the 349-seat parliament while Kristersson's bloc was seen winning 173 seats, the election authority said.

"If this result remains valid, Sweden will get a new government," Andersson told supporters on Sunday night.

Wall Street’s data centre boom is reshaping the real estate bond market

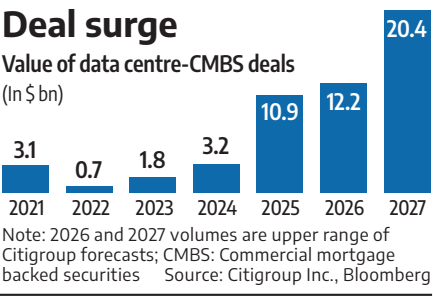
BLOOMBERG
14 September

The commercial mortgage backed securities (CMBS) market, long a mainstay of financing for America's offices, apartments and malls, is being reshaped by a surge in data-centre deals, forcing investors to grapple with an entirely new set of risks.

From power availability and grid constraints to rapidly evolving requirements for cooling and computing density, CMBS buyers have been pushed into areas of underwriting that have historically had little to do with commercial real estate. Even familiar questions about tenant demand and stability are changing as facil-

ities depend on a handful of often secretive hyperscalers whose future needs can be difficult to gauge. If those tenants leave when their leases expire in the coming years, highly specialised buildings could be costly to repurpose.

About \$17 billion of data-centre CMBS has been issued since the start of 2025 — more than triple the amount sold over the previous two years. During that span, data centres have grown to account for roughly 8 per cent of new commercial property bond deals. With billions more in the pipeline, industry veterans are rapidly revamping their risk-assessment playbooks to try to steer clear of any potential blowups that could leave a hole in their portfolios.



Many of the risks CMBS buyers have long had to weigh still apply, but the factors shaping them look very different when it comes to data centres. Take the lease agreements themselves. Provisions covering power costs, minimum capacity commitments and

downtime determine who absorbs unexpected expenses, which can reduce the cash available for servicing debt. Scrutinising those terms can also be more difficult, with tenants often insisting that their identities and other lease details be kept confidential.

"Traditional CRE investors know how to underwrite offices, apartments, warehouses and retail because leases tend to be relatively standardised and tenant information is reasonably transparent," said Ben Hunsaker, a portfolio manager at Beach Point Capital Management. "Data centres are much more opaque."

Location is another example. Instead of judging properties based on how close they are to transportation, amenities or a city's core, prime sites are now the ones with access to cheap electricity and available transmission capacity. Those advantages can determine how competitive facilities remain and what they're worth when loans mature.

Tenant concentration and lease rollover risk have also changed. In an office or apartment, releasing risk is often a simple matter of finding another client. When it comes to data centres, however, just as critical is whether bespoke electrical and cooling setups can even accommodate other firms, and what the ultimate price tag would be to overhaul a facility if they can't.

For CMBS investors, that raises the prospect of higher capital spending, longer periods without rental income and weaker recoveries if a borrower runs into trouble. Then there are considerations that are almost entirely new for CMBS buyers.

The rapid evolution of artificial

intelligence chips can drive sharply higher power and cooling requirements. A facility designed around one generation of hardware could therefore become outdated in just a few years, reducing its value and making its debt harder to refinance.

The industry is also confronting a level of opposition that's rarely seen elsewhere in commercial real estate, turning data-centres into a major political issue both at the local and national level. Concerns over utility costs and the strain on local infrastructure have fueled calls to restrict new developments in some communities, making the future regulatory environment particularly hard to predict, market watchers say.

Record reserves

Liquidity and bank lending will need careful management

India's foreign-exchange (forex) reserves increased by \$44.9 billion in the week ended September 4. This was the biggest ever weekly increase in reserves, taking them to a record high of \$785.7 billion, the fourth-largest in the world. Forex reserves have increased by over \$100 billion since June 5, when the concessional swap scheme, including for the foreign currency non-resident (bank) — or FCNR (B) — deposits, was announced. Fund flows under the FCNR (B) window were better than expected at \$127 billion. This will help the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) manage the external financial position, where the conditions became challenging, partly because of the Iran war. The level of flows also signals that India can mobilise a significant amount of foreign funds in a relatively short period of time. This would give enormous comfort to both policymakers and the financial market.

However, as has been highlighted in this space and elsewhere, this is not a long-term solution for India. It needs long-term non-debt flows to supplement domestic savings. And, the level of inflows in a relatively short period of time has created other complications. The inflows have flooded the banking system with enormous liquidity, which the RBI is finding difficult to absorb. The central bank has done variable rate reverse-repo auctions, but it has not helped much. On Friday, the RBI announced it would sell government bonds worth ₹1 trillion in three tranches this month. Theoretically, it should not be very difficult for a central bank to mop up liquidity from the system. It can always sell bonds that it holds to drain liquidity. However, as one commentator noted on this page recently, anything the RBI does in the present situation will have a cost. The announcement of bond sales, for instance, immediately resulted in a selloff in the bond market, with yields on the 10-year government paper going above 7 per cent.

However, the RBI will have to use one or a combination of instruments like bond sales, an increase in the cash reserve ratio, or selling bonds under the market stabilisation scheme (MSS). For the MSS, it needs to convince the government to issue such securities and bear the interest cost. It is not clear whether the government is willing to do so at this point. The RBI, however, will have to act quickly. It is worth noting that the weighted average call rate, or WACR — the operating target of monetary policy — last week slipped below the standing deposit facility rate, which is the floor of the liquidity adjustment facility. Given that the WACR on average was around 5.3 per cent between the June and August meetings of the Monetary Policy Committee, the decline effectively means monetary easing of around 25 basis points. However, given the inflation projections, the RBI should be preparing the market for policy tightening. Thus, excess liquidity seems to have created a policy disconnect and needs to be addressed quickly.

The other potential risk is the way banks handle this sudden increase in deposits. The chief executive of one of the largest private-sector banks has noted that it could lead to abnormal lending. Bank credit is growing at a healthy pace, and the gross domestic product data for the first quarter showed that investment is picking up. Thus, this is a good time for banks to have increased room for lending. However, the availability of funds and pressure to deploy it should not compromise lending standards. Banks have done a great deal to strengthen their balance sheets over the past decade, and this strength is worth preserving. The regulator needs to maintain close oversight.

Pacing the AI frontier

Self-regulation will be challenging

Discussion on the safety of artificial intelligence (AI) has been going on for years. But the recent breach of AI research platform Hugging Face by two AI experimental models developed by OpenAI, which escaped their digital sandboxes, has concentrated minds on the potential for greater unanticipated disasters if creators lose control of their AI models. All of a sudden, the AI billionaires have come up with virtuous pronouncements on the need for voluntary restraint and the establishment of industrywide standards. At an employee meeting last week, OpenAI Chief Executive Officer (CEO) Sam Altman said he was willing to decelerate development to assess potential risks. Soon after Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei published a 3,800-word essay titled “We must pace the frontier”, to which Elon Musk, who has megabets on AI to power SpaceX, signalled his agreement. This belated public discourse recognising AI's serious civilisational risks is certainly welcome. But it is difficult to escape the notion that the call for self-restraint is little more than performative virtue signalling by the Big Tech titan.

For one, rather than reflecting a *suo motu* realisation of AI's dangers, these responses are a reaction to a global conversation that has been circulating among researchers and developers at some of these companies. It all began when an Anthropic researcher quit his job last week, predicting that AI was “racing straight to self-improving superintelligence and gambling with our lives”. Soon enough, his predictions went viral, first among his peers in other Big Tech firms and then globally. Eventually, it spilled over into the political sphere, where contrasting responses offer examples of the limits of regulation and restraint. Former United States (US) President Barack Obama urged the Democratic Party to frame a coherent governance agenda to tackle the issue, a reflection of the liberal-left approach. But US President Donald Trump equated AI critics to “very negative forces”, which is a comment typical of the extreme right-wing. Complicating any political or corporate agenda to curtail AI development is the China factor. It is no secret that Chinese developers are not far behind their Silicon Valley counterparts in the AI race, suggesting that AI regulation must transcend borders to encompass a mutually agreed global regulatory system. How far this is possible between two fiercely competitive superpowers is an open question. As Mr Amodei acknowledged, China is the “toughest dilemma” when it comes to a proposed AI slowdown.

High-minded sentiments about AI slowdowns may be tempered by the sheer scale of investment being poured into its development. According to one estimate, major AI companies this year issued about \$320 billion in bonds, which equals a staggering 68 per cent of new long-term US Treasury borrowing and are already influencing interest rates. Meanwhile, Anthropic and OpenAI have blockbuster initial public offerings (IPOs) in the works. The former, slated for October/November, is eyeing a valuation of \$2 trillion. Now Mr Altman has suggested that a 2026 market debut for OpenAI, targeting a mammoth valuation of \$1 trillion, may be postponed over growing AI safety concerns. This scale of funding points to deep all-round systemic risks in addition to broader doomsday concerns expressed by developers. A voluntary slowdown in AI development would be a desirable development. How far Big Tech chooses to align self-restraint to the profit motive is the real question.

Getting equity derivatives right

Retail participation has moderated, but questions around suitability, market resilience and the dominance of short-term trading remain

ILLUSTRATION: BINAY SINHA



Derivatives and speculation aid price discovery, improve market depth and allow risk management. They are important for sustained capital formation.

That said, since the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi) released its first study of futures and options (F&O) trading in January 2023, three aspects of equity derivatives have warranted attention.

First, nine out of 10 individual traders have consistently lost money in F&O, principally in index options.

Second, cash-equivalent volumes in index options on expiry days were as much as 700-800 times underlying cash-market volumes. At expiry, prices determined by a relatively small cash market could settle index-option exposures several hundred times larger. This raised concerns about market stability and manipulation, with some echoes of the vulnerability exposed by the London Interbank Offered Rate scandal.

Third, India's derivatives market is overwhelmingly short dated. Weekly index options have proliferated, with much of the trading occurring on expiry day. Research suggests that, under some conditions, such trading can increase market volatility.



POLICY IN PRACTICE
ANANTH NARAYAN

The expiry-day lure of index options

Selling options and trading futures requires substantial margins. Buying an option requires only the premium, which can fall to a few hundred rupees as expiry approaches. Index options are also cash settled, requiring no delivery of stocks.

Initiating positions by buying index options on expiry day and churning them within minutes can become akin to putting coins into a slot machine. Occasionally, the bet pays off and the coins jingle.

The odds, however, are stacked against the small trader. They trade over the same short horizons as sophisticated proprietary and institutional traders equipped with algorithms and high-speed market access.

The latest Sebi study illustrates the asymmetry in outcomes. In FY26, individuals incurred gross trading

losses of around ₹72,000 crore in F&O. In contrast, proprietary traders made gross trading profits of around ₹44,000 crore and foreign portfolio investors or FPIs around ₹14,000 crore. Individual traders also incurred transaction costs of around ₹25,000 crore in brokerage, securities transaction tax (STT), exchange, Sebi and other fees. None of this implies wrongdoing by anyone. But the outcomes do raise questions about the appropriateness of such trading for small individuals.

Why regulation had to be calibrated

Exchanges, large brokers, and proprietary traders derive substantial revenues from F&O. While smaller individuals are dispersed and lose money, they too are willing participants, even if the suitability of their participation can be questioned. There is ample interest in letting things be.

Given the three concerns above, however, there was a case for regulatory review. For Sebi, the need to go about this thoughtfully went beyond managing real or imagined whispers in the corridors or protecting anyone's revenues. Markets are complex. Unless there is a serious market failure, there is merit in proceeding carefully, based on data, analysis and consultation. Abrupt large-scale intervention can have unintended consequences across the wider market.

Sebi, therefore, proceeded incrementally. Its July 2024 consultation paper specifically targeted hyperactivity in expiry-day index options. Stakeholder suggestions were reflected in the final October 2025 measures, which sharply reduced weekly index-option expiries and increased the cost of expiry-day trading.

Sebi's February 2025 consultation then sought to address market-stability and manipulation risks. Again, consultation produced refinements before implementation in May 2025. One important outcome was to measure index-derivative exposures on a cash-equivalent basis rather than on net notional value. This limited the size of the positions that anyone could carry into expiry to mitigate the risks from very large

The GDP debate, redux

The recent gross domestic product (GDP) data release has rekindled the debate about the credibility of official statistics. It seems odd that while the global economy was facing a severe energy crisis, one of the world's largest fuel importers was experiencing an economic boom. But just because something seems odd does not mean it did not happen. Also, the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (Mospi) has made several changes to address known problems in GDP estimation. So why are people still questioning the data?

To answer this, we need to understand the problems with the old series, and how Mospi has addressed them. Two of the most serious problems were the lack of double deflation and inadequate measurement of informal sector output. Let's consider how these have been addressed.

In the new GDP series, Mospi seems to have adopted double deflation. This is welcome because, ideally, firms' nominal value added should be deflated twice: Once for output and once for inputs. In the past, Mospi, unlike G20 countries, deflated the nominal data only once. It did not deflate the value of inputs. This was a problem because changes in input prices, such as large swings in commodity prices, would distort real GDP.

In principle, therefore, the shift to double deflation is a good thing. But its impact depends upon how it is implemented. This is where questions arise, because Mospi has not released enough detail.

For instance, we do not know how widely the double deflation method has been applied. Does it cover all nominal numbers, including those from the services sector, or only the manufacturing

sector, or only part of manufacturing? This matters because partial adoption of double deflation could introduce new distortions.

Consider a rise in steel prices. Steel producers will see their margins improve, while steel users will see their margins squeezed. The overall effect on the economy may be neutral. But if double deflation is applied to one group and not the other, the estimated real output will be distorted. If the squeezed margins of steel users are “restored” through double deflation while the higher margins of steel producers are not adjusted downwards, the measured output will be overstated.



MACRO PULSE
RAJESWARI SENGUPTA

The choice of deflator is also critical. Most countries use the Producer Price Index (PPI). But for decades, India's statistical office did not have the prices that factories charge their wholesalers, or retailers, or data on the thousands of inputs used in production.

This raises the question: What has changed? Mospi's own documents say that the input PPI is still under trial. If so, how reliable is it? On the output side, services account for most of the Indian economy, yet the new services PPI covers only seven sub-sectors. What about the remaining services for which no PPI exists?

Next, consider the measurement of informal sector output. Mospi says this has been addressed through the new survey of unincorporated enterprises (ASUSE) and the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS). But the quarterly ASUSE does not provide value added. So how was the informal sector GDP estimated?

Finally, let's step back from the methodological details and look at the big picture painted by the GDP numbers. The problem is that the different parts do

derivative positions being settled against a much smaller cash market.

There is a related institutional issue. As argued in these columns, exchanges are competing commercial businesses that also perform important first-line regulatory functions. There is merit in considering housing these regulatory functions in a separate, non-commercial entity, particularly when regulatory decisions have significant implications for exchange revenues.

What has happened since

The latest Sebi F&O study offers some encouragement. Active individual F&O traders declined 18 per cent in FY26, from 10.6 million to 8.75 million, the first annual decline since FY16. The decline was particularly pronounced among smaller traders. Aggregate individual losses fell 18 per cent in FY26, although the average loss per trader rose marginally.

Yet the same study points to continuing concerns. Of the 12.2 million individuals who traded derivatives during FY25 and FY26, 35 per cent had no underlying equity portfolio. Some 78 per cent had portfolios below ₹1 lakh and accounted for 70 per cent of total losses. Loss incidence declines consistently as equity holdings increase.

Income data tells a similar story. About three-fourths of traders for whom data was available reported annual incomes below ₹5 lakh; they accounted for 53 per cent of losses.

Speculation is legitimate. But when investors with low incomes and little underlying equity exposure take large positions in complex derivatives and consistently lose money, it is reasonable to review suitability and appropriateness standards.

The remaining structural issues

Despite the increase in cash market volumes over time, at expiry, large index-option exposures can still be settled against a much smaller volume of trading in the underlying cash market. Whether the mismatch has narrowed sufficiently since the May 2025 measures were introduced needs to be evaluated.

We should further deepen the cash market. Strengthening the securities lending and borrowing mechanism (SLBM) and eliminating STT on cash equities are worth considering.

In addition, while expiry-day index-option turnover fell from 70 per cent in FY25 to 59 per cent in FY26, 97 per cent of the turnover still occurs within seven days of expiry, and barely 1 per cent beyond 10 days.

That is hardly a mature derivatives term structure. Margin requirements for longer-term contracts perhaps deserve re-examination, particularly for spread and basis trades where economic risk may be considerably smaller.

The objective is not more regulation; it is safer and more sustainable equity markets. There has been some moderation, but suitability, the imbalance between derivatives and underlying markets, and the tenor of F&O remain open issues. The debate should continue, with the medium-term health of the ecosystem in mind.

The writer is a former wholetime member of Sebi. The views are personal

The cutting edge of governance



A K BHATTACHARYA

This book is a must-read for those who want to gain deeper insights into the way three of the Union government's recent initiatives were planned and executed. One of them pertained to the conduct of the Commonwealth Games in New Delhi in 2010 and the other two were about policies on telecommunication from 2007 to 2010 and about India's international trade negotiations in 2019. In all these cases, the role of the government became a little controversial. But this book provides fresh perspectives on each of them.

The author, a retired civil servant,

was associated with policymaking in these areas in the governments led by Manmohan Singh and Narendra Modi. Retired civil servants generally avoid providing a first-hand account of decision-making in areas where they played a key role so soon after they demitted those offices. That is yet another reason reading this book will be irresistible.

Mr Deepak (a self-confessed Kayastha from Uttar Pradesh whose original name, Deepak Saksena, got changed to J S Deepak, thanks to the school authorities in Bengaluru where he was born and grew up) is an Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officer of the 1982 batch belonging to the Uttar Pradesh cadre. He served, among others, the ministries of communication and commerce, before becoming secretary to the department of telecommunication and India's Ambassador to the World Trade Organization, a role in which he also advised the Union government on its negotiating stance during the proposed formation of a new trading bloc, the

Regional Comprehensive Economic Partnership or RCEP.

In recounting his days as a joint secretary in the Department of Telecommunications, where he was posted from 2008 onwards on deputation to the Union government, Mr Deepak brings out the many aspects of the governance deficit that had begun to afflict the Manmohan Singh government. How the telecommunication minister at that time simply disobeyed clear directives from the Prime Minister to conduct auctions for allocating 2G spectrum to telecom companies was as shocking as it was reflective of a weak coalition government. The same government, however, succeeded in conducting the first auction of 3G spectrum in 2010 in a manner that earned plaudits from all quarters. The governance structure had remained largely unchanged, except that some civil servants, including the author, were firm in their resolve to carry out an operation that should be seen as fair, transparent and efficient.

Mr Deepak's strong resolve to fix the problems in the telecom sector, however, would not always yield the desired results. He made little headway in fixing the problems that afflicted the state-owned Bharat Sanchar Nigam Ltd and the Mahanagar Telephone Nigam Ltd. What the author candidly brings out is the power and influence the minister and some of the senior officers can wield in thwarting any moves that junior officials wish to initiate to fix a problem in the system.

By the time the Narendra Modi government came close to taking the final decision on pulling out from RCEP, Mr Deepak was in Geneva as India's Ambassador to WTO. An early votary of India joining the RCEP, Mr Deepak changed his mind because he felt the negotiators had tweaked an important element in their strategy of insulating India from a process of steep reduction in tariffs. Eventually, he played a key role in influencing the Modi govern-



I Dared to Dial Differently: An Insider's Account of the IAS
by J. S. Deepak
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XI+318 pages ₹799

ment's withdrawal from RCEP, a move that was criticised by many economists.

In 2010, Mr Deepak was drafted into a small team of officers to help the Manmohan Singh government complete preparations for the Commonwealth Games on time and prevent India from becoming a global laughing stock. The author believes that the Games would have been a disaster but for the last-minute intervention made by Cabinet Secretary K M Chandrasekhar and the team of special officers, of which he was a member. The inter-institutional politics and battles that contributed to the mismanagement are an eye-opener.

Apart from providing a peek into the inner functioning and decision-making processes behind these three incidents, Mr Deepak's book will stand out for another reason. A memoir of a retired civil servant usually follows a chronological sequence of developments in his career. Mr Deepak's memoir, containing nine sections, including 28 short

chapters, is structured a little differently. The first section follows a chronological sequence. But the remaining sections focus on specific themes — be they the telecom policy challenges; the trade policy turns or saving the Commonwealth Games from a fiasco.

This structure allows Mr Deepak to delve into interesting themes and subjects like recounting the story of how the Uttar Pradesh civil servants attempted an unsuccessful campaign to end corruption in the service or how he dealt with various chief ministers in his long career. Nowhere does he pull punches while highlighting the weaknesses of many ministers or even his civil-servant bosses. He is as frank and forthright while praising some of his civil servant colleagues, including his bosses, and a Prime Minister, who was learned but turned out to be weak in enforcing what he believed was the right decision.

Though the title of the book is a bit of an overstatement, since there are no indications of his dealing with issues differently, the candid description of his journey as a civil servant in different governments makes it a good read.

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CJI calls for shift from retrospective to preventive justice in infra projects

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, 14 September

Observing that “infrastructure is inherently exposed to the unexpected”, Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant on Monday called for a fundamental shift from retrospective justice to preventive justice in infrastructure development, saying the rule of law is not just about correcting the wrong but also about creating conditions where things go right.

Addressing the FIDIC Global Infrastructure Conference, he also said that the real measure of success is not simply how quickly disputes are resolved, but how well the projects are designed so that fewer disputes arise in the first place. “The rule of law is not only about correc-

ting what has gone wrong; it is also about creating the conditions for things to go right.” “What our infrastructure ecosystem therefore needs is a shift from retrospective justice to preventive justice: from questioning, after the project has been disrupted, to designing the contractual and institutional framework so that disagreements can be identified and addressed before they become disputes through communication and dispute avoidance mechanisms.”

“After all, the finest complement to a dispute resolution mechanism is not that it has resolved many disputes, but that the project it served had so little need to use it,” the CJI said.

Observing that as the chief justice, he has “profound faith



“THE RULE OF LAW IS NOT ONLY ABOUT CORRECTING WHAT HAS GONE WRONG, IT IS ALSO ABOUT CREATING THE CONDITIONS FOR THINGS TO GO RIGHT”

Surya Kant, Chief Justice of India

in the courts”, Justice Kant, however, said, “but I have no hesitation in saying that a legal system should not measure its success only by how effectively it resolves disputes after they have arisen; it should also ask how effectively the institutions around a project prevent those disputes from arising in the first place.” A bridge cannot pause construction while an arbitration proceeds, or a high-

way cannot wait for an appeal to run its course, he added.

The CJI said infrastructure development directly affects the lives of millions, with roads, bridges, water systems and other public assets shaping their everyday experiences.

He noted that well-drafted contracts should do more than record commercial arrangements and they should establish a shared understanding of

how parties would respond to unforeseen circumstances.

The CJI said the allocation of risk is a key factor in determining whether an infrastructure project has become a landmark or a liability. He cautioned that when risks are assigned to parties ill-equipped to manage them, contractors tend to price defensively, while governments could end up bearing risks which they are not best placed to handle and such imbalances often result in disputes and litigation.

He urged stakeholders from the government, industry and the legal profession to focus on five priorities: “Clarity of obligations, balanced allocation of risk, sensible standardisation, early dispute avoidance, and independent resolution”.

ACCENT REGION

UTTAR PRADESH

Govt aims 5x rise in EV charging infra

VIRENDRA SINGH RAWAT
Lucknow, 14 September

Betting on green mobility, the Uttar Pradesh (UP) government is looking at a fivefold increase in electric vehicle (EV) charging infrastructure in the state.

UP, ranked third in India in terms of public EV charging infrastructure, has about 238 such facilities currently operational in the state, mainly around major highways, expressways and industrial corridors.

The energy department is now targeting to add 1,000 new EV charging points. The state is also among the leaders in the registration of EVs across dif-

ferent vehicle categories.

According to UP Energy Minister A K Sharma, the state is playing a leading role in India's clean energy transition by accelerating renewable energy and creating a conducive ecosystem for investment and innovation.

He was addressing the Lucknow roadshow of the Bharat Renewable Energy Summit & Expo (BRE Summit) 2026 recently.

“The BRE Summit 2026 offers a global platform to showcase UP's clean energy opportunities, connect with investors, and strengthen collaboration across the renewable energy value chain,”

Sharma added.

The BRE Summit 2026 will be held alongside the 9th Session of the International Solar Alliance (ISA) Assembly and the 4th International Conference on Green Hydrogen (ICGH), during 2-5 November 2026 at New Delhi.

Under the UP Electric Vehicle Manufacturing and Mobility Policy 2022, the Yogi government offers capital subsidy to EV charging service providers.

For investment of ₹25 lakh in an EV charging station, the state will provide capital subsidy of 20 per cent, subject to a maximum of ₹10 lakh per unit to first 2,000 charging stations.

RAJASTHAN

State tops PM-KUSUM capacity

ANIL SHARMA
Jaipur, 14 September

Rajasthan ranks first in the country in terms of capacity under the PM-KUSUM scheme, Aarti Dogra, secretary of the state's Energy Department, said. “Approximately 5.20 gigawatt (Gw) of capacity has been installed in the state under PM-KUSUM Components A and C,” Dogra said. The state crossed the 5 Gw mark in July 2026, she added.

Dogra was speaking at a review meeting of the Energy Department chaired by Chief Secretary V Srinivas.

During the meeting, Srinivas asked the department to

place special emphasis on vendor capacity building for the successful implementation of the PM Surya Ghar Yojana.

He directed the department to train the maximum possible number of vendors through capacity-building workshops to accelerate implementation of the scheme. While reviewing ongoing training programmes, he also called for measures to make them more effective.

Reviewing power-sector grievances registered on the Rajasthan Sampark Portal, Srinivas directed officials to ensure prompt and quality resolution of consumer complaints.

Monsoon withdrawal likely to begin this weekend: IMD

SANJEEB MUKHERJEE
New Delhi, 14 September

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) on Monday said conditions are becoming favourable for the withdrawal of the southwest monsoon from some parts of West Rajasthan around September 19, marking the beginning of its withdrawal from the Indian mainland.

The monsoon, which enters India through the Kerala coast, covers the mainland over the subsequent four months before beginning its withdrawal from the far western parts of Rajasthan.

According to IMD, rainfall during the monsoon season so far, from June 1 to September 13, has been 15 per cent below normal. Southern peninsular India has recorded the largest shortfall, with rainfall 28 per cent below normal, followed by East and Northeast India at 25 per cent below normal.

The southwest monsoon this year started on a weak note, with rainfall in June 2026 being 36.5 per cent below normal. The weak start to the season disrupted the sowing of kharif crops, with the area under cultivation recording an almost 21 per cent shortfall by

Mixed bag
Kharif sowing as on Sep 11
(in million hectares)



Crop	Normal area	2026	Chg %*
Paddy	41.2	42.7	3.6
Pulses	12.3	11.8	-4.2
Coarse cereals	18.3	18.3	0.3
Oilseeds	20.0	19.4	-3.1
Cotton	12.6	10.9	-12.9
Total	110.4	109.6	-0.7

*From normal area, which is the average area of last 5 years for most crops

Note: Total might not match as it is only of broad crop categories
Source: Ministry of Agriculture

the end of June compared with the same period last year.

However, rainfall picked up pace in July and August, helping narrow the cumulative all-India deficit to around 15 per cent. Rainfall in July was, in fact, 1 per cent above normal on a cumulative all-India basis.

The rains recovered slightly in July and August after a weak June, but prolonged dry spells

in some parts have kept the overall shortfall close to 15 per cent, with regional variations ranging from 0 to 35 per cent.

The sowing of kharif crops, which was lagging until the end of June, also picked up pace in July and August. The acreage under all crops together as of September 11 was around 1.45 per cent lower than last year and 0.72 per cent below the normal acreage, which is the average area covered over the past five years.

At a granular level, data showed that as of September 11, the acreage under urad, moong, soybeans and cotton was significantly lower than the average area covered during the corresponding period over the preceding five years. These are among the crops where inflationary pressures could emerge first, barring rice, where the Centre is sitting on ample stocks that could be used to keep prices in check.

Water levels in reservoirs shows that till September 3, total water levels in the 178-odd reservoirs monitored in the country were close to 129.87 billion cubic metres (bcm), which is lower than last year's levels of 159.18 bcm and even lower than the average level of the last 10 years, which is 134.233 bcm.

ICEA seeks 5% GST on mobiles amid high chip prices

Mobile phone industry body ICEA has written to the government seeking a reduction in GST on mobile phones to 5 per cent from the current 18 per cent amid a decline in domestic demand, especially due to rising memory chip prices.

The India Cellular and Electronics Association (ICEA) in a letter to Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman dated September 2 said India is now the

world's second-largest mobile-phone manufacturer by volume, and mobile phones became the country's largest export product in FY26.

The industry body, however, has not kept pace with manufacturing and exports, as handset consumption has declined, replacement cycles have lengthened and the affordable smartphone segment remains under pressure.

“This imbalance will constrain the next phase of manufacturing growth unless India restores momentum in its domestic market. ICEA therefore seeks the Government's intervention to reduce GST on mobile phones from 18 per cent to 5 per cent and undertake corresponding rate rationalisation for mobile-phone components,” ICEA chairman Pankaj Mohindroo said in the letter. pri

► FROM PAGE 1

Banks likely to incur more costs on FCNR(B)

Banks that have not fully hedged the interest component could face higher rupee costs of servicing their dollar liabilities if the rupee weakens further. Those that have hedged the exposure would have already locked in the additional cost.

The rupee breached the 95-per-dollar mark last week as crude oil prices rose above \$100 a barrel amid heightened tensions in West Asia, while the RBI was seen intervening through spot dollar sales and foreign exchange swaps.

Banks could face higher hedging costs on the interest component of FCNR(B) deposits if US yields and forward premiums rise, a market economist said. Expectations of tighter monetary policy in the US and concerns over the country's fiscal position could put upward pressure on US yields, while domestic factors could also affect forward premiums, the economist said.

Banks can use overnight indexed swaps (OIS) to manage interest-rate risks, while forwards and swaps can be used to manage currency risks, the economist said. The precise impact would depend on banks' balance sheets and treasury strategies, the economist added.

The strong mobilisation of FCNR(B) deposits has also added to the RBI's liquidity-management challenges, as the scale of inflows was higher

than banks had initially expected, bankers said.

“We could have done it with at least \$25-30 billion less than what has come in,” the private sector banker cited above said.

With the banking system's liquidity surplus rising well above the RBI's comfort threshold, the central bank initiated sterilisation of excess liquidity through variable rate reverse repo (VRRR) operations in August. The RBI has now turned to more durable liquidity-absorption tools, announcing open market operation (OMO) sales of ₹1 trillion, to be conducted through three auctions on September 17, September 21 and September 28.

The combination of the standing deposit facility (SDF), VRRR operations and OMO sales could enable the RBI to sterilise around Rs 10 trillion of excess liquidity from the banking system, economists at QuantEco Research said.

QuantEco estimated that this would leave room for another ₹2 trillion for immediate sterilisation, which could be met through short-dated sell/buy foreign exchange swaps and/or issuances of market stabilisation scheme (MSS) securities or cash management bills (CMBs). Analysts do not expect the RBI to resort to a cash reserve ratio (CRR) hike or extend the OMO sales programme for now.

doubled to 48.27 per cent from 22.54 per cent in July, garlic climbed to 43.60 per cent and ginger stayed extremely high at 73.82 per cent. The food basket showed divergence with tomato and potato deepening into deflation at -31.09 per cent and -13.14 per cent, respectively.

Rajani Sinha, chief economist at CareEdge Ratings, pointed to price pressure across several categories beyond vegetables, including sugar, rice and edible oil.

“Onion prices have been impacted by delayed new plantings due to late monsoon, resulting in a delay in the arrival of the new harvest in the market. Meanwhile, lower-than-expected sugarcane yields and a shift towards ethanol production have tightened the domestic availability of sugar, thereby pushing up sugar prices,” she noted.

The inflation for sugar skyrocketed to 24.2 in August per cent from 4.92 per cent in July.

On the wholesale side, the WPI food index—which combines primary and manufactured food—touched a 20-month high of 7.05 per cent. Rahul Agrawal, principal economist at Icrs, said WPI food inflation was led by fruits and vegetables, milk, spices and sugar, and warned it could harden further into September-October on an unfavourable base.

The data landed on the same day that RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra met Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman in New Delhi, amid heightened attention to the inflation outlook, crude oil prices and the future course of monetary policy.

The meeting came weeks after India posted a record 7.8 per cent GDP growth in the first quarter of the current financial year despite an uncertain global backdrop, and just ahead of the October monetary policy review.

Among the 12 major CPI divisions, personal care, social protection and miscellaneous goods and services remained the single biggest driver at 15.17 per cent, as gold and silver prices held at elevated global levels amid geopolitical risk aversion.

Silver jewellery inflation stood at 107.11 per cent and gold, diamond and platinum jewellery at 35.53 per cent. Industry body PHDCCI cautioned that demand for precious metals could take a hit in the coming festival and

wedding season if prices stay this high.

Fuel pressures showed up across both indices. WPI fuel and power inflation accelerated to 22.93 per cent from 20.05 per cent, as crude petroleum and natural gas jumped to 34.41 per cent and mineral oils to 38.48 per cent on the back of the West Asia conflict.

“Despite deflation in electricity prices, renewed spurt in crude petroleum prices in August due to West Asia crisis has pushed fuel and power inflation and is expected to remain elevated until a permanent solution to West Asia crisis is achieved,” noted Devendra Pant, chief economist at India Ratings and Research (Ind-Ra).

On the CPI, the pass-through was visible in transport, where inflation edged up to 4.6 per cent, and in restaurants and accommodation services, which recorded 8.38 per cent. Sabnavis linked the firming in transport, restaurants and even glassware to the rise in petrol, diesel and other energy prices.

Even the normally benign information and communication segment of the CPI ticked up to 2.01 per cent from 0.63 per cent. “This could be partly attributed to robust global demand for memory chips amid the AI boom, which is gradually feeding through into domestic retail prices,” Sinha reckoned.

Categories such as health (1.34 per cent), recreation (1.74 per cent) and housing (2.61 per cent) stayed benign, while education services (3.73 per cent) and clothing and footwear (3.56 per cent) were only mildly elevated.

Manufacturing pressures, meanwhile, are broadening. WPI manufactured products inflation rose to 8.37 per cent, a series 29-month high, with several sub-sectors—including chemicals, metals and textiles—in double digits.

Pant said the persistence of double-digit prints across manufacturing suggested “WPI inflation is turning structural.”

The output producer price index (PPI), which tracks prices received by producers, rose to 110.8 in August from 109.9 in July, translating into an inflation rate of about 9.8 per cent, up from 9.57 per cent in July. The trial input PPI for manufacturing, published on an experimental basis since March, eased to 104.2 in August from 105.9 in July.

Retail inflation in rural areas, at 5.23 per cent, ran well

ahead of the 4.31 per cent in urban areas, widening the rural-urban gap. Among states, Telangana recorded the highest inflation at 6.27 per cent, followed by Tamil Nadu (5.92 per cent), Madhya Pradesh (5.55 per cent), Andhra Pradesh (5.53 per cent) and Odisha (5.52 per cent).

The twin readings leave the RBI's rate-setting Monetary Policy Committee (MPC), which meets next on October 5-7, with a harder call. The central bank has kept the repo rate unchanged at 5.25 per cent for four consecutive reviews.

With headline CPI still

below 5 per cent, Sabnavis said an immediate policy change was unlikely, though he flagged that the inflation threat remained and pegged full-year FY27 inflation at 5-5.2 per cent.

Sinha said the October decision would be crucial and that a sustained uptick could strengthen the case for a rate hike, projecting CPI to peak in the third quarter of FY27 and average around 5 per cent for the year. Ind-Ra expects WPI to breach 10 per cent in September, while ICRs sees it in the 9.5-10 per cent range through September-October.

Tata Sons listing may boost group's weight in key indices

The recent decline has been driven largely by TCS, whose shares, along with those of other information technology (IT) services companies, have fallen sharply in calendar year 2026. A slowdown in earnings growth, weak guidance and uncertainty around the impact of artificial intelligence (AI) have weighed on investor sentiment. Foreign institutional investor (FII) selling in Indian large-cap companies has also pressured the stock.

If the Tata Sons listing takes place, it would add another large-cap group company to the listed space. According to reports, the listing could take place at a valuation of up to ₹12 trillion, based on an estimated value of ₹15-16 trillion for its underlying portfolio. More conservative estimates, which factor in a holding company discount, put the potential listed valuation below ₹10 trillion.

Looking into Airtel, Jio's MNP rule violation allegations: Trai

The telcos have also alleged that Vi was restricting SMSes that have to be mandatorily sent to 1900 for generation of unique porting code (UPC) for MNP in several circles. This was in violation of MNP 2009 norms specifying issuance of UPC without delay from the network where the customer is porting out of.

The two carriers are learnt to have alleged that Vi was also circulating and promoting discounted postpaid tariff plans for those seeking to switch to Vodafone Idea using MNP.

The issue of misleading or deceptive activities for MNP

solicitation have come to the fore at a time when Vi has begun to regain customers, on the back of promoter equity infusion and bank funding being tied up towards capex investments.

The Aditya Birla group company intends to raise ₹35,000 crore from banks to fund its ₹45,000 crore capex cycle till 2028-29 (FY29), even as it upgrades the network to 5G and adds customers on a monthly basis.

Vi is also making its presence felt in the market and among consumers through an aggressive marketing cam-

paign, for the first time in many years. It is pushing the narrative of equal service for all in the face of rival carrier Bharti Airtel launching Fast-

lane services for its postpaid customers.

Vi is the only one among its peers that is yet to implement any increase to its tariff plans.

Cosmetics from Pakistan breach Indian market, raise eyebrows

“Many companies from Pakistan might be using distribution networks to reroute their products to India from friendlier countries such as the United Arab Emirates (UAE) and Nepal,” said Rishi Agrawal, co-founder and chief executive officer (CEO) at TeamLease RegTech, a compliance management software company.

A retired drug inspector added, on the condition of anonymity, that while the country of origin and import need to be mentioned on the manifest of import consignments, many may circumvent the rules to show, say, UAE as the place of origin by making small changes to the product there.

CDSco's alert has advised consumers against buying these products, and if they have bought them, to not use

them. “Violations observed in the label can be reported to the respective state drugs controller for the products manufactured in India and the DCGI for the imported cosmetics products,” the alert added.

Agrawal of TeamLease RegTech said the central and state drug regulators need to have a list of pharma and cosmetics distributors and retailers within their jurisdictions to share regulatory notifications and ensure their implementation. “There remains an information asymmetry, where important regulatory messages do not get through the last rung of distributors,” he said. “Strong action should also be taken against retailers and ecommerce platforms that still listed unauthorised products,” he added.

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The Smart Investor

STREET VIEW

“In the short term, these (AI safety) warnings could still weigh on AI and chip stocks. When expectations are this high, even a possible delay can trigger profit-taking”

Charu Chanana, Chief Investment Strategist, Saxo Bank, Singapore



Regulatory changes hit derivatives volumes

Daily contracts fall 23% in Aug as higher STT and collateral requirements weigh on trading

SHILPA RANGARAJAN
Mumbai, 14 September

The market-wide average daily contracts traded in derivatives fell 23 per cent in August to about 224 million, the lowest in 13 months. Overall trading activity across the equity derivatives segment contracted for the third consecutive month as regulatory changes, including a higher securities transaction tax (STT) and enhanced collateral requirements, took full effect.

The regulator also rolled out a closing auction session in the first week of August, and the market is yet to adjust to the change. This has had a big effect on options trading.

Yet individual investors continued to gain market share in the equity derivatives segment despite an overall cooling in derivatives turnover, driven by regulatory



Report card

Share of client participation in index options (premium turnover) of NSE (%)

Client category	Aug-25	Jul-26	Aug-26
Corporates	1.9	2.2	2.4
DIIs	0.1	0.2	0.1
Foreign Investors	5.9	6.5	6.4
Individuals	40.3	41.8	42.4
Proprietary traders	49.8	45.1	44.5
Others	2.1	4.3	4.1

Source: NSE Market Pulse, September 2026 (Vol. 8, Issue 9), NSE EPR. Data as of August '26.

interventions and recalibrated contract sizes, according to the latest data from the National Stock Exchange (NSE).

In its September Market Pulse report, the exchange revealed that individual investors' share of overall equity derivatives notional turnover

rose to 32.9 per cent in August 2026, up from 29.9 per cent during the corresponding period a year ago.

Data shows that traders who participated in both the cash and derivatives segments are not taking much interest in derivatives and are moving out of the segment. On the

other hand, the number of pure derivatives traders is on the rise. Over the past year, this number has increased from 2 million to 2.1 million. Since 2016, there has not been a single year in which this number has fallen.

Over the same period, cash-market participation

rose to 35.85 million.

The number of traders participating in both segments fell to 6.32 million from 8.88 million in 2024.

Trading activity on the NSE declined for the third month in a row in August across both equity cash and equity derivatives, with the decline much sharper in the latter. Average daily turnover (ADT) in the equity cash segment fell 0.6 per cent month-on-month (M-o-M) to ₹1.2 trillion in August.

Equity futures ADT slipped 9.9 per cent M-o-M and 17.3 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) to ₹1.22 trillion in August, marking a 33-month low. Simultaneously, equity options premium turnover moderated considerably, falling 15.7 per cent sequentially and 10.6 per cent Y-o-Y to ₹42,332 crore.

The shift towards mobile-based trading technology

gained further thrust. Mobile-based trading platforms accounted for 19.8 per cent of total index futures turnover in August, rising from 16.4 per cent a year earlier. In contrast, colocation facilities' contribution to index futures turnover declined to 40.2 per cent from 44.3 per cent a year ago.

The pullback was particularly pronounced in index-linked contracts. Despite the decline in volumes, the average trade size for index futures jumped 72 per cent to ₹24.4 lakh compared with October 2024 levels, even as overall index futures trading value slumped 60 per cent to its lowest level in more than a decade.

Average daily premium trading values for index options also fell 43 per cent to a four-year low, pointing to a broad-based cooling in index derivatives activity.

August IPOs strike gold: Listing gains hit 100%

SHILPA RANGARAJAN
Mumbai, 14 September

The primary market in August hit the jackpot with 100 per cent listing gains as the broader market's retail investor base expanded, according to NSE's latest Market Pulse report.

IPOs and new registrations go hand in hand. New investors often register to invest into IPOs with the idea of making quick gains. While June and July were not the best of months for IPO returns, August has been exceptional.

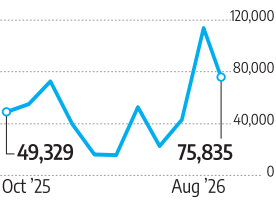
Eighteen mainland IPOs raised ₹28,976 crore and carry ₹2.48 trillion of market value — 8.6 times the capital raised. Manipal Health Enterprises alone, accounted for 32 per cent of the month's fundraising and 40.5 per cent of the combined market value; the top three took 51.6 per cent of the money. The primary market recorded 25 IPOs during the month, the highest in the last ten months.

The three biggest gains all came from small issues: Tempens at 111.3 per cent raised ₹650 crore, Technocraft at 81.4 per cent raised ₹252 crore, Behari Lal at 63.2 per cent raised ₹302 crore. The money went into the large issues and the gains went into the small ones. Horizon Industrial Parks, the third-largest issue, gained 0.4 per cent. The expansion in the IPO market was heavily driven by West India. New registrations from the western region jumped by a massive 40.9 per cent month-on-month (M-o-M), significantly outstripping other geographies. North India followed with a steady M-o-M growth of 12.4 per cent in new investor additions. Meanwhile, East India witnessed 7.3 per cent new registrations, and South India saw 3.6 per cent.

Individual investor participation expanded rapidly. New investor registrations on the NSE rose to 1.5 million in August from 1.3 million in July, representing a month-on-month increase of approxi-

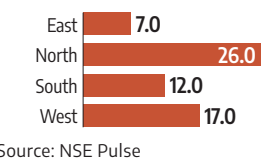
Roller-coaster ride

Total equity raised through IPOs (₹ cr)



Region-wise share

New investor registrations in FY27 so far (in lakhs)



Source: NSE Pulse

mately 16.5 per cent. This acceleration further extended the exchange's registration rally, which had previously expanded by 14.1 per cent in June. On the other hand, Gujarat has overtaken Uttar Pradesh as the largest source of new investor registrations in August 2026, adding 230,000 investors, equivalent to 14.6 per cent of monthly additions. Uttar Pradesh followed with 200,000 (12.9 per cent).

Gujarat's saw new registrations increasing 94.8 per cent over the previous month and 134.9 per cent over last year. Rajasthan also recorded strong sequential growth of 36.7 per cent. The shift in leadership from Uttar Pradesh to Gujarat. Uttar Pradesh continues to have the second-largest registered investor base nationally. Gujarat's sharp increase in new registrations made it the largest contributor to incremental investor participation during August.

This divergence highlights changing dynamics of investor acquisition, where states with already large investor pools are being joined by markets registering rapid growth in new participation.

Oil prices soar over 4% to 16-week high

Houthi attacks on key Saudi pipeline trigger sharp surge

REUTERS
14 September

Oil prices jumped over 4 per cent to a 16-week high on Monday after new strikes on Saudi Arabian energy infrastructure and attacks on ships in the West Asia compounded energy supply concerns.

Brent futures rose \$4.68, or 4.5 per cent, to \$109.29 per barrel at 10:15 a.m. EDT (14:15 GMT), while US West Texas Intermediate (WTI) crude rose \$4.21, or 4.2 per cent, to \$104.26.

That kept both benchmarks in technically overbought territory for more than a week and put Brent and WTI on track for their highest closes since May 19. Arab states in the Gulf called off a meeting with Iran planned for Monday, while Yemen's Iran-backed Houthis launched a new attack on Saudi Arabia after fighting that has extended the West Asia war to another theatre and further jeopardised global oil supplies.

The Houthis said they fired dozens of missiles and drones on Monday at a Saudi military airbase in Khamis Mushait, near the border, hitting aircraft hangars, radar systems, runways and ammunition depots.

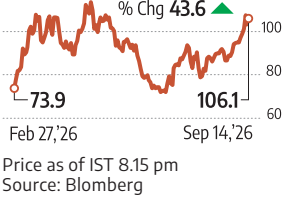
On Friday, an attack, which Riyadh blamed on Iran-backed fighters in Iraq, knocked out Saudi Arabia's east-west pipeline, which helps Saudi Arabia avoid the Strait of Hormuz by re-routing oil shipments to the Red Sea, threatening up to 4 per cent of global oil supply.

Before the U.S. and Israel



On the rise again

Brent crude spot (\$/bbl)



Price as of IST 8:15 pm

Source: Bloomberg

attacked Iran in late February, about a fifth of the world's oil supplies passed through the Strait of Hormuz.

Commodity vessel transits through the Strait of Hormuz fell to a single digit per day at the weekend, preliminary ship tracking data showed on Monday, well below a 10-day average of 14.

With the pipeline out of service, the Red Sea port of Yanbu will have to draw on storage, which is estimated to cover five to seven days of exports, according to three industry sources.

"The relatively contained price reaction suggests the market still expects Saudi inventories to cushion exports in the near term, but if the disruption extends beyond the five-to-seven-day inventory cushion, that could change quickly," said Janiv Shah, oil markets analyst at Rystad.

Yemen's Iran-aligned Houthis reached the island of Perim on Friday, tightening their control over the Babel-Mandeb strait at the southern end of the Red Sea.

Tata Sons' listing: Charter changes, disclosure scrutiny and OFS in focus

Company may challenge RBI decision, which could impact timeline

KHUSHBOO TIWARI
Mumbai, 14 September

With the Reserve Bank of India's (RBI's) rejection of Tata Sons' bid to shed its Core Investment Company (CIC) status making a stock market listing increasingly difficult to avoid, attention is now turning to the legal and structural groundwork the salt-to-software conglomerate will need to complete before it can file for an initial public offering (IPO).

The starting point, lawyers say, is Tata Sons' Articles of Association (AoA). The company converted to a private limited entity in 2017, embedding restrictions on share transferability and shareholder entry that are incompatible with public listing norms. According to Tanmay Banthia, partner at TARAKsh Lawyers and Consul-

itants, the board will need to pass special resolutions reverting Tata Sons to a public company and stripping out these restrictive covenants to meet the market regulator's baseline listing criteria.

Rohit Jain, managing partner at Singhania & Co, said that Tata Trusts' controlling position and any trust-linked governance arrangements may need scrutiny from a disclosure, related-party transaction, and beneficial ownership perspective. "A calibrated dilution by existing shareholders, including strategic secondary sales, could improve free float and price discovery. Enhanced transparency, board independence, disclosure controls, and capital structure simplification would be central to IPO readiness," he said.

Tata Trusts is the largest shareholder of Tata Sons with a

Listing hurdles

■ AoA restrictions need to be removed before Tata Sons can pursue an IPO

■ Tata Trusts' 66 per cent stake in Tata Sons may face disclosure and beneficial ownership scrutiny

■ Experts expect an OFS by existing shareholders to meet public-shareholding regulations

■ SP group's 18.4% stake could form part of the OFS to ease its debt burden

66 per cent stake. On meeting the minimum public shareholding (MPS) threshold, experts believe an offer for sale (OFS) route involving existing shareholders — rather than a fresh dilution — is the likely path.

The Shapoorji Pallonji (SP) group, which holds 18.4 per cent and has long pushed for a listing to ease its own debt load, is seen as a natural candidate for such an OFS, allowing Tata Sons to meet compliance requirements without loosening the Trusts' grip on control, experts noted.

Alay Razvi, managing partner at Accord Juris, said Tata Sons' immediate priority would be to obtain clarity from the RBI on timelines. He added that the company would need to reassess its valuation, public-float requirements, and disclosure framework, and that "the Shapoorji Pallonji group's stake could potentially form part of an offer for sale." Razvi also flagged the possibility of a legal pushback: "Tata Sons may challenge the RBI's decision, but should prepare for listing unless a court grants effective interim relief."

Global markets fall as AI slowdown worries hit chipmakers

BLOOMBERG
14 September

A selloff in chipmakers dragged down stocks after leaders of artificial-intelligence giants proposed slowing the technology's development, with a rally in oil also weighing on sentiment.

From the US to Europe and Asia, semiconductor shares came under heavy pressure. American powerhouses Nvidia and Broadcom slumped.

A closely watched industry gauge sank 5 per cent. The Nasdaq 100 fell 1.3 per cent. Brent crude topped \$108, raising

concern about inflationary pressures in the countdown to this week's Federal Reserve decision. Short-term Treasury yields rose.

A 3,800-word missive by Anthropic PBC Chief Executive Officer Dario Amodei - which was endorsed by OpenAI CEO Sam Altman and SpaceX AI CEO Elon Musk - said development of the most-advanced systems must be slowed in order to prevent AI slipping beyond human control and inflicting catastrophic harm.

On Monday, Microsoft's AI researchers have released a new set of guiding tenets that they

LATEST COMMENTARY SUGGESTS THAT SAFETY CONSIDERATIONS COULD, AND SHOULD, SLOW THE PACE OF FRONTIER AI DEVELOPMENT

say boil down to five words: People matter more than AI.

If the latest developments push out the timing of promised AI returns, it makes sense that investors would become less enthusiastic, according to Matt Maley at Miller Tabak.

While US industry leaders are not advocating a full pause, the latest commentary suggests

that safety considerations could, and should, slow the pace of frontier AI development, according to Justin Post and Nitin Bansal at Bank of America.

"We believe concerns on AI deployment could be a sentiment negative for the AI value chain," they wrote. "Despite potential concerns, we continue to believe AI capacity will have strong multi-year demand."

At HSBC, Max Kettner says calls for a slower AI buildup and resulting fears for the tech sector are "overblown."

This could actually help profitability of AI companies

eventually, he said.

"Fearmongering, confrontation and vicious competition will only disrupt the process of global AI governance and serve the interests of no one," Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesman Guo Jiakun said at a regular briefing in Beijing on Monday.

Traders also kept a close eye on the latest geopolitical developments.

A meeting between Iran and several Gulf Arab nations over a temporary shipping lane through the Strait of Hormuz was postponed, highlighting tensions with the Islamic Republic.

In the red

Global markets on Monday	% Chg 1-Day
Nasdaq Composite	-1.0
S&P 500	-0.7
Dow Jones	-0.4
Euro Stoxx 50 Pr	-1.3
FTSE 100	0.4
Kospi	-3.3
Nikkei 225	-0.8
Hang Seng	0.5

As of 8.22 pm IST

Source: Bloomberg

THE COMPASS

Ather Energy on a long growth road, but not without hurdles

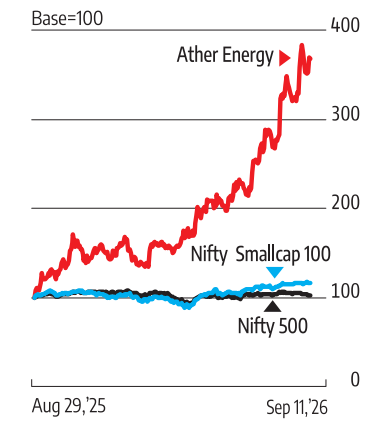
DEVANGSHU DATTA

The electric two-wheeler (e2W) market may be close to an inflection point with near cost parity, policy support, and better ecosystem. Electric 2Ws have registered double-digit market shares in overall 2W sales for two consecutive months. Ather Energy could be a big beneficiary, though the company has unimpressive financials and faces increasing competition.

On Ather's 4th Community Day, it launched Konarc on its new mass-market EL (short for "enlightened") platform. Starting prices at ₹99,999 mark a shift from Ather's prior strategy of premiumisation, though the company is trying to lower prices only by reducing cost structures, rather than dropping features. Ather now has a 700-store physical network. Some analysts are seeing annual revenue growth rates of above 50 per cent for the next few years as electric vehicles (EVs) catch on and the network expands. The scalable EL

platform, and a focus on battery life, home charging options, and resale value are aimed at the average consumer. Dealer inventory stands at just three days (versus 14 days in the fourth quarter of financial year 2025-26, or Q4FY26). Industry e2W penetration has reached 11 per cent, as Ather's retail registrations grew 102 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) in Q1FY27. This strong growth took Ather's market share to 16.8 per cent from 14.2 per cent quarter-on-quarter (Q-o-Q), with pre-orders up 158 per cent.

Volume growth is supported by EL, and a planned AURIC Phase-1 rampup in Q3FY27 will raise capacity to 0.92 million units. Average selling prices (ASPs) may soften but the management expects margins to be protected and gradually improve due to the lower cost structure. Various variants of the Konarc will be available with range options of 100-200 km across S and Z variants. The vehicles have new features like Advanced Electronic Braking System (AEBS), MagicKey, AutoPop, AirWalk, and com-



bined charging, which reduces charging time by 50 per cent. There is a 10-year or 100,000 km extended warranty on the 5th-generation Bedrock battery.

AtherNode is a smart solution designed to electrify every parking spot in a building without upgrades to the transformer. AtherNode hubs can

manage up to 1,000 chargers per complex. The True Health app provides a health score, component-level diagnostics, and estimated resale value. The modular architecture allows for fast repairs. In a live demonstration, the Konarc was disassembled in 37 seconds and reassembled in 90 seconds. Konarc could accelerate growth gained from Rizta, which took market share from 8 per cent in early FY25 to 16.8 per cent by Q1FY27. Motorcycles, which make up 60 per cent of India's 2W market, could offer a long-term opportunity.

Ather is focussed on expansion beyond South India. Central India (Gujarat, Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, and Odisha) was the fastest-growing zone in Q1FY27, up 141 per cent Y-o-Y, ahead of Rest of India (118 per cent), and the South (76 per cent). New stores are turning operationally profitable in five-six months on average, faster than guidance to partners.

The capacity expansion is funded by a ₹2,500 crore raise of capital — a ₹1,300

crore qualified institutional placement (QIP) has been completed, while a ₹1,200 crore preferential issue is pending. Management guided for five-month rampup to Phase 1's full 42,000 units per month run-rate. The EL platform will add up to 18,000 units per month of capacity at Hosur, for a total capacity of 60,000 units per month.

AtherNode is designed to work for all EVs, not just Ather scooters. Ather claims its batteries are built for a 10-year lifecycle. Therefore, it offers an extended 10-year or 100,000 km warranty. The cell-balancing hardware is supposed to be five times as good as the previous iteration. Safety is monitored through Breach Sense, a new safety technology that uses sensors and software for early detection of potential issues. Ather True Health is a feature in the mobile app that provides a "0-5 health score" for the scooter, covering battery, motor, etc. The software also provides smart destinations for automatic morning and evening navigation,

flyover alerts, and WhatsApp control.

One selling point is that the Konarc has a 10-12 per cent lower bill of materials cost compared with the 450 series, helping maintain a high margin profile. Ather currently operates in Sri Lanka and Nepal, with plans to scale globally over a 2-4 year timeframe using the flexible EL platform.

The company has a negative cash conversion cycle. Earnings before interest, taxes, depreciation, and amortisation (Ebitda) margins are projected to run at minus 6.2 per cent in FY27. It's likely to improve to positive 7.6 per cent by FY29, with profit after tax (PAT) breakeven in FY28. However, there is a high intensity battle for share in e2Ws, with Ola, TVS, Bajaj, and Hero jostling for attention. Dependency on rare-earth supplies could impact margins. The share price has doubled in the past six months.

The writer is a New Delhi-based independent journalist



UBL needs to turn its growth tap back on

Better execution could help beer major reverse its revenue, margin lag

RAM PRASAD SAHU
Mumbai, 14 September

The stock of India's largest beer maker, United Breweries (UBL), is trading at a five-year low and has shed about 31 per cent over the past year. While the main pain points are sluggish volume, revenue growth, and margin pressure, weak demand, adverse weather, inventory correction, and higher input costs have squeezed its operational performance over the past five quarters.

To rectify the situation, the company has devised a medium-term plan to achieve double-digit revenue growth. It has also guided a low-teen operating profit margin, compared with the high single-digit level currently (9.2 per cent in the first quarter, or April-June/Q1 of 2026-27/FY27). The gains are expected to come from a combination of portfolio mix, state mix, and productivity initiatives.

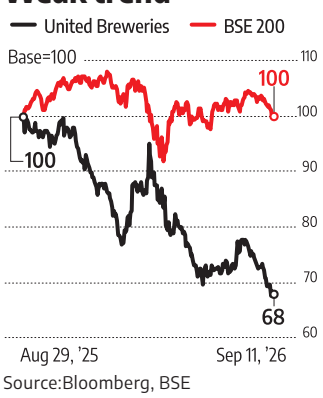
While brokerages are positive on the structural growth story and the company's targets, they are cautious and await better execution, which will help the company improve market share and deliver on margins going ahead. Until that happens, the stock (₹1,255), which is trading at around 50x its 2027-28 (FY28) earnings estimates, may continue to underperform peers and the broader market.

Double-digit revenue growth is one trend the Street will keep a close eye on. The company has been working on improving top-line growth, as the 6 per cent annual revenue growth over the past three years and 3 per cent volume growth are hardly something to cheer about. The weaker performance is ascribed to its increased reliance on contract brewers in structurally lower-profitability states, as well as its dependence on tie-up units to handle sudden volume surges.

PHOTO: SHUTTERSTOCK



Weak trend



Analysts Nitin Gupta and Ishant Lalwani of HDFC Securities expect ramping up of market supply to be in place and, with the commissioning of the projects in Telangana, Maharashtra, and Uttar Pradesh, the share of revenue from own breweries should expand, helping the company achieve double-digit growth. Maharashtra, Karnataka, and Telangana are the company's key states, where faster growth could be sustained, they add.

The brokerage has a "reduce" rating, given competitive intensity, and a target price of ₹1,325. Despite historically inconsistent earnings, the stock's valuation (64x the five-year average forward price-to-earnings ratio) remains elevated, reflecting its dominance in low-alcohol beverages, premiumisation runway, strong consumer traction, and a scarcity premium supported by limited free float and liquidity, it adds.

The other trigger is an improvement in profitability metrics. Gross margins have declined to sub-45 per cent levels from an average of 54 per cent between 2012-13 and 2021-22, restricting profitability at the operating level to single digits. More recently,

UBL's margins remain under pressure due to war-related cost inflation, with an impact of ₹300-500 crore. However, pricing, trade-spend optimisation, procurement and productivity initiatives have mitigated nearly half of the impact, points out analyst Ajay Thakur of Anand Rath Research.

The company aims to improve its operating profit margin from the current single-digit level to low-to-mid-teen levels. Premiumisation, favourable state mix, localisation, and productivity should aid structural margin expansion.

Anand Rath Research has reduced its earnings per share estimates by 30 per cent for FY27 and 18 per cent for FY28 due to the company's underperformance over the past few quarters and the impact of higher input costs on margins on account of the West Asia conflict. It, however, has a "buy" rating on the stock, with a lower target price of ₹1,600 (from ₹2,100 earlier), valuing it at 60x FY28 earnings, compared with 65x previously. The "buy" rating is based on expectations of a visible volume upswing, premiumisation turning margin-accretive, and a sharp recovery in earnings growth.



YOUR MONEY

How the elderly should avoid insurance mis-selling trap

SANJAY KUMAR SINGH

The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (Irdai) has imposed a ₹1 crore penalty on Canara HSBC Life Insurance Company for mis-selling a deferred annuity policy to an 88-year-old, although its entry age was 30 to 80. Irdai found deficiencies in the verification call, proposal form, disclosure of features and solicitation process.

Why seniors are easy targets

Many seniors do not realise that incentives drive recommendations. "They sign where instructed without seeking further documents because they trust the banker," says M. Pattabiraman, associate professor, Indian Institute of Technology Madras and founder, Freefincal. Many also hold much of their retirement corpus in deposits. "Large fixed-deposit holdings make them easy targets for high-margin products presented as secure income streams," says Pattabiraman.

Recognise mis-selling

Sellers may portray insurance as a high-interest fixed deposit or a guaranteed-return product (even

when that is not the case). They may sell it as a short-term plan without revealing the long tenure, lock-in, low liquidity and early-exit penalties. Sometimes these plans are sold as single-premium plans when, in reality, they require regular premium payments.

Check suitability

Barring immediate annuities, most life policies may not suit seniors. A deferred annuity makes little sense at age 75 if income starts five or six years later. "Returns during the deferment period may be only around 4 to 5.5 per cent," says Renu Maheshwari, Sebi-registered investment adviser, cofounder and principal adviser, Finscholarz Wealth Managers. Ulips carry market risk. Endowment and money-back plans may not generate adequate returns to beat medical inflation. Seniors without income generally do not require term insurance.

Understand the product

Seniors must distinguish between the premium-payment term and the policy term. In a deferred annuity, establish when the payouts begin. If an investment of ₹5 lakh produces ₹1 lakh annually from the sixth year, the

return is not 20 per cent. "The waiting period lowers the effective return," says Maheshwari.

Check the internal rate of return. Annuity products tend to have zero or low liquidity. "A promise of liquidity from a locked annuity corpus indicates mis-selling," says Shilpa Arora, cofounder and chief operating officer (COO), Insurance Samadhan.

Read before signing

Read the customer information sheet (CIS), which states benefits, exclusions, lock-in and charges. Treat the verification call seriously. "Do not hand the phone to another person to answer on your behalf," says Kapil Mehta, cofounder, SecureNow Insurance Broker. Once the policy document arrives, review the benefit illustration and

Documents to preserve

- Proposal form and benefit illustrations from time of sale
- Compare policy's underwriting age band with customer's profile
- Request recording of verification call
- Recording can show ineligible customer was allowed to buy product
- Keep bank statements showing premium debits
- Preserve SMS and WhatsApp exchanges with branch staff or agents
- Keep copies of every complaint and insurer's response

Source: King Stubb & Kasiva, Advocates and Attorneys

policy schedule page. "The benefit illustration tells you how much the policy will pay and when. It also distinguishes guaranteed benefits from non-guaranteed ones," says Mehta.

Use the free-look period

The free-look period lasts 30 days from receipt of the policy document. Return an unsuitable policy at the insurer's branch or online. "Obtain an acknowledgement of the cancellation request," says Arora.

Escalate complaints

If the free-look period has ended, complain in writing to the insurer's grievance redressal officer. "Obtain a complaint reference number," says Siddhartha Karnani, partner, King Stubb & Kasiva, Advocates and Attorneys. If the response is unsatisfactory, approach the Insurance Ombudsman. "An unresolved or inadequately answered complaint may also be escalated to Irdai through Bima Bharosa," says Karnani. If a bank sold the policy, complain to its grievance cell and, if necessary, escalate the complaint to the Reserve Bank of India Ombudsman. Consumer court and civil court remedies remain available.

Avoid rushed purchases

Ignore salespersons if they say that the premium will go up if you do not hurry up and buy. Demand documents and study them. "Seek an opinion from an independent fee-only adviser. Consult a knowledgeable and trusted family member if a fee-only adviser is not available," says Maheshwari.

Atal Pension Yojana: Withdrawal & pension claim rules if exiting before 60

Atal Pension Yojana (APY) subscribers can exit before 60. Administered by the Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority, APY offers a guaranteed minimum monthly pension of ₹1,000 to ₹5,000 from age 60. The amount depends on the subscriber's contribution and age of joining.

Premature exit rules

Voluntary exit before 60 is allowed, but the subscriber generally receives their contributions and net returns, after applicable charges. The government co-contribution, where applicable, and returns earned on it are not refunded.

Premature exit is also permitted in specified exceptional circum-

stances, including death and certain illnesses. If the subscriber dies before 60, the spouse can continue the account until the subscriber would have reached 60 or opt for the applicable corpus. If there is no spouse, the nominee receives the accumulated amount.

Claim after 60

On reaching 60, the subscriber can

claim the pension through the bank or post office where account is held. The monthly pension continues for life.

What subscribers should know

- Keep nominee and KYC details updated.
- Maintain balance for auto-debits.
- Check the latest claim forms.

COMPILED BY AMIT KUMAR

भारतीय कंटेनर निगम लिमिटेड
CONTAINER CORPORATION OF INDIA LTD.
(सबसे अधिक सेवकों वाला एगेंसी) (A Navratna Undertaking of Govt. of India)
Kolkata Cluster, Area-IV East, Dockback House, 5th Floor, 41 Shahpore Sarani, Near Kalamandir, Kolkata-700017

EOI Notice

EOI Nos.	CON/AREA-IV/WH/COMBINED/2026-27/01
Name of work	ONLINE EOI FOR RENTING OUT WAREHOUSE SPACE ON MONTHLY RENTAL BASIS FOR A PERIOD OF 1+1+1 YEAR THROUGH FORWARD E-AUCTION AT 1. JHARSUGUDA (1000 Sq Mtr), Debadhri, Orissa. 2. FATUAH (929 Sq Mtr), Patna, Bihar 3. AMINGAON (2500 Sq Mtr), Guwahati, Assam.
Estimated Cost	Jharsuguda: Rs.22.31,970/- incl. GST for 1+1+1 year period Fatua: Rs.52.86,357/- incl. GST for 1+1+1 year period Amingaon: Rs.1,71,84,926/- incl. GST for 1+1+1 year period
Period of Contract	1+1+1 years for all the three locations
Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) (through e-payment)	Jharsuguda: Rs. 44,659/- Fatua: Rs. 1,05,727/- Amingaon: Rs. 3,43,699/-
Cost of EOI Document (Non-refundable)	Rs. 1000/- for each location (through e-payment).
EOI Processing Fee (Non-refundable)	Rs.1317/- for Jharsuguda, Rs.3119 for Fatua & Rs.3540/- for Amingaon inclusive of all taxes through e-payment (Non-Refundable).
Date of sale of EOI documents (online)	From 15.09.2026 15:00 hrs to 07.10.2026 (upto 16:00 hrs) for all the three locations
Last Date of submission of EOI.	On or before 08.10.2026 upto 15:00 hrs for all the three locations
Date & Time of Opening of EOI.	09.10.2026 at 15:30 hrs. for all the three locations
Eligibility Criteria:	The bidder should be in the field of manufacturing or trading or clearing & forwarding agent or transporter or in logistic field for a period of last two immediate financial years prior to the last date of submission of the bid for this EOI i.e., 2024-25 & 2025-26. The bidder shall produce documentary proof of having carried out such business for the said financial years. The bidder must have a positive net worth based upon latest completed (audited) annual accounts. Note: Bidder may submit their Bid for any location or for all three locations as per their choice. Corrigendum/ Addendum/ Amendments/ Clarifications etc., if any, shall be hosted on CONCOR website only (www.concor.co.in). Bidders are requested to visit the website regularly, contact office of CONCOR, AREA IV office, New Delhi / Kolkata Cluster office for any doubt / clarifications. (Ph: 033-22837101-05). For complete details log on to www.tenderwizard.com/ccil . Sd/ Area Head (Area-IV)

HB PORTFOLIO LIMITED
CIN : L67120HR1994PLC034148
Registered Office : Plot No. 31, Echelon Industrial Area, Sector 32, Gurugram-122001, Haryana
Phone : + 91-124-4675500, Fax : + 91-124-4370985
E-mail : corporate@hbportfolio.com, Website : www.hbportfolio.com

SPECIAL WINDOW FOR RE-LODGE-MENT OF TRANSFER REQUESTS OF PHYSICAL SHARES

Pursuant to SEBI Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)2026-MIRSD-POD/I/3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026, shareholders of **HB Portfolio Limited** (the Company) are hereby informed that special window has been opened from **February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027** for re-lodgement requests for the transfer of shares and is specially applicable to cases which were lodged prior to deadline of April 01, 2019. The original share transfer requests which were rejected/returned/not attended due to deficiencies in documentation or were not processed due to any other reason.

Eligible shareholders may submit their transfer request along with the requisite documents to the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent (RTA) at **RCMC Share Registry Private Limited** at their office address at B-25/1, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase 2, New Delhi, India, 110020, Tel: 011-26387321 or send an email at investor.services@rcmcdelhi.com within stipulated period.

If all the documents are found to be in order by the Company/RTA, the share transfer shall be processed only in dematerialized form and shall be under lock in for a period of 1 (one) year from the date of registration by the Company / RTA and shall not be transferred /marked/ pledged during the said lock-in-period. Accordingly, the transferee(s) must have a demat account and provide a copy of their Client Master List (CML), along with the requisite documents, at the time of lodging the transfer request with the Company/RTA.

For HB Portfolio Limited
Sd/-
Meenu Papreja
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Membership No. F11607

Date : September 14, 2026
Place : Gurugram

NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the general public that Mr. Shivam Goyal, residing at 33/19-A/6-B, Lohiya Nagar, Balkeshwar, Agra, Uttar Pradesh - 282005, is the owner of the property situated at House No. 3/20, Pratap Pura, Agra, Uttar Pradesh - 282001 and is proposing to create an equitable mortgage of the said property in favour of IDBI Bank Limited, Sanjay Place Branch, Agra for availing a mortgage loan facility.

It is further stated that the Original Chain Deed dated 05.06.1967, executed by Smt. Mahadevi in favour of Virendra Singh and Ranjit Singh wide sale deed bhai no. 1, Jld no. 1841 pages 144/147 serial no. 3229, relating to the aforesaid property, has been lost/misplaced and despite diligent search could not be traced.

Therefore, any person(s), institution(s), bank(s), financial institution(s) or any other entity having any claim, right, title, interest, charge, lien, objection or encumbrance whatsoever in respect of the aforesaid property or the aforesaid lost original chain deed is hereby required to notify the undersigned in writing along with supporting documentary evidence within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice. Failing which, it shall be presumed that no person has any claim, right, title, interest or objection in respect of the said property or the lost document, and the proposed mortgage transaction shall proceed accordingly.

Contact Address: Mr. Shivam Goyal 33/19-A/6-B, Lohiya Nagar, Balkeshwar, Agra, Uttar Pradesh - 282005, Mobile No. - 8433119676

GOVERNMENT OF MEGHALAYA
OFFICE OF THE DIRECTOR OF HEALTH SERVICES
MEDICAL EDUCATION & RESEARCH (DME), MEGHALAYA,
PASTEUR HILLS, SHILLONG
Email ID: pasteurnstudiesh@gmail.com Tel. Ph. No.: (0364) 2591510 / 94851 06663
No.DHSME&R/USTM&BAMS/2026/5483 Dtd. Shillong, the 14th September, 2026

NOTIFICATION

In connection with Advertisement No.DHSME&R/USTM&BAMS/2026/5475 dated 8th September 2026, the list of Candidates has been uploaded in the Government website for the 1st Round Counselling which is scheduled to be held on the **17th September 2026 from 9.00 AM at the office of the Director of Health Services Medical Education & Research (DME), Health Complex, Top Floor, Laitumkhrah, Shillong** for Admission to 1st year BAMS seats at IA Ayurvedic Medical College (IAMC), USTM, Meghalaya.

Candidates are requested to visit the website: www.meghealth.gov.in for further information.

Sd/-
Director of Health Services
Medical Education & Research (DME),
Pasteur Hills, Meghalaya, Shillong

MIPR No. : 1633
Dated : 14-09-2026

Tamilnad Mercantile Bank Ltd
Faridabad Branch,
Upper Ground Floor, Plot No.37, W G Tower, Neelam Bata Road, NIT, Faridabad, Haryana - 121001
E-mail: faridabad@tmb.bank.in
CIN : L65110TN1921PLC001908 Mob No. 9205137300

APPENDIX IV-A (See proviso to rule 8(6))
Sale notice for sale of immovable property

Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described immovable properties mortgaged/charged to the Secured Creditor, the constructive possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of **Tamilnad Mercantile Bank Limited, Faridabad Branch**, (Secured Creditor), will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", and "Whatever there is" on **29.09.2026, for recovery of Rs. 22,37,667.49 (Rupees Twenty Two Lakh Thirty Seven Thousand Six Hundred Sixty Seven Paise Forty Nine only)** as on 31.08.2026 due to **Tamilnad Mercantile Bank Limited Faridabad Branch** (Secured Creditor) with subsequent interest and expenses from **Miss. Vandana Sharma D/o Mandev Sharma and Mr. Arun Sharma S/o Mandev Sharma, r/o House No. 943, Gali No. 2, Jawahar Colony Part – 2, Near Aggarwal School, Faridabad, Haryana – 121005.**

The Reserve price will be **Rs. 27,10,000/- (Rupees Twenty Seven Lakhs Ten Thousand Only)** and the earnest money deposit will be **Rs. 2,71,000/- (Rupees Two Lakhs Seventy One Thousand Only).**

Place of Auction	Tamilnad Mercantile Bank Ltd Faridabad Branch, Upper Ground Floor, Plot No.37, W G Tower, Neelam Bata Road, NIT, Faridabad, Haryana - 121001 E-mail: faridabad@tmb.bank.in CIN : L65110TN1921PLC001908 Mob No. 9205137300
Date and Time of Auction Sale	29-09-2026 and 03:00 PM
Upset Price	Rs. 27,10,000/- (Rupees Twenty Seven Lakhs Ten Thousand Only)

Description of property:
All that the part and parcel of the residential land to an extent of 90 sq.yds or 810 sq.ft. in Southern Part of Plot No. 74 in Arazi Kharsa Musli No: 57 Kila No: 18, 8, 3, 23/2, 2, 48/23 at Gali No: 2, Nangla Road, Jawahar Colony, Near Aggarwal School, Faridabad, Tehsil & District. Faridabad, Haryana and there is a residential house building constructed thereat to the extent of 810 sq.ft. vide House No: 943, Property ID No. 1B57D5H2 (Old PID on NDC : P07003550707) standing in the name of Mr. Arun Sharma S/o Mandev Sharma is being bounded by

BOUNDARIES : East :- 15 Feet Gali (Road), West :- Others Property, North :- Others Property, South :- Remaining part of Property

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided in secured creditors website www.tmb.bank.in.

Place: Faridabad
Date 11.09.2026

Authorised Officer
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank Ltd
Faridabad Branch

The Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India (ASSOCHAM)
CIN: U91990DL1920NPL008223
Reg. Add: 4th Floor, YMCA Cultural Centre and Library Building 1, Jai Singh Road, New Delhi-110001, Delhi, India. Tel.: +91-11-46550555 (Hunting Line)
E-mail: assochem@nic.in, Website: www.assochem.org

NOTICE OF THE 106th ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING AND E-VOTING INFORMATION

Notice is hereby given that the 106th Annual General Meeting ("AGM") of **The Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India (ASSOCHAM)** will be held on Wednesday, September 30, 2026 at 3:00 p.m. IST at **Hotel Le Meridien Sovereign – 12, Windsor Place, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001, Delhi, India** (hereinafter referred to as 'AGM'), to transact the business, as set out in the Notice convening the 106th AGM of the Company.

The said Notice along with Proxy form, attendance slip and Annual Report for the financial year 2025-26 has been sent on **Tuesday, September 15, 2026** to the members whose name is entered in the Register of Members as on the cut-off date of **Tuesday, September 15, 2026** (cut-off date for the purpose of dispatch of Notice) through email at their registered email-ID.

In terms of the aforesaid provisions:

- The Company is providing to its members the facility to exercise their right to vote on resolutions proposed at the meeting through **electronic voting (remote e-voting)**.
- The Company has engaged the services of **National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL)** for providing the remote e-voting facility.
- The remote e-voting period shall commence on **Sunday, September 27, 2026 (9:00 a.m.)** and end on **Tuesday, September 29 2026 (5:00 p.m.)**. During this period, members whose name is entered in Register of Member as on the cut-off date of **Tuesday, September 15, 2026** may cast their vote electronically. Remote e-voting shall not be allowed beyond the said date and time.
- The cut-off date for determining the eligibility of members to vote through remote e-voting or at the meeting is **Tuesday, September 15, 2026**.
- Members who have cast their vote by remote e-voting prior to the AGM may also attend/Participate in the AGM, but shall not be entitled to vote again at the AGM.
- Members present at the meeting and who have not cast their votes on the resolutions through remote e-voting system and are otherwise not barred from doing so, shall be eligible to vote through e-voting system at the AGM. The instructions for voting at the AGM are provided in the Notice of the 106th AGM.
- The Notice of the Meeting together with instructions for remote e-voting has been sent electronically to the members whose email addresses are registered with the Company. The Notice is also available on the Company's website at www.assochem.org and on the website of the e-voting agency at www.evoting.nsdl.com.
- In case of any queries or issues regarding e-voting, members may refer to the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) and e-voting user manual available on the website of the e-voting agency or contact the Company at **NSDL at evoting@nsdl.com or call at 022 - 48867000, Address: T301, 3rd Floor, Naman Chambers, G Block, Plot No. C-32, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra East, Mumbai-400051, Maharashtra, India.**
- The Managing Committee has appointed **Mr. Nitin Madaan (ACS No. 36368 & CP No. 20664), Proprietor of N Madaan & Associates, Practicing Company Secretary** as Scrutinizer to scrutinize the remote e-voting process and voting at the meeting in a fair and transparent manner.

By the Order of the Managing Committee
For The Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India
Sd/-
Date: September 15, 2026
Place: Delhi

Saurabh Sanyal
Secretary General/Director

HDFC BANK
We understand your world

Head Office: HDFC Bank House, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Panel (West), Mumbai - 400 013
Regional Office: HDFC Bank Ltd.; Dept For Special Operations, Ground Floor, Gulab Bhawan ,6,Bhadur Shah Zafar Marg ITO, New Delhi 110002

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE PUBLIC NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE & MOVABLE PROPERTY

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immoveable properties mortgaged to Bank under Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rule, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s)/Mortgagor(s)/Guarantor(s) that, the Authorized Officer(s) of HDFC BANK LTD. had taken physical possession of the following property/ies pursuant to demand raised vide notice(s) issued under Sec 13(2) of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 in the following loan accounts with right to sell the same on "AS IS WHERE IS, AS IS WHAT IS, AS IS WHAT IS, THERE IS AND WITHOUT RECOURSE BASIS" for realization of Bank's dues plus interest as detailed hereunder and whereas consequent upon failure to repay the dues, the undersigned in exercise of power conferred under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said Rules proposes to realize the Bank's dues by sale of the said property/ies. The sale of the below-mentioned Properties shall be conducted by way of E-Auction through Web Portal: <https://www.bankauctions.com>

DESCRIPTION OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES/DETAILS OF ACCOUNT/AMOUNT/EMD/ETC

Name of the Branch & Account	Name of the Mortgagor & Guarantors of the property	Details of property	Reserve Price		Amount as per Demand Notice Demand Notice Date	Inspection Date and Time:
			EMD	Bid Increase Amount		
HDFC Bank Ltd, Delhi M/S United Construction	Mortgagor/Partner Guarantor: Mr Gopal Raj Rani & Mohd. Zuber Khan	Item No. 1 Property Bearing No. Entire Second Floor With Roof Right, Part of the Property No.16 & 17 In Pocket & Block B-5 Sector-15 Rohini Delhi 110085.	Rs. 96,00,000/- Rs. 9,60,000/- Rs. 1,00,000/-		Rs. 4,38,00,791.87/ Date of Demand Notice: 30-06-2021, Dues as on 30.06.2021 with further interest along with the costs and expenses till the date of full and final payment under the Loan account	13.10.2026 10.30 AM to 11.30 AM

Name of Authorised Officer/Phone No./Email ID :
Mr. Somnath Pandey , Mobile: 9310110525, somnath.pandey1@hdfc.bank.co.in

Date / Time of e-Auction : 16.10.2026, 10.30 AM to 11.30 AM
Last Date for Receipt of Bids: 15.10.2026 Up to 4.00 PM

TERMS & CONDITIONS:

- The e-Auction is being held on "AS IS WHERE IS, AS IS WHAT IS, WHEREVER THERE IS AND WITHOUT RECOURSE BASIS"
- The interested bidders shall submit their EMD details and documents through Web Portal: <https://hdfcbank.auctiontiger.net> (the user ID & Password can be obtained free of cost by registering name with <https://hdfcbank.auctiontiger.net>) through Login ID & Password. The EMD shall be payable through NEFT / RTGS in the following Account: **8750000904261**, Name of the Account: **DFSO TRANSITORY ACCOUNT**, Name of the Beneficiary: **HDFC BANK LTD.**, IFSC Code: **HDFC000240** or through Demand Draft drawn in favour of **HDFC Bank Ltd Account No. 57500000904261** latest by 4.00 P.M. on or before the dates mentioned in the table above. Please note that the Cheques shall not be accepted as EMD amount.
- To the best of knowledge and information of the Authorized Officer(s), there is no encumbrance or claims except as disclosed as per Bank's record with respect to the Properties including statutory dues like property taxes, society dues etc. The Bank however shall not be responsible for any outstanding statutory dues / encumbrances / Municipal Corporation Dues / electricity dues, charges/tax arrears etc, if any and it will be liability of the buyer. The intending bidders should make their own independent inquiries regarding the encumbrances, title of Properties & to inspect & satisfy themselves. **Properties can be inspected strictly on the above mentioned date and time.**
- The intended bidders who have deposited the EMD and require assistance in creating Login ID & Password, uploading data, submitting bid, training on e-bidding process etc., may contact our service provider **M/s. C1 India Pvt. Ltd., Plot No 301, Gulf Petro Chem Building, Udyog Vihar, Phase 2, Gurgaon, Haryana. Helpline No's: 0124-4302020/21/22/23/24, Mr. Mihlesh Kumar Mobile: 7080804466**, Help Line e-mail ID: support@bankauctions.com and for any property related query may contact the Authorized officer as mentioned above in office hours during the working days. (10:00 AM to 5:00 PM).
- The highest bid shall be subject to approval of HDFC Bank Limited. Authorized Officer reserves the right to accept/ reject all or any of the offers/ bids so received without assigning any reasons whatsoever. His decision shall be final & binding.
- The prospective bidder should take cognizance of all the litigation with respect to the property in auction including Securitization Application, if any filed before Debt Recovery Tribunal. He should inquire all the case with respect to the property in auction, independently and take cognizance of it prior to submission of bid.
Note:- Although there is a pending litigation with regard to the said property viz M/s Kuber Polychem Private Limited Vs HDFC Bank Limited (SA No. 260 of 2026 before DRT-I, Delhi) is pending before DRT-I, Delhi for adjudication with regard to the said properties. There is no order staying/precluding HDFC Bank Limited.
- (FOR DETAILED TERM AND CONDITIONS PLEASE REFER TO OUR WEBSITE www.hdfcbank.com and www.bankauctions.com)**

Date: 15.09.2026, Place: Delhi

Authorised Officer, HDFC Bank Ltd.



Bluechip valuation slump offers value bets

The BSE Sensex has fallen 6.8% since the end of September 2025, with its trailing P/E multiple down 10.8%

KRISHNA KANT & RAM PRASAD SAHU

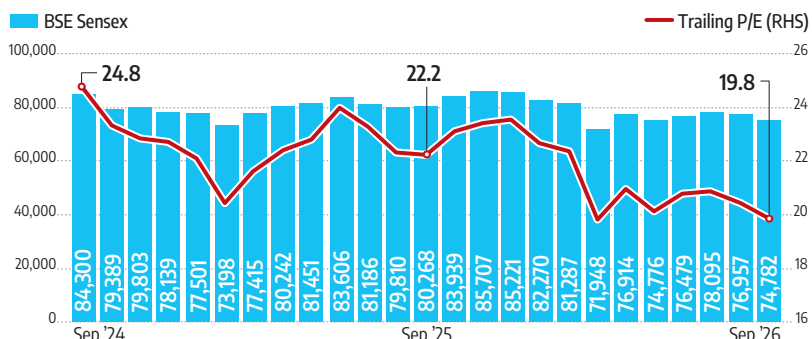
Indian equity markets are not only underperforming peers in other developed and emerging markets, but also being de-rated by investors. This shows a steady decline in the valuation ratios of the benchmark indices and top stocks. In the past 12 months, the BSE Sensex has fallen 6.8 per cent from 80,268 at the end of September 2025 to 74,782 on Friday. In the same period, the index's trailing price to earnings (P/E) multiple is down 10.8 per cent from 22.2x to 19.8x. Similarly, the index price to book value ratio (P/BV) has declined 6.1 per cent in the past one year, from 4.28 to 4.02.

The Sensex's current earnings multiple is close to its lowest since June 2020, while the price to book value is the lowest since April 2025, barring March 2026 when the ratio had declined to 3.78. This low valuation simply reflects the valuation de-rating of the country's top listed companies that are part of the index.

A sharper decline in the valuation ratio suggests that investors are pessimistic about the prospects of faster earnings growth in the country, especially for the largecap stocks, and they see a slowdown in the pace of growth from their current level. It could also mean that foreign portfolio

Poor sentiment

BSE Sensex's monthly closing and its trailing price-to-earnings multiple



Note: Latest data is for September 11, 2026; Source: BSE, Compiled by BS Research Bureau

investors (FPIs) — who are largely responsible for the decline in share prices of large cap stocks and benchmark indices — see better growth prospects in other markets.

While low valuations clearly hint at poor investor sentiment, it also offers a buying opportunity for value investors. On many occasions in the past, such as in 2011, 2016 and 2020, the market has bounced back from a similar level of valuation.

Here are 10 companies from the

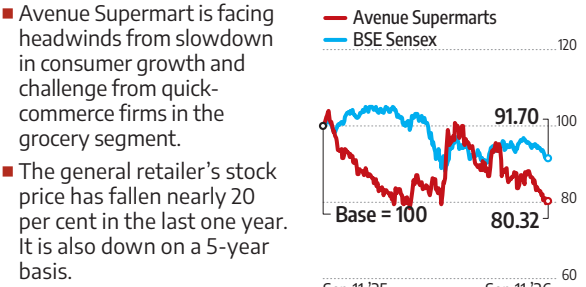
BSE200 that have seen the biggest decline in their share price and valuation ratios — trailing trailing P/E and P/BV ratios — in the last one year, as well as in the last five years. Nine of them have not only seen high double-digit fall in their share price in the last one year, but also on a five-year basis. These stocks are currently trading at a trailing P/E discount of 30-50 per cent from their five-year average earnings multiple. Their current P/BV ratio shows a similar discount.



ILLUSTRATION: BINAY SINHA

Avenue Supermarts

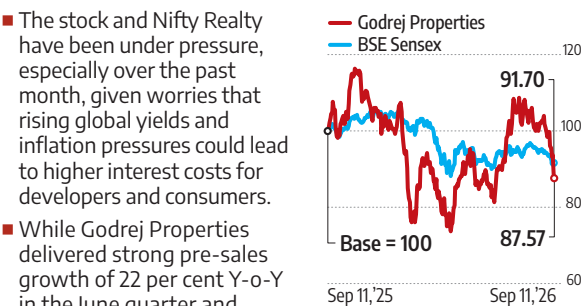
Share price (₹)	1-year chg (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Current P/E (x)	5-year avg P/E (x)	Current P/BV (x)	5-year avg P/BV (x)	Q1FY27 (Y-o-Y % chg)
3,688	-19.6	-1.4	78.5	117.7	9.8	15.2	Revenue Net profit 14.9 11.3



- Avenue Supermart is facing headwinds from slowdown in consumer growth and challenge from quick-commerce firms in the grocery segment.
- The general retailer's stock price has fallen nearly 20 per cent in the last one year. It is also down on a 5-year basis.
- Analysts at Emkay Global see more downside for the stock due to a slower ramp-up in new store additions, lower growth in bill size (up only 1.5 per cent in Q1FY27) and expensive valuations.
- The company's revenue rose 14.9 per cent Y-o-Y, while adjusted net profit grew 11.3 per cent Y-o-Y in Q1FY27.
- The growth was inadequate, given its still pricey trailing P/E multiple of 78.5x and price to book value of 10x.
- It also faces challenges from continued losses from its e-commerce venture and a further decline in return on invested capital, after the board approved issuance of non-convertible debentures worth ₹1,000 crore.

Godrej Properties

Share price (₹)	1-year chg (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Current P/E (x)	5-year avg P/E (x)	Current P/BV (x)	5-year avg P/BV (x)	Q1FY27 (Y-o-Y % chg)
1,745	-12.3	2.0	32.8	66.4	2.9	4.7	Revenue Net profit 16.5 -41.7



- The stock and Nifty Realty have been under pressure, especially over the past month, given worries that rising global yields and inflation pressures could lead to higher interest costs for developers and consumers.
- While Godrej Properties delivered strong pre-sales growth of 22 per cent Y-o-Y in the June quarter and collections rose 18 per cent Y-o-Y, aggressive growth in construction payouts at ₹2,200 crore were up 54 per cent Y-o-Y and led to a weak operating cash flow, which was down 80 per cent Y-o-Y, said Kotak Research.
- The company has indicated that it will strike an optimum balance between growth and cash generation.
- With land costs largely paid, HSBC Research expects a significantly higher share of collections, higher margins benefiting from price appreciation, and increase in operating cash flows going ahead.
- Progress towards 20 per cent return on equity and its sustenance and free cash flow generation will be next drivers of stock performance, the brokerage said.

PI Industries

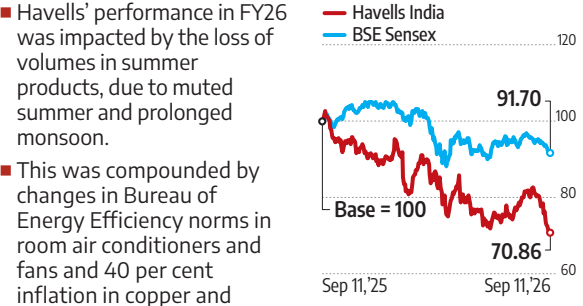
Share price (₹)	1-year chg (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Current P/E (x)	5-year avg P/E (x)	Current P/BV (x)	5-year avg P/BV (x)	Q1FY27 (Y-o-Y % chg)
2,258	-39.6	-7.9	26.0	42.5	3.2	6.4	Revenue Net profit -10.4 -39.0



- The custom synthesis and manufacturing (CSM) segment (three-fourths of revenue) witnessed a sharp slowdown in 2025-26 (FY26) due to weak industry demand, elevated channel inventories globally, and customers adopting a cautious just-in-time procurement strategy, resulting in a volume decline.
- Even in the June quarter, volumes fell 8 per cent year-on-year (Y-o-Y) (revenue down 10 per cent) amid muted demand in the global agrochemicals market, competition from generics and higher input costs due to the West Asia war.
- Despite the weak start, the company has reiterated full-year guidance of a low single-digit growth, supported by recovery in the exports business in the second half of FY27 and gradual ramp up of the pharma and biological businesses.
- Factoring in a muted first quarter (Q1), JM Financial Research has cut its FY27/28 earnings estimates by 7-13 per cent.

Havells India

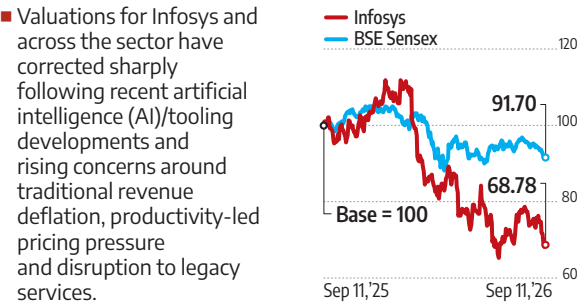
Share price (₹)	1-year chg (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Current P/E (x)	5-year avg P/E (x)	Current P/BV (x)	5-year avg P/BV (x)	Q1FY27 (Y-o-Y % chg)
1,115	-29.4	-5.2	41.4	70.7	7.4	11.7	Revenue Net profit 19.5 -16.5



- Havells' performance in FY26 was impacted by the loss of volumes in summer products, due to muted summer and prolonged monsoon.
- This was compounded by changes in Bureau of Energy Efficiency norms in room air conditioners and fans and 40 per cent inflation in copper and aluminium prices.
- In the June quarter, a staggered pass through of rising costs and higher advertising and promotion costs have had an adverse impact on its margins.
- Entry of UltraTech into wires and cables, which is Havells' largest segment by revenue, and inability to pass on the additional costs could dent margins further in the coming quarters, say analysts.
- Some brokerages believe that despite the correction and multiple risks, valuations have not corrected enough and the stock is trading at higher levels than peers.

Infosys

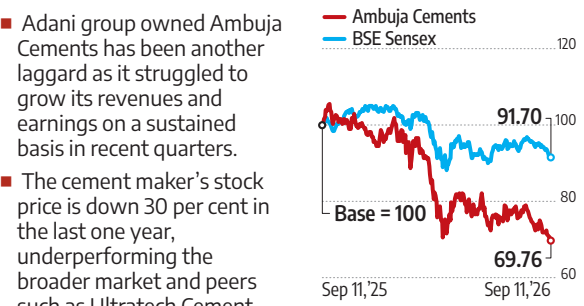
Share price (₹)	1-year chg (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Current P/E (x)	5-year avg P/E (x)	Current P/BV (x)	5-year avg P/BV (x)	Q1FY27 (Y-o-Y % chg)
1,038	-31.3	-9.3	14.0	25.8	4.9	8.7	Revenue Net profit 14.0 12.3



- Valuations for Infosys and across the sector have corrected sharply following recent artificial intelligence (AI)/tooling developments and rising concerns around traditional revenue deflation, productivity-led pricing pressure and disruption to legacy services.
- Performance continues to undershoot expectations as Q1FY27 constant currency revenue growth on a sequential basis came in at 1 per cent. Revenue was weighed down by a 50 basis points one-off from a client programme termination, softer-than-seasonal volumes, and higher offshoring.
- The company cut its FY27 revenue growth guidance to 1.5-3.0 per cent from 1.5-3.5 per cent.
- Demand remains uncertain with elongated decision cycles and cautious discretionary spend, HDFC Securities said.
- The brokerage has cut its estimates by 1 per cent and lowered the target multiple to 15 times from 16 times, citing continued uncertainty and guidance cut.

Ambuja Cements

Share price (₹)	1-year chg (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Current P/E (x)	5-year avg P/E (x)	Current P/BV (x)	5-year avg P/BV (x)	Q1FY27 (Y-o-Y % chg)
391	-30.1	-2.2	20.4	33.9	1.7	2.5	Revenue Net profit -7.7 -33.6



- Adani group owned Ambuja Cements has been another laggard as it struggled to grow its revenues and earnings on a sustained basis in recent quarters.
- The cement maker's stock price is down 30 per cent in the last one year, underperforming the broader market and peers such as Ultratech Cement.
- The company's consolidated net sales were down 7.7 per cent Y-o-Y in Q1FY27, while its net profit fell 29.1 per cent Y-o-Y in the quarter.
- It also faces margin pressure from higher energy costs. Ebitda margins were down nearly 370 basis points to 18.3 per cent Y-o-Y in Q1FY27.
- Poor show on bourses has led to sharp decline in Ambuja Cements' valuation with trailing price to earnings multiple down to 20.5x, 40 per cent lower than its 5-years average earnings multiple of 33.9x.
- Its P/BV ratio has declined to 1.66, nearly 35 per cent lower than five-year average ratio of 2.53.
- Brokerages expect a better show from the stock due to a combination of low valuation and growth revival.

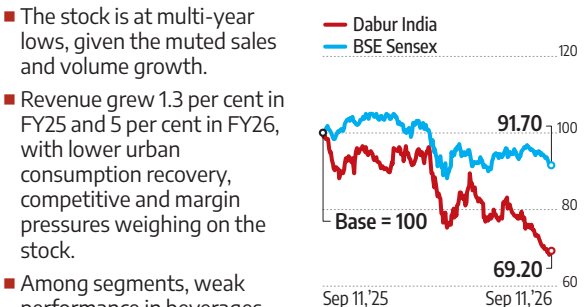
SBI Cards & Payment Services

Share price (₹)	1-year chg (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Current P/E (x)	5-year avg P/E (x)	Current P/BV (x)	5-year avg P/BV (x)	Q1FY27 (Y-o-Y % chg)
656	-23.3	-9.9	28.8	43.0	4.0	7.2	Revenue Net profit 3.4 19.5

- SBI Cards and Payment Services has seen a sharp de-rating in its valuation and performance in the last year.
- The stock is down 23.3 per cent in the last one year, underperforming the benchmark Sensex by a big margin.
- The underperformance has been driven by a rise in credit cost and its adverse effect on the company's net interest margin (NIM).
- According to Axis Securities, SBI Cards' NIMs were down 28 basis points in Q1FY27, owing to higher cost of funds.
- The credit card issuer also faces challenges from a potential rise in delinquencies from stress in the job market, especially in the information technology services sector.
- The stock is currently trading at a trailing price to book value ratio (P/BV) of 4, which is a 45 per cent discount to its 5-year average P/BV of 7.24.

Dabur India

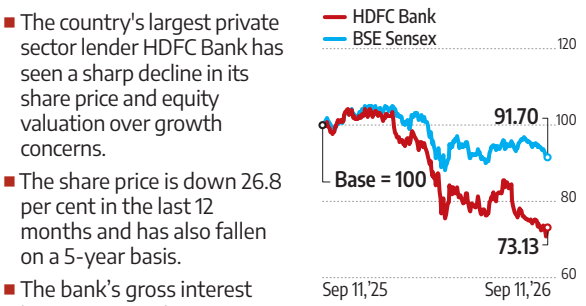
Share price (₹)	1-year chg (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Current P/E (x)	5-year avg P/E (x)	Current P/BV (x)	5-year avg P/BV (x)	Q1FY27 (Y-o-Y % chg)
377	-30.9	-10.0	35.2	53.5	5.9	9.9	Revenue Net profit 10.6 15.0



- The stock is at multi-year lows, given the muted sales and volume growth.
- Revenue grew 1.3 per cent in FY25 and 5 per cent in FY26, with lower urban consumption recovery, competitive and margin pressures weighing on the stock.
- Among segments, weak performance in beverages, health supplements and over-the-counter and ethicals have resulted in moderation in revenue contribution.
- Though volume growth in the past couple of quarters has normalised, Religare Research believes near-term growth could be marred by weak consumer spends and high competitive intensity. Valuations do not discount medium term earnings risk, it added.
- The company is eyeing double digit consolidated revenue growth in FY27, as well as gradual expansion of margins.
- However, weaker than expected monsoons will impact rural demand and pose a downside risk to earnings, given Dabur's relatively higher share of the rural market, pointed out Emkay Research.

HDFC Bank

Share price (₹)	1-year chg (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Current P/E (x)	5-year avg P/E (x)	Current P/BV (x)	5-year avg P/BV (x)	Q1FY27 (Y-o-Y % chg)
708	-26.8	-2.0	13.8	19.4	1.8	2.8	Revenue Net profit 2.4 5.0

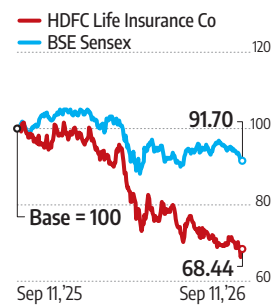


- The country's largest private sector lender HDFC Bank has seen a sharp decline in its share price and equity valuation over growth concerns.
- The share price is down 26.8 per cent in the last 12 months and has also fallen on a 5-year basis.
- The bank's gross interest income was up just 3.7 per cent Y-o-Y in Q1FY27, while net profit rose 18.4 per cent Y-o-Y, largely from a decline in provisions for bad loans.
- It is now one of the lowest priced large cap stocks, with a trailing P/E of 13.8x, nearly 30 per cent lower than its 5-year average valuation of 19.44x.
- Similarly, its current P/BV ratio of 1.78 is nearly 36 per cent lower than five-year average ratio of 2.77.
- Analysts attribute the poor show to market concerns about governance and operational challenges post its merger with HDFC around three years ago.
- Analysts at Motilal Oswal Securities maintained a "buy" rating on the stock, as a new leadership team takes charge, with hopes of improved financial performance from FY28.

HDFC Life Insurance

Share price (₹)	1-year chg (%)	5-year CAGR (%)	Current P/E (x)	5-year avg P/E (x)	Current P/BV (x)	5-year avg P/BV (x)	Q1FY27 (Y-o-Y % chg)
530	-31.5	-6.4	57.9	86.4	5.8	9.0	Revenue Net profit 14.6 11.5

- HDFC Life Insurance's stock price is down 31.5 per cent in the last 12-months, grossly underperforming the broader market and its peers.
- Brokerages attribute this to the company's slower than industry growth in gross and annualised premium equivalent (APE).
- Gross premium income was up 14.4 per cent Y-o-Y in Q1FY27, while APE rose 7 per cent Y-o-Y lagging private industry growth, according to Elara Capital.
- This was partly due to a weak growth at HDFC Bank bancassurance channel — one of the biggest sources of new customers for the insurer.
- Trailing price to earnings multiple is down to 28.8x, 33 per cent discount to its 5-year average of 43x. Its P/BV is down to 5.84, 35 per cent lower than the 5-year average of 9.



Frugality, climate and K-pop

The new cultural economics of Gen Z

ANKUR BISEN

Last year, Pilot, the leading Japanese stationery products company, opened its first exclusive brand outlet anywhere in the world in an upscale neighbourhood market in Gurugram. In the age of all things digital, it is the most analogue move one can think of, but that's beside the point. The moot point is that this store sits in the company of a ramen noodle bar that is styled on a popular concept in downtown Tokyo. The noodle bar is a hole in the wall that has a wait time of more than ten minutes on most weekends, if you fancy a squeeze into it.

From Disney to Duolingo: The rise of Jap-Kor
Stroll around in the same market to spot a Japanese doughnut place throbbing with Gen-Z and a self-ramen Korean bar where you can cook your own instant noodles that is always buzzing with pre-teens and their unwilling parents figuring a way around the concept. Korean is the fourth most accessed language on Duolingo in India after English, Hindi and French. Last year, Nykaa reported that Korean brands' gross merchandise value grew at 58 per cent year-on-year on its platform. Ten per cent of the global fan-base of Hallyu (the Korean wave, a term that signifies K-pop, K-food, and films) of 150 million-plus fans resides in India.

The rising influence of Jap-Kor (Japanese and Korean) subculture, beyond automobiles, on the Indian consuming class has been in the works since the early 2000s. It started with the satellite TV that wedded dubbed Japanese cartoons with the telly-time of school children and kids of that generation. They are now the Gen-Zs who are finishing colleges, hunting for jobs, or starting to earn their bread. They have graduated from cartoons-for-kids to K-pop and Japanese anime. This transition passed the baton in kids' entertainment to the next generation, which is consuming content from Korean and Japanese influencers talking about everything from Instagram to nail art.

India has lived through a similar cycle of a foreign culture with an all-American cast of characters — from Disney cartoons to the make-believe world of WWF, and from Hollywood sitcoms to romanticising Wall Street. We saw this play out with food becoming on-the-go and fashion becoming label-conscious. In less than a decade since 1991, we saw this manifest in Americanism taking a fair slice of India's consumption story from merchandise to services. The questions to ask are: Why is the generation of Zs and Alphas not imbibing Americanism with the same fervour as their parents, and is the Jap-Kor of Gen Z and Gen Alpha all set to replace the



A Korean fair at a mall in Delhi's Saket area

PHOTO: SHUTTERSTOCK

Americanism of the millennials?

Peak Americanism and the Trump-era pivot

The dominance of American culture was slotted into neat triggers of consumption synced up with the business successes of American corporations under a tight supervision of geopolitics and technological dominance. In the Trumpian order of things, characterised by anti-immigrant rhetoric, an arc of diplomatic relationship that is distinctly transactional, and the disruption caused by AI, the proximity to Americanism has itself retreated. In physical terms, it means fewer people in the workforce from India headed to the US on H1Bs and fewer students in Gurgaon, Delhi, and Bengaluru dreaming of an American university campus life after school.

But, more than physical, this retreat is also one of mind-share, in which the American movies that were the last word on rom-com and drama, American MBAs that were the solution-template for every-

thing with a problem statement, American superheroes that were the go-to saviour for the world in crisis, and American fast food that was the chic meal to look cool are now showing cracks. Fast food is getting scrutinised for its adverse impact on public health. American entertainment has moved into telling stories of metaphysical and dystopian worlds, if not showing the opioid crisis and broken families in an average American home. American MBAs don't offer the same return on investment, and American superheroes emit geriatric vibes.

Beyond burgers: The new cultural diet

This retreating American culture is giving birth to a simmering counter-trend that seeks equally able alternatives to fill the void, and such a profound shift is playing out right at the time when Zs and Alphas are getting warmed up to take up the reins of the world. Likely Jap-Kor cultural levers are filling this space with gore, romance, and noir in entertainment, with soup bowls and chopsticks in food, gloss and glitter in beauty, and linen mixes and relaxed fits in fashion.

In 2025, South Korea overtook the US to become the world's second-largest exporter of beauty and personal care

products after France. Japan is the third-largest entertainment content exporter and, outside of the US, Korean content is the largest viewed on Netflix globally. These trends do suggest that Jap-Kor is already competing with the Americanism that we all know.

Climate anxiety and the shift to frugality

Heightened awareness of the environment and climate change is a force-multiplier that is also pushing itself into this void and creating its own sub-culture among the Zs and Alphas. Loss of biodiversity, heat shocks, flash floods, and pollution stress are not only about short-term shocks but longer-term psychological shifts that confront the new generation with an impressionable mind.

Consequently, a new language that seeks minimalism, understatement, fraternity, sharing, frugality, and irreverence appears in the lingua franca of the Zs and Alphas.

The gig economy and K-shaped reality

The economic disparity that confronts the new generation with a K-shaped reality can't be ignored for its cultural impli-

cations too, and one that is bound to spiral down into consumption choices. Employment is already becoming gig-based, and temporary hirings are becoming more permanent. Gig workers now account for 2.2 per cent of the workforce in India. Between 2021 and 2025, the number of people earning more than ₹100 crore in annual income rose from 150 to 520. But the average salary earned by an Indian person with a permanent job in 2025 stood at ₹250,000, which is also the average price of a luxury watch sold by a watch retailer whose sales have grown at a CAGR of 33 per cent and profit at a CAGR of 83 per cent between 2021 and 2026.

The net addition of new jobs in the IT sector of India in the first half of 2026 has remained flat in comparison with what it was in FY 25, at around 135,000. This is in a sector that gives direct employment to nearly six million people. Globally, too, with the advent of AI and even before, the white-collar employment pool is getting smaller and greyer. Auto majors in Europe

have retrenched the employee count by nearly 240,000 in FY26 — and that is nearly 10 per cent of the total workforce employed directly by auto companies in the whole of Europe — amid increasing threat from Chinese EVs.

These economic realities are starkly different from the millennials who grew up at a time of great certainty and with a fair chance for upward mobility.

Therefore, the cultural identities of the millennials that were about individuality, flair, assertion, and confidence, and that reflected the economic and lived realities of that era, will be replaced with identities that signify sharing, frugality, minimalism, irreverence, or even nihilism for the Gen Zs and Alphas.

It is not so much about the win of Jap-Kor over Americanism as it is about reading this shift as a change of guard from an American-influenced identity to one that is more country-neutral and seeks more solidarity and universality amidst the realities of climate change and economic uncertainties.

It so happens that Jap-Kor cultural identities now are perceived to be most aligned with the change.

This is bound to have implications on consumer businesses and the growth capital they seek to invest in the Indian consumption story. This may mean everything from the colour choices that the new generation will prefer on the packaging box to the understated tones they will seek in their relaxed fit trousers and polos. They will seek minimalism and subtlety in home decor and bowl meals with more proteins and fewer carbs. They will ditch that shade of lipstick from their mom's era in favour of more gloss and seek the latest collectible of watches made from recyclable material or solar-powered cells over an American power brand.

The boardroom challenge for Indian brands

When market opportunities are sized into large datasets, such macro cultural shifts are quickly stereotyped into major/micro trends for a tactical interpretation, if not ignored as a passing fad or both, and in doing so we may be missing the wood for the trees.

The question is how much of these signals are getting unpacked in the boardrooms of Indian companies for inferences that are beyond their explicit and tactical cues.

How much of the datasets on consumer and market research are investi-

gated beyond numbers and dissected for long-term implications or to trigger innovation and research? Indian brands and businesses have a choice to make. One of them is to merely sit on the boundary line and let a disruptive event roll over their business plans, just like the country's politicians in power recently learned about the mannerism and values of Gen Zs and Gen

Alphas. The other is to get up, take note of this shift and act on it.

The writer is a senior partner at The Knowledge Company, and the author of *Wasted: The Messy Story of Sanitation in India, A Manifesto for Change* (Pan Macmillan; 2019). His X handle is: @AnkurBisen1

OPINION

Understanding double deflation: What it does and why it matters



SAURABH GARG & SHUBHABRATA DAS

India's new gross domestic product (GDP) series has brought the concept of double deflation into wider public discussion. While the basic idea is straightforward, its implications can sometimes appear counter-intuitive. In particular, the implicit gross value added (GVA) deflator may move differently from familiar price indices such as the consumer price index (CPI), wholesale price index (WPI) or producer price index (PPI), and its growth rate can decline even when these indices are increasing. Understanding double deflation therefore requires examining not only the method itself, but also the data, price indices and level of detail used in its implementation.

Why one price index may not be enough
GVA is the difference between an industry's output and intermediate consumption. At current prices, this calculation is straightforward. At constant prices, however, changes in quantities and prices need to be separated.

A simple approach, known as single deflation, is to deflate nominal GVA using one price index. The difficulty is that GVA itself does not have a directly observable market price. It is a residual obtained after deducting inputs from output, and the prices of output and inputs can move very differently.

Using only one price index, therefore, implicitly assumes that input and output prices move broadly together. This may be problematic when the two diverge significantly. Double deflation removes this assumption by separately measuring the volume changes in output and intermediate consumption. The UN System of National Accounts describes real GVA as output in volume terms less intermediate consumption in volume terms. Double deflation is therefore an internationally recognised approach and is not an India-specific innovation. However, due to challenges of meeting the requirement of detailed data, both for output and intermediate use, double deflation is difficult to apply for all sectors of the economy.

India has adopted double deflation for the manufacturing sector, given its input-intensive nature and the availability of rich data from the Annual Survey of Industries (ASI) and PPI.

For the manufacturing sector, nominal estimates for both output and intermediate consumption at annual level are compiled for various institutional sectors using robust data sources. Estimates for private corporations are based on MCA-21 data, public corporations estimates use annual reports, and estimates for the unincorporated sector use Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE) and Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) data.

What does double deflation actually mean?

The method involves three basic steps: (1) Output is deflated separately: Current-price output or nominal value of output is adjusted for changes in output prices to obtain real output. (2) Intermediate consumption is deflated separately: Current-price inputs or nominal value of inputs are adjusted using appropriate prices for the goods and services

How it works				
Nominal		Year 1	Year 2	Growth rate (%)
	Output	1,000	1,110	11
	IC	800	896	12
Price changes	GVA	200	214	7
	Output	100	110	10
	IC	100	113	13
Real	Output	1,000	1,009	0.9
	IC	800	793	-0.9
	GVA	200	216	8.1
Implicit price deflator of GVA		100	99	-1

Note: IC is intermediate consumption; GVA is gross value added

consumed in production. (3) Real GVA is derived as real output minus real intermediate consumption.

Since two separate deflations are undertaken to calculate volume-based GVA, hence the name double deflation.

Why the GVA deflator can appear unusual

The implicit GVA deflator is calculated as Nominal GVA / Real GVA × 100.

Under double deflation, there is no independently observed GVA price index. Output and intermediate consumption (IC) are separately deflated using their respective price indices, and real GVA is obtained as their difference. The movement of the implicit GVA deflator, therefore, depends on the relative movement of output and input prices and their respective weights. As depicted in the illustration below, if input prices increase substantially faster than output prices, real GVA will grow faster than nominal GVA. The GVA deflator can consequently decline, or its growth rate can become negative, even when familiar price indices are rising.

Where do the input prices come from?

Double deflation requires more detailed information than single deflation. An important feature of production is that the output of one industry can become an intermediate input for another. For example, coal is an output of mining but an input for electricity and manufacturing; cotton yarn is an output of spinning and an input for textiles.

Therefore, an output PPI is not restricted to only final-use products. The output PPI basket also includes intermediate use products such as bauxite, coking coal, electricity, refined palm oil, cotton yarn, naphtha, phosphoric acid and cement. Granularity matters in double deflation. The impact and reliability of double deflation also depend on the level of granularity at which it is applied. Out of a total of 30 compilation categories which broadly correspond to combinations of two- and three-digit NIC (National Industrial Classification) industries, double deflation is applied for 28 compilation categories. Real GVA estimates for two compilation categories — manufacture of food products and

manufacture of pharmaceutical products — are compiled using volume extrapolation method, not double deflation, due to challenges of mapping of input items. Output and input items from the latest ASI data are mapped with item-level PPI. Such detailed mapping allows granular deflation of output and input values separately within each tabulation category. The above statistical framework aligns with the practice followed in other countries, including advanced economies like the US, Japan and the Eurozone.

PPI, WPI and producer prices

Another source of misunderstanding is transition towards a PPI. It is sometimes assumed that WPI reflects wholesale market prices while PPI requires entirely new information from producers. It may be noted that for manufactured products, the distinction between WPI and PPI is less pronounced as prices underlying WPI have also substantially been collected at the ex-factory level since the 2011-12 series. The move towards PPI is nevertheless important because of its granularity and coverage and its concep-

tual objective to provide price measures that correspond more closely to the valuation principles used in national accounts.

Why real GDP should not be inferred simply from nominal GDP and a familiar inflation rate

A common shortcut is to think of real GDP growth as nominal GDP growth minus a familiar measure of inflation. This can be misleading. CPI measures consumer prices, while WPI and PPI have different coverage and weights. In the new series, single deflation has been eliminated: Real estimates for agriculture and manufacturing use double deflation, while volume extrapolation is used for the remaining sectors. Under double deflation, real GVA is obtained from separately deflated output and intermediate consumption. The resulting implicit GVA deflator is therefore an outcome of the national-accounts calculation, rather than a CPI or WPI measure used to derive real GVA. Consequently, nominal GDP growth minus CPI or WPI inflation need not equal real GDP growth.

Better statistics can sometimes look less intuitive

Richer survey, administrative and price data enable more refined measurement of real economic activity. The resulting estimates may not always resemble familiar inflation measures such as CPI or WPI. What matters is the quality, appropriateness and consistency of the underlying data. Double deflation is an important step towards better measurement.

Saurabh Garg is secretary, Ministry of Statistics & Programme Implementation (Mospi), and Shubhabrata Das is faculty at IIM Bangalore and member, National Statistical Commission. With inputs from Dalip Singh, DG, central statistics, Mospi





Employees at a garment factory in Tiruppur, Tamil Nadu

PHOTO: REUTERS

Tiruppur: How a small cluster turned into a textile export powerhouse

From ₹429 crore in 1991, exports from India's knitwear capital have grown to ₹46,000 crore with markets spanning 50-plus countries



SHINE JACOB Chennai, 14 September

A 107-fold rise in exports! That sums up the story of India's knitwear capital Tiruppur over the last 35 years. From a modest ₹429 crore in calendar year (CY) 1991, its knitwear exports have grown to ₹46,000 crore in financial year 2025-26. This growth makes the city, around 463 kilometres to the west of state capital Chennai, a classic small-scale industry cluster success story in the post-liberalisation era, driven by scale, entrepreneurship and resilience. Well, it is not that liberalisation created Tiruppur's textile ecosystem from scratch, but it connected an existing entrepreneurial and supplier network to the external world. Today, major brands like Primark, Walmart, Marks & Spencer, Hennes & Mauritz AB (H&M), Tommy Hilfinger, and Target source textiles from Tiruppur. The region also exports to over 50 countries, around 65 per cent of its shipments go to countries with which India has free trade agreements (FTAs). This share is expected to increase further once the FTAs with the United Kingdom and the European Union kick in fully. The ecosystem employs around 1 million people, spread across 1,300 garment units, out of which 75 per cent are women and around 200,000 are migrant workers from around 19 states.

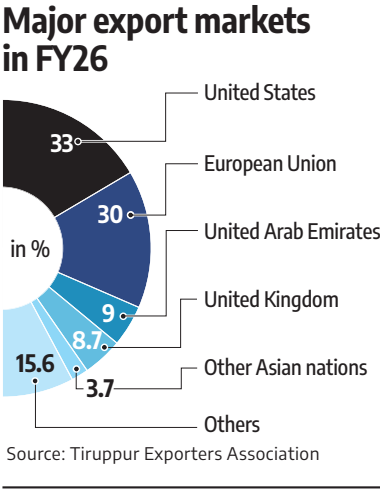
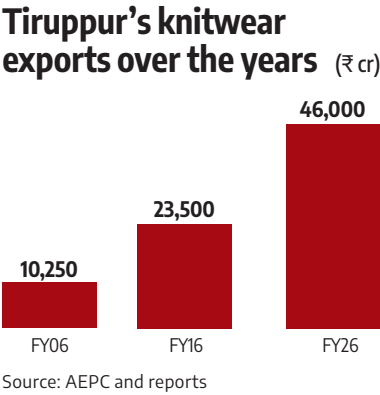
How Tiruppur evolved Located on the banks of the Noyyal River, the region's export prowess is not new. Kodumanal, around 26 km east of Tiruppur, boasts a two-millennium-old trade link with Rome that dates back to the era of Julius Caesar. Despite this rich past, its textile glory went into oblivion for centuries, and for much of its modern history it was an agricultural settlement dependent on the Noyyal, where farmers cultivated cotton and other crops. The first knitwear unit in Tiruppur was set up in 1925, and it emerged as the prominent centre in South India in the 1940s, becoming a hub of white knit innerwear. Earlier, local manufacturers used to sell their knitwear through middlemen and exporters in Kolkata (then Calcutta) and Mumbai (then Bombay). It was only in 1978 that Italian garment player Verona started directly sourcing white T-shirts from the city. Three years later, in 1981, this European retail chain, C&A, became its second international customer. The rest, as they say, is history. From the mere exports of ₹37 crore in CY86, liberalisation, fresh investments and entrepreneurial intelligence pushed its export turnover to ₹1,850 crore by CY96, ₹10,250 crore by FY06, ₹23,500 crore in FY16, and ₹46,000 crore by FY26, show historic data from the Apparel Export Promotion Council (AEPC) and media reports. If you add the domestic market as well, the total revenue from Tiruppur would cross ₹75,000 crore now. "It was a small agrarian town, and we were strong in manufacturing *baniyans* (vests). We had no speciality till exports came into the picture. Now, it is the fourth-largest city in the state, the administrative capital of Tiruppur district and a municipal corporation," says K M Subramanian, president of the Tiruppur Exporters Association (TEA). Tiruppur's success has been powered

by a unique cluster model, where thousands of micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) specialise in different stages of the garment-making process. It should also be noted that the exchange rate in 1991-92 was a mere 24.47 per US dollar, while in FY26 it was seen near ₹86 per US dollar.

Waves of change One of the major advantages that the 1991 reforms threw up for Tiruppur was that it opened up new customer bases like the United States and Europe. Adding to this, the new economic policies made it easier for manufacturers to import modern knitting, dyeing, finishing and garment-making machinery, raising the quality and quantity of production from the region. The reason people consider Tiruppur an example of smart entrepreneurship is also down to the role played by the TEA, launched in 1990 by leading knitwear exporter A Sakthivel, in its transformation. "Liberalisation helped bring fresh investments in infrastructure. In 1990, TEA set a target of achieving ₹1,000 crore of exports and we achieved that. Since then, TEA has played a crucial role in turning around the industry in Tiruppur," says Sakthivel, who is the current chairman of AEPC and the chairman of Poppys Group. According to Ashwin Chandran, chairman of the Confederation of Indian Textile Industry (CITI) and Managing Director of Precot Ltd, the dismantling of the textile quota regime under the World Trade Organization's (WTO's) Agreement on Textiles and Clothing in 2005 was a game changer. Till then, major importing markets such as the US and Europe had imposed quotas on how much clothing and textiles countries such as India could export, under a system called the Multi-Fibre Arrangement (MFA). "During that time, the rise in manufacturing costs forced developed markets to look at countries like China, Bangladesh and India," says Chandran. That meant that companies that had earlier operated with 100 or 200 machines began investing in capacity, setting up 1,000 machines. "The period after 2005 also witnessed another phase of transformation, led by investments in infra-

structure, technology, modernisation and manufacturing capacity," he adds. TEA also played a crucial role in bringing in fresh investments for worker welfare, including education, health-care, accommodation, dormitories, play schools and other facilities. The industry body is now further improving the accommodation and educational infrastructure facilities, which attracted more foreign majors. According to Subramanian, Tiruppur's advantage is its distributed production model, which evolved as a chain of interconnected activities. This ranges from cotton and yarn manufacturing to knitting, processing, embroidery, printing, sewing, accessories and packing. Only 20 per cent of units have vertically integrated operations; nearly 80 per cent are MSMEs that specialise in individual activities and share the business across the cluster. The model helped Tiruppur build scale without requiring every company to invest in the entire manufacturing chain. That is the reason why Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal said the country wants to create 75 textile hubs like Tiruppur which will not only support textile product exports and ensure inclusion of sustainable technology, but will also generate huge opportunities for employment. In his Independence Day speech last month, Prime Minister Narendra Modi too specified that the country's textile sector, spread from Ludhiana in Punjab to Tiruppur, has the potential to reach global markets. "Tiruppur's unique strength is its deeply connected textile ecosystem, where almost everything from raw material to finished garments is available within a short radius. This gives Tiruppur the speed, flexibility, quality and consistency to serve global brands," says Prabhu Dhamodaran, convenor and secretary of the Indian Textpreneurs Federation (ITF).

Resilient looms The city had its share of roadblocks too, ranging from environmental concerns in the early 2010s to Covid-19 and even geopolitical headwinds. Following a court order directing dyeing and bleaching units to achieve Zero Liquid Discharge (ZLD) and stop discharging effluent into the Noyyal, several units were shut down briefly in 2011, affecting exports. An industry source said around 729 factories were shut at that time. However, Tiruppur adapted quickly. Now, around 130 million litres of water a day is being recycled and reused, and the majority of the industry has shifted to renewable energy too. Chandran of CITI says the pandemic also resulted in consolidation, with smaller operators increasingly giving way to larger companies. Before Covid, there were small operators with 200-300 machines and an annual turnover of around ₹15 crore, which are fading away fast now, he says. The region is also facing tough competition from states like Odisha, from where it used to source a large share of manpower before, as it looks to ramp up its own textile production chain. That has meant that unlike before when labourers would come to Tiruppur in search of work, factories in the city are now having to go in search of workers. Even so, the TEA has set an ambitious exports target of ₹1 trillion by 2030, and is aiming for domestic business of ₹50,000 crore by then, says Subramanian. More importantly, it is gradually focusing more on man-made fibres (MMF), compared to its stronghold of cotton. Despite all its challenges, with FTAs expected to take centre stage, exporters see a boom ahead for Tiruppur.



PUBLIC NOTICE
B L LIFESCIENCES PRIVATE LIMITED
A-245, Okhla Phase-I, New Delhi – 110020
This is to inform all concerned that a fire incident occurred at the office premises of B L Lifesciences Private Limited situated at A-245, Okhla Phase-I, New Delhi, on **03 August 2026 at around 5:15 PM.**
The fire was caught in the record room on the third floor of the building, resulting in damage to certain furniture items, office records, Promotional Material and digital records kept in the said record room.
If any person, institution, authority, customer, supplier or other stakeholder has any concern, information, documents or records relating to the affected records, they are requested to kindly contact the undersigned within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice.
For any information or clarification, please contact:
Mobile No. : 8800412795
Date: 15th September 2026
Place: New Delhi
For B L LIFESCIENCES PRIVATE LIMITED
Authorised Signatory
A-245, Okhla Phase-I, New Delhi – 110020

NOTICE
BEFORE THE NATIONAL COMPANY LAW TRIBUNAL, CHANDIGARH BENCH, CHANDIGARH, COURT-II
IN THE MATTER OF:
ADANI INFRASTRUCTURE AND DEVELOPERS PVT. LTD.
M/S. RISHALI DEVELOPERS LLP (CORPORATE DEBTOR)
CP (IB) No.172/Chd/Hry/2026
A petition numbered CP (IB) No.172/Chd/Hry/2026 has been filed under Section 7 of the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016 against **M/s. Rishali Developers LLP (Corporate Debtor) by Adani Infrastructure And Developers Pvt. Ltd. (Financial Creditor)** before the National Company Law Tribunal, Chandigarh Bench. In light of the aforesaid petition notice was issued by the Adjudicating Authority by way of an order dated 04 August 2026, wherein the respondent was instructed to file their reply within a period of two weeks. The said Petition was taken up by the Hon'ble Chandigarh Bench, NCLT on 25 August 2026 for hearing, wherein none appeared for/represented the Corporate Debtor. Consequently, liberty was sought by the Financial Creditor from Hon'ble Tribunal to effectuate the service through alternative means i.e., issuance of Public Notice. Accordingly, vide this Notice it is being intimated to the Corporate Debtor and its Officials, including its Designated Partners, and any other person connected therewith, that the said Petition is now fixed for hearing before the Chandigarh Bench of the National Company Law Tribunal, Court II, on 30 September 2026. The Corporate Debtor is called upon to appear before the Hon'ble Tribunal on the said date, either in person or through an authorised representative or advocate, and to file its reply, if any, failing which the Petition is liable to be heard and disposed of ex parte.

S.no	Name of Respondent/ Corporate Debtor	LPIN	ADDRESS
1.	RISHALI DEVELOPERS LLP	AAS - 3899	329/1 Village Baighera Near Gurugram Gramin Bank, Gurgoan, Haryana, India, 122017

For: Adani Infrastructure and Developers Private Limited
Through Counsel: Adv. Amitabh Tewari
H No. 3038, Sec 21-D, Chandigarh 160022
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M: +91-9814016469

— TENDER CARE —

— Advertorial

CIL CHAIRMAN REVIEWS MINING OPERATIONS AT ECL'S RAJMAHAL AREA
Shri. B. Sairam, Chairman, Coal India Limited (CIL), visited the Rajmahal Area of Eastern Coalfields Limited (ECL) to review mining operations and assess the progress of key operational activities. The Chairman was received by Shri Satish Jha, CMD, ECL; Shri Chitrnanjan Kumar, Director (Technical/ Operations), ECL; and Shri Arupa Nanda Nayak, General Manager, Rajmahal Area, along with other senior officials of ECL. During the visit, the Chairman undertook a field visit to Rajmahal Open Cast Project (OCP) and Hurra 'C' OCP, where he reviewed ongoing mining operations and took stock of operational performance and activities at the projects. The visit focused on strengthening operational efficiency, safety, productivity and sustainable mining practices, with particular emphasis on maintaining sustained coal production and addressing operational challenges at the field level. As part of the visit, the Chairman also participated in a plantation programme at Urjanagar, reaffirming CIL and ECL's commitment towards environmental sustainability, ecological conservation and responsible mining.

UNIT-II (660 MW) OF SJVN'S BUXAR THERMAL POWER PROJECT SUCCESSFULLY ACHIEVES COMMERCIAL OPERATION
Sh. Bhupender Gupta, Chairman & Managing Director, SJVN, informed that SJVN has successfully achieved Commercial Operation Date (COD) of Unit-II (660 MW) of 1320 MW Buxar Thermal Power Project on 12.09.2026. Sh. Bhupender Gupta expressed gratitude to Central and State Governments, Ministry of Power and other key Ministries and Departments for their constant guidance and support. He also appreciated collective commitment, dedication and perseverance of SJVN employees and all stakeholders who have directly or indirectly contributed to achievement of this significant milestone. On this occasion, Sh. Ajay Kumar Sharma, Director (Personnel), Sh. Parthajit De, Director (Finance) and Sh. Rajesh Kumar Chandel, Director (Projects) congratulated all employees and associated stakeholders on this historic achievement.

BANK OF BARODA LAUNCHES BOB WORLD 2.0 – POWERED BY AI ITS NEXT-GENERATION MOBILE BANKING PLATFORM
Bank of Baroda, one of India's leading public sector banks, announced the launch of bob World 2.0, its next-generation mobile banking application. The app was demonstrated to Shri Sanjay Lohiya, Secretary, Department of Financial Services (DFS), Ministry of Finance, Govt of India along with Dr. Debaddatta Chand, Managing Director & CEO, Bank of Baroda and Executive Directors of the Bank at the Global Fintech Fest (GFF) 2026 in Mumbai on 11th September 2026. Speaking on the launch, Dr. Debaddatta Chand, Managing Director & CEO, Bank of Baroda said, "As banking becomes increasingly digital, customers expect experiences that are intuitive, intelligent, secure and highly personalised. With bob World 2.0, we have reimaged mobile banking around our customers' needs, combining financial wellness tools, voice-enabled AI-driven engagement and personalised customer experiences on a single platform. As a forward-looking, customer-centric institution, we remain committed to continuously innovating and building a future-ready digital banking ecosystem that will continue to evolve with the changing needs and expectations of our customers."

CENTRAL BANK OF INDIA BECOMES FIRST PSU BANK TO LAUNCH 'BHARAT CONNECT FOR BUSINESS'
Central Bank of India has become the first Public Sector Bank to launch 'Bharat Connect for Business', in partnership with NPCI Bharat BillPay Ltd. (NBPL), marking a significant step towards strengthening India's digital B2B payments ecosystem. The platform provides an integrated digital ecosystem for businesses to generate invoices, make and receive payments, manage collections and settlements, enabling secure, seamless and efficient transactions between buyers, sellers and their banks. The initiative was launched at the NPCI Pavilion at Global Fintech Fest 2026 in the presence of Kalyan Kumar, MD & CEO, Central Bank of India, and Noopur Chaturvedi, MD & CEO, NBPL.

BoI, AHMEDABAD ZONE, ORGANISES VIGILANCE AWARENESS PROGRAMMES IN RURAL AND SEMI-URBAN AREAS
As part of the ongoing Vigilance Awareness Campaign 2026, Bank of India, Ahmedabad Zone, has been organising a series of awareness programmes at Gram Panchayats and schools across the rural and semi-urban areas of Kheda and Ahmedabad districts. The programmes are being conducted by the rural and semi-urban branches of Ahmedabad Zone under the leadership of Zonal Manager, Shri Subrata Behera, in coordination with the Vigilance Department of the Zone. The participants were also encouraged to remain vigilant and immediately report any suspicious banking or cyber-related activity through appropriate channels. Integrity Pledge was administered to the participants, reinforcing the importance of honesty, probity and ethical conduct in public and professional life.

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E-mail : corporate@hbleasing.com, Website : www.hbleasing.com
Special Window for Re-lodgement of transfer requests of physical Shares
Pursuant to SEBI Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)/2026-MIRSD-POD//I3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026, shareholders of **HB Leasing & Finance Company Limited** (the Company) are hereby informed that special window has been opened from **February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027** for re-lodgement requests for the transfer of shares and is specially applicable to cases which were lodged prior to deadline of April 01, 2019. The original share transfer requests which were rejected/returned/not attended due to deficiencies in documentation or were not processed due to any other reason. Eligible shareholders may submit their transfer request along with the requisite documents to the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent (RTA) at **RCMC Share Registry Private Limited** at their office address at B-25/1, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase 2, New Delhi, India, 110020, Tel: 011-26387321 or send an email at investor.services@rcmcdelhi.com within stipulated period. If all the documents are found to be in order by the Company/RTA, the share transfer shall be processed only in dematerialized form and shall be under lock in for a period of 1 (one) year from the date of registration by the Company / RTA and shall not be transferred /marked/ pledged during the said lock-in-period. Accordingly, the transferee(s) must have a demat account and provide a copy of their Client Master List (CML), along with the requisite documents, at the time of lodging the transfer request with the Company/RTA. For HB Leasing & Finance Company Limited
Sd/-
Shahbaz Khan
(Company Secretary)
Membership No. A75337
Date : September 14, 2026
Place : Gurugram

Hinduja Housing Finance Ltd.
Corporate Office: No. 167-168, 2nd Floor, Anna Salai, Saidapet, Chennai - 600015, Tamil Nadu, India, Branch office: F8, Mahalaxmi Metro Tower, Sector-4, Vaishali Ghaziabad -201010
Contact details: ZCM: Pawan Yadav (97119 92427) | ACM: Sushant Talwar (88826 67796)
ALM: Arun Mohan Sharma 880898999
Email: Auction@hindujahousingfinance.com
NOTICE OF SALE THROUGH PRIVATE TREATY
SALE OF MOVABLE & IMMOVABLE ASSETS CHARGED TO HHFL UNDER THE SARFAESI ACT, 2002.
The undersigned, as Authorized Officer of HHFL, has taken possession of the schedule property under Section 13(4) of the SARFAESI Act. Public at large is hereby informed that the secured property described in the Schedule is available for sale through Private Treaty, on terms agreeable to HHFL, for realization of its dues on an "AS IS WHERE IS" and "AS IS WHAT IS" basis. **Standard Terms & Conditions :** 1. Sale will be conducted strictly on "AS IS WHERE IS" and "AS IS WHAT IS" basis. 2. Purchaser must deposit 10% of the offered amount along with the application and KYC documents. This will be adjusted against the 25% deposit required upon acceptance. 3. On acceptance of the offer by HHFL, purchaser must deposit 25% of the sale consideration (inclusive of the initial 10%) on the next working day. 4. Balance 75% of the sale consideration must be paid within 15 days thereafter. 5. Failure to remit amounts within stipulated timelines will result in forfeiture of all deposits made, including the initial 10%. 6. If HHFL does not accept the offer, the initial 10% deposit will be refunded without interest. 7. The property is sold with all existing and future encumbrances, whether known or unknown to HHFL. HHFL shall not be responsible for any third party claims, rights, or dues. 8. Purchaser must conduct independent due diligence on all aspects of the property. No claims will be entertained later. 9. HHFL reserves the right to reject any offer without assigning reasons. 10. Auction/bidding shall only be through "online electronic mode" through the website www.bankauctions.com Or Auction provided by the service provider M/s C1 India Pvt. Ltd., 11. The bidders may participate from their place of choice through online portal. Secured Creditor/service provider shall not be held responsible for the any connectivity issue. 12. For any details on e-auction prospective bidders may contact the Service Provider M/s C1 India Pvt. Ltd., having its corporate office at Plot No. 68, 3rd Floor, Sector -44, Gurgaon, Haryana-122003 (Contact Person Mr. Mitlesh, Mobile No.7080804466, Email: ln@c1india.com, Prabhashan.Malancham@C1india.com & Support (Helpline) Mobile No. +91-7291981124/25/26, Support Email – Support@bankauction.com. 13. For participating in the e-auction sale the intending bidders should register their name at <https://www.bankauctions.com> well in advance and shall get the user id and password. Intending bidders are advised to change only the password immediately upon receiving it from the service provider. 14. For participating in e-auction, intending bidders have to deposit a refundable Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) i.e. 10% OF RESERVE PRICE (as mentioned above) shall be payable by interested bidders through Demand Draft/NEFT/RTGS in favour of "Hinduja Housing Finance Limited". 15. Interested parties may contact the Authorized Officer for details and submit Offer, EMD along with KYC documents on or before **29.09.2026 at 5.00 p.m.** 16. Purchaser shall bear all stamp duty, registration fees, taxes, and other statutory expenses related to the purchase. 17. Sale shall be conducted in accordance with the provisions of the SARFAESI Act and Rules.
SCHEDULE
Description of the Property (Secured Asset): Plot No. 1/32 area measuring 60 Sq. Yds., out of Khirna No. 803, Situated at V.I.P Homes-2 Village Roja Jalapur Pargana and Tehsil Dadri, Distt. Gautam Budh Nagar. POSITION: NORTH: Plot of Other SOUTH: Entry of Property/18 ft wide Road EAST: Property of Other WEST: Plot of Other
Reserve Price: Rs. 15,00,000/- (Rupees Fifteen Lakh Only) **EMD:** Rs. 1,50,000/-
LOAN NO: DL/SH/SLH/WA/00000872
Borrowers Name: 1. Ms. SEEMA BISWAS, 2. Mrs. AMAN BISWAS
EMD Deposition Last Date: 29.09.2026 till 1700 hrs
Date/Time of E-Auction: 30.09.2026, 1100hrs-1300 hrs. **Bid Increase Amount:** Rs. 10,000/-
Date: 15-09-2026, Place: Ghaziabad Authorised Officer, For Hinduja Housing Finance Limited

Evergreen notes: A new Asha Bhosle song and the return of lost voices

How ‘mortality bump’, a spike in music consumption after an artiste’s death, plays out in digital world

PRATIKSHA PRIYA
New Delhi, 14 September

A new song by Asha Bhosle was released on September 8, her 93rd birth anniversary, nearly five months after her death on April 12. The song, *Ae meri zindagi, tu chhup hai kahan*, her last as a play-back singer, will feature in the upcoming drama-comedy, *Om Ka Hari*, directed by Harish Vyas.

It is an unusual kind of return, but then music has always had a way of outliving the people who make it.

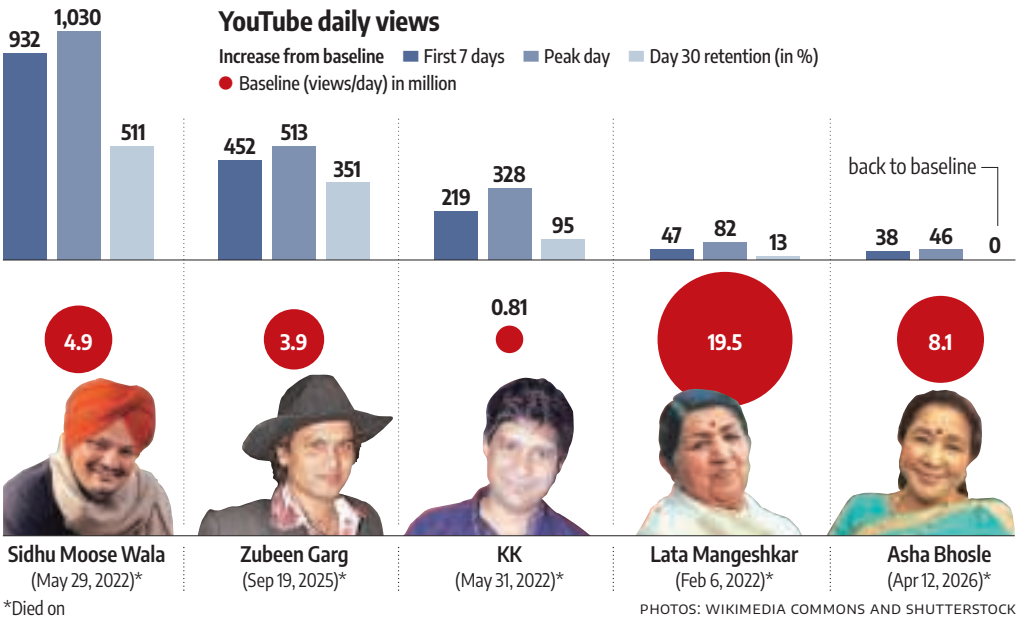
Something similar happened when news of Suman Kalyanpur’s passing broke on May 31. Many younger listeners did not encounter it through obituaries or television tributes. They found her through songs suddenly reappearing on Instagram reels, posts, playlist recommendations and nostalgic clips shared across social media. For many, it was the first introduction to the voice behind classics like *Na tum humein jaano* and *Aaj kal tere mere pyar ke charche*. Suman Kalyanpur had recorded more than 850 songs across Hindi, Marathi, Gujarati and other languages, but had slipped out of everyday digital listening habits.

In recent years, the deaths of singers across generations, such as Lata Mangeshkar, KK, Sidhu Moose Wala and Zubeen Garg, have repeatedly brought their songs back into public conversation.

This renewed listening can create what researchers describe as a “mortality bump” — a spike in music consumption following an artiste’s death.

However, the afterlife of music is not the same for every artiste. While some see a brief spike in attention before returning to the familiar listening patterns, others continue attracting new audiences months, or even years, after their passing. The difference lies not just in the size of the surge, but also in how long it lasts.

The digital afterlife



		Increase from baseline (in %)					
Artist	Baseline (in mn)	First 7 days	30-day peak	Day 30	Day 90	Day 180	
Zubeen Garg	2.0	49	170	169	90	69	
Sidhu Moose Wala	2.9	58	148	147	124	156	
KK	7.3	29	45	45	27	56	
Lata Mangeshkar	4.1	14	28	25	18	44	
Asha Bhosle	16.6	14	15	10	NA	NA	

For instance, according to music analytics platform Chartmetric, daily YouTube views of Asha Bhosle’s catalogue jumped 46 per cent within a week of her passing. The surge itself was hardly unusual. What happened next, however, was less expected.

By Day 30, the daily YouTube views returned to their pre-death baseline, suggesting that the renewed attention faded almost as quickly as it arrived.

A return to baseline, however, does not necessarily mean a loss of cultural relevance. Harshit Bansal, founder of Humans of Cinema, a platform dedicated to film discourse and cinema for change, says Asha Bhosle’s underlying audience remains a reflection of her enduring place in Indian music.

“Even if her music saw a sudden spike and return to baseline, that baseline itself will always remain quite high because of how important her music has been for this country,” he says.

While Asha Bhosle’s catalogue returned to pre-death levels within a month, every other artiste analysed by Chartmetric continued to record daily YouTube views above their pre-death baselines. Sidhu Moose Wala and Zubeen Garg experienced the most dramatic surges, with views rising by triple digits within the first week and remaining substantially elevated even after a month. KK, too, witnessed a triple-digit spike in the days following his death, while Lata

Mangeshkar’s catalogue also sustained listening well beyond the initial wave of public mourning. The data suggests that while post-humous spikes are common, the longevity of renewed attention varies sharply from artiste to artiste.

Bansal says Sidhu Moose Wala’s enduring resurgence reflects the emotional connection listeners had with him and the circumstances of his death. “It was unfortunate and tragic, and he was someone people connected with, both because of his humble beginnings and the rebellion in his music,” he says.

If YouTube captures the immediate public response to an artiste’s death, Spotify offers a longer view. Rather than measuring day-to-day spikes, its monthly listener data shows whether audiences continue returning to an artiste’s music long after the headlines fade. In other words, it asks a different question: Once the news cycle moves on, who actually stays?

For Asha Bhosle, Lata Mangeshkar and KK, the trajectory was gradual. Although all three recorded significant increases in monthly listeners during the weeks following their deaths, their audiences steadily moved closer to pre-death levels over the following months. The resurgence was visible, but not with the same persistence seen in the catalogues of Sidhu Moose Wala and Zubeen Garg.

Taken together, the data suggests that posthumous listening in the streaming era is far more complex than a single burst of nostalgia. Some catalogues quickly returned to familiar listening patterns, while others continued attracting audiences months later.

The difference is not simply in how sharply an artiste’s music resurges after death, but in whether that resurgence can turn into lasting discovery.

That said, “some art is beyond the social media numbers,” Bansal says. “The internet favours trends over quality, and trends keep changing.”

Ministry issues notice to A-I after 3 foreigners bypass immigration

DEEPAK PATEL
New Delhi, September 14

The Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA) has issued a show-cause notice to Air India after three Italian nationals travelled from Amritsar to Delhi on an Air India flight and subsequently departed for Munich without obtaining mandatory departure immigration clearance.

According to the notice dated September 12, the three passengers arrived at Indira Gandhi International Airport, Delhi, at 0050 hours on September 4 on Air India flight AI-1115 from Amritsar. They subsequently travelled onward to Munich on Lufthansa flight LH-763 at 0145 hours the same day. Air India and Lufthansa have a codeshare partnership, under which passengers can book connecting journeys across the two airlines on a single itinerary. Air India and Lufthansa have had a codeshare relationship since 2004, with the partnership expanded in February 2025.

The MoCA — in its September 12 notice — said the incident repre-

sented a “serious security and immigration-related lapse” during the operation of Air India’s “Hub&Spoke” service. The passengers were able to leave India without completing the mandatory departure immigration process. The notice has been issued over an alleged violation of the Standard Operating Procedure for Hub&Spoke operations. The MoCA has sought an explanation from Air India over how the passengers were permitted to proceed from their domestic arrival at Delhi to an international departure without the required immigration clearance.

Delhi airport operator Delhi International Airport Limited (DIAL) said it had not received any show-cause notice in connection with the matter.

“Security at IGIA is managed under a multi-agency framework. DIAL, as the airport operator, remains fully committed to supporting all security and government agencies and complying with all laid-down protocols,” a DIAL spokesperson said. Air India did not issue any statement on the matter.

Google selects four Indian startups for AI programme

UDISHA SRIVASTAV
New Delhi, 14 September

Tech giant Google announced on Monday that it has selected four Indian startups for its inaugural Google DeepMind Accelerator: AI for the Planet programme.

The four startups — Terrastack, Varaha Climate, Farmers for Forests and Climitra Carbon — are joining the cohort of 16 organisations across the Asia Pacific. These homegrown startups are applying artificial intelligence (AI), satellite intelligence, remote sensing and drones to face challenges ranging from sustainable agriculture and agroforestry to carbon removal and biodiversity. Over the next three months, they will receive access to the latest Google AI stack, technical support, and expert mentorship to scale up their critical solutions for a sustainable future.

Among the selected startups, Terrastack combines satellite and agronomic data to provide plot-level land intelligence for smallholder farmers. The company is part of the programme’s sustainable agriculture track, using data and AI to make agricultural decision-making more precise and accessible.

Varaha Climate empowers small farmers to earn carbon credits by verifying regenerative agriculture and carbon removal using remote sensing and AI. Its work is part of the programme’s focus on scaling up climate and carbon solutions. Farmers for Forests is using AI-powered drones to turn smallholder agroforestry into measurable carbon and biodiversity action, and Climitra Carbon is deploying Geo-AI to verify the removal of invasive species and their conversion into biochar, linking land restoration with scalable carbon solutions.

HB STOCKHOLDINGS LIMITED
CIN: L65929HR1985PLC033936
Registered Office : Plot No. 31, Echelon Institutional Area, Sector 32, Gurugram-122001, Haryana
Ph. : + 91-124-4675500, Fax No. : + 91-124-4370985
E-mail : corporate@hbstockholdings.com, Website : www.hbstockholdings.com

Special Window for Re-lodgement of transfer requests of physical Shares

Pursuant to SEBI Circular No. HO/38/13/11(2)/2026-MIRSD-POD//I3750/2026 dated January 30, 2026, shareholders of **HB Stockholdings Limited** (the Company) are hereby informed that special window has been opened from **February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027** for re-lodgement requests for the transfer of shares and is specially applicable to cases which were lodged prior to deadline of April 01, 2019. The original share transfer requests which were rejected/returned/not attended due to deficiencies in documentation or were not processed due to any other reason.

Eligible shareholders may submit their transfer request along with the requisite documents to the Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent (RTA) at **RCMC Share Registry Private Limited** at their office address at B-25/1, Okhla Industrial Area, Phase 2, New Delhi, India, 110020, Tel: 011-35020445.66 or send an email at **investor.services@rcmcdelhi.com** within stipulated period.

If all the documents are found to be in order by the Company/RTA, the share transfer shall be processed only in dematerialized form and shall be under lock in for a period of 1 (one) year from the date of registration by the Company / RTA and shall not be transferred /marked/ pledged during the said lock-in-period. Accordingly, the transferee(s) must have a demat account and provide a copy of their Client Master List (CML), along with the requisite documents, at the time of lodging the transfer request with the Company/RTA.

For HB Stockholdings Limited

Sd/-
Pooja Jain
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Membership No. F11719

Date : September 14, 2026
Place : Gurugram

Company Secretary and Compliance Officer
Membership No. F11719

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
Invitation of Tenders through E-Procurement system.

Principal Chief Materials Manager, Northern Railway, New Delhi-110001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites e-tenders through e-procurement system for supply of the following items:-

S. No.	Tender No.	Brief Description	Qty.	Closing Date
01	06261135	MS FLAT SIZE 40X6 MM	93982 KGS	05.10.26
02	01261725A	CONTACT WIRE PARALLEL CLAMP (SMALL) (1041-2) COMPLETE ASSEMBLY	30087 SET	05.10.26
03	77269002	THICK WEB SWITCH T9842	400 SET	06.10.26
04	77265116	M.S. FITTINGS FOR THICK WEB SWITCH T-6155	240 MT	07.10.26
05	06265036	RHS-40X80X4MM	120000 KGS	08.10.26
06	15265093	MANUFACTURING AND SUPPLY OF COMPLETE INSPECTION	480 SET	13.10.26
07	77269097	RUNNING CONTRACT FOR HVN CUT LINER (T-10236 & T-10237)	40000 PAIR	13.10.26
08	07263446	AXLE BOX PIVOT BUSH WITH SOLID OR HOLLOW PIN CONSTRUCTION	11751 NOS	03.11.26
09	07261145	NON ASBESTOS K- TYPE HIGH FRICTION COMPOSITE BRAKE	69645 NOS	10.11.26

Note:1). Vendors may visit the IREPS website i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for details. 2. No Manual offer will be entertained.
Tender Notice No. 41/2026-2027 Dated: 10/09/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3165/26

J&K Bank
Serving To Empower

Jammu & Kashmir Bank Limited
Human Resources- Trainings,
Corporate Headquarters,
M. A. Road Srinagar, 190 001 J&K

Online Request for Proposal (RFP) for Group Term Life Insurance Cover to Employees of J&K Bank

RFP Notice along with Complete RFP document outlining the minimum requirements can be downloaded from and BIDs can be submitted on the Banks' e-Tendering Portal <https://jkbank.abcpocure.com> w.e.f. September 15, 2026, 16.00 Hrs. Tender Document can also be downloaded from Bank's Official Website <https://jkb.bank.in/tenderNotice>. Last date for submission of Bids is September 28, 2026, 17.00 Hrs. **e-RFP No. JKB/CHQ/HR/GTLI-Emp-JKB/2026-1895 Dated: 11-09-2026**

Registered office : Corporate Headquarters, M.A.Road, Srinagar 190001, Kashmir, India
CIN: L65110JK19385GCO00048 ; **T : +91 (0)194 2481 930-35 ; F : +91 (0)194 248 1928;**
DIPK-NB-1642/26
Sent Date: 14-09-2026 **E info:** info@jkbmail.com ; **W :** <https://jkb.bank.in>

गार्डन रीच शिपबिल्डर्स एण्ड इंजीनियर्स लिमिटेड
Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers Limited
(एनएसएससी का उद्योग / A Govt. of India Undertaking), राय चक्रवर्ती / Ministry of Defence
Regd and Corp Office: GRSE BHAVAN, 61, Garden Reach Road, Kolkata - 700 024
Web: www.grse.in, (CIN: L35111WB1934G0007891)

Tender No. PUR/MB/OT/CCTV/C-1274/2026/01/RA-3517

Offers are invited through Open e-Tender in two-part bid system with reverse auction from reputed Manufacturers/Authorized dealers for Comprehensive AMC and Upgradation of CCTV surveillance system across 05 Units of GRSE.

For details of Tender Documents and further Corrigendum/any amendment, bidders are requested to visit the GRSE e-Procurement portal <https://eprocure.grse.co.in> and GRSE website www.grse.in & <http://eprocure.gov.in/cppp>. Due date for submission of offer shall be within 21 days of publication of this tender Notice.

"In Pursuit of Excellence and Quality in Shipbuilding"

IDBI BANK

Hall No. H-2, Gr Floor, Padamdeep Tower G-10/8, Sanjay Place Agra-282002 Ultra Pradesh

POSSESSION NOTICE (For Immovable Property under Rule 8(1))

Notice is hereby given under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets & Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 of 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13 (12) read with Rule-3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The Bank Issued demand notice to the following borrower/Co-borrower/ Guarantor/Mortgagor on the date mentioned against their name calling upon them to repay the amount within 60 days from the date of receipt of said notice. Since they failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to them and to the public in general that the undersigned has taken the possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him under section 13 (4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said Rules on the dates mentioned against the name of the borrower. The borrower/Co-borrower/Guarantor/Mortgagor, in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealing with the property will be subject to the charge of IDBI Bank Limited for the amount given against their names with future interest charges thereon.

No.	Name of the Borrowers/ Guarantors	Description of Immovable Property	Date of Demand Notice	Date of Possession Notice	Outstanding Amount
1.	Branch: Sanjay Place Neena Agarwal, Yashu Goyal	All that piece and parcel of land comprised in and forming part of above mentioned details which is Flat No 602 on 6th floor in block no G-13 A/8, area 121.70 Sq. Mts at Narian Tower, Sanjay Place Commercial Complex, Tehsil & Distt Agra in state of Uttar Pradesh. Bounded as follows On the North: Open To Sky, On the South: 7'0" wide Common Corridor, On the East: Residential Unit No Flat No 604 Sixth Floor, On the West: Open To Sky.	01.07.2026	10.09.2026	Rs. 25,60,624.72 and interest thereon net after if any
2.	Branch: Sanjay Palace M/s Rakesh Radio (Prop Neena Agarwal) Neena Agarwal, Yashu Goyal, Radika Goyal.	1. All that piece and parcel of shop comprised in and forming part of above mentioned details which is unit no B-4 basement shop Agra Nagar Nigam No 4/SE-13/6/B1 situated at Raman Tower Block no E 13/6 Sanjay Palace Haripurawat Ward Tehsil & District Agra in the State of Uttar Pradesh with covered area of 48.29 square meter and which is bounded as follows: On the North: Unit No 2 Basement, On the South: Unit No 6 Basement, On the East: Gallery Basement, On the West: Parking thereafter land below footpath. together with all and singular the structures and erections thereon, both present and future. 2. All that piece and parcel of shop comprised in and forming part of above mentioned details which is unit no B-1 Basement shop Agra Nagar Nigam No 4/SE-13/6/B1 situated at Raman Tower Block no E 13/6 Sanjay Palace Haripurawat Ward Tehsil & District Agra in the State of Uttar Pradesh with covered area of 48.29 square meter and which is bounded as follows: On the North: Shop No 3 Basement, On the South: Shop No 9 Basement, On the East: Footpath and Road, On the West: Corridor at Basement.	30.06.2026	10.09.2026	Rs. 2,61,07,700.55 and interest thereon net after if any

Date - 14.09.2026

Place - Agra

Authorized Officer, IDBI Bank

HDFC BANK
We understand your world

Head Office: HDFC Bank House, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai - 400 013
Regional Office: HDFC Bank Ltd., Dept For Special Operations, Ground Floor, Gulab Bhawan 6,Bhaur Shah Zafar Marg ITO, New Delhi 110002

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE PUBLIC NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE & MOVABLE PROPERTY

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable properties mortgaged to Bank under Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rule, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s)/Mortgagor(s)/Guarantor(s) that, the Authorized Officer(s) of HDFC BANK LTD. had taken physical possession of the following property/ies pursuant to demand raised vide notice(s) issued under Sec 13(2) of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 in the following loan accounts with right to sell the same on "AS IS WHERE IS, AS IS WHAT IS, WHATEVER IS THERE IS AND WITHOUT RECOURSE BASIS" for realization of Bank's dues plus interest as detailed hereunder and whereas consequent upon failure to repay the dues, the undersigned in exercise of power conferred under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said Rules proposes to realize the Bank's dues by sale of the said property/ies. The sale of the below-mentioned Properties shall be conducted by way of E-Auction through Web Portal: <https://www.bankauctions.com>

DESCRIPTION OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES/DETAILS OF ACCOUNT/AMOUNT/EMD/ETC

Name of the Branch & Account	Name of the Mortgagor & Guarantors of the property	Details of property		Inspection Date and Time:	Amount as per Demand Notice Demand Notice Date
			Reserve Price EMD Bid Increase Amount		
HDFC Bank Ltd, Delhi M/s Kuber Polychem Private Limited	(Director/ Guarantor/ Mortgagor): Mr. Sandeep Gupta and Mrs. Anju Gupta	Item No. 1 Property No. Free hold residential property being Entire Ground Floor (without roof/terrace right), Property No. 86, admeasuring 186.66 Sq yards, Situated in the layout plan of National Defence Worker's Co-Operative House Building Society Limited, Shakti Vihar, Pitampura, New Delhi-110034	Rs. 2,90,00,000/- Rs.29,00,000/- Rs. 1,00,000/-	12.10.2026 11.30 AM to 12.30 P.M	Rs.5,85,76,522.47 Date of Demand Notice: 10-10-2025 Dues as on 10.10.2025 with further interest along with the costs and expenses till the date of full and final payment under the Loan account
		Item No.2. Property No. Freehold commercial property being Unit No. 508-509, 5th Floor, Krishna Apra Business Square, Plot No. D-4, 5 and 6, Wazirpur District Centre, Netaji Subhash Place, Pitampura, New Delhi-110034	Rs. 2,01,00,000.00/- Rs. 20,10,000.00/- Rs. 1,00,000/-	12.10.2026 01.00 PM to 02.00 P.M	

Name of Authorised Officer/Phone No./Email Id :
Mr. Somnath Pandey, Mobile: 9310110525, somnath.pandey1@HDFC.BANK.IN

Date / Time of e-Auction : 16.10.2026, 10.30 AM to 11.30 AM
Last Date for Receipt of Bids: 14.10.2026 Up to 4.00 PM

TERMS & CONDITIONS:
1. The e-Auction is being held on "AS IS WHERE IS, AS IS WHAT IS, WHATEVER IS THERE IS AND WITHOUT RECOURSE BASIS"
2. The interested bidders shall submit their EMD details and documents through Web Portal: <https://hdfcbank.auctiontiger.net> (the user ID & Password can be obtained free of cost by registering name with <https://hdfcbank.auctiontiger.net>) through Login ID & Password. The EMD shall be payable through NEFT / RTGS in the following Account: 57500000904261, Name of the Account: DFSD TRANSITORY ACCOUNT., Name of the Beneficiary: HDFC BANK LTD., IFSC Code: HDFC0000240 or through Demand Draft drawn in favour of HDFC Bank Ltd Account No. 57500000904261 latest by 4.00 PM on or before the dates mentioned in the table above. Please note that the Cheques shall not be accepted as EMD amount.
3. To the best of knowledge and information of the Authorized Officer(s), there is no encumbrance or claims except as disclosed as per Bank's record with respect to the Properties including statutory dues like property taxes, society dues etc, if any and it will be liability of the buyer. The intending bidders should make their own independent inquiries regarding the encumbrances, title of Properties & to inspect & satisfy themselves. Properties can be inspected strictly on the above mentioned date and time.
4. The intended bidders who have deposited the EMD and require assistance in creating Login ID & Password, uploading data, submitting bid, training on e-bidding process etc., may contact our service provider M/s. C1 India Pvt. Ltd., Plot No 301, Gulf Petro Chem Building, Udyog Vihar, Phase 2, Gurgaon, Helpline No's: 0124-4302020/21/22/23/24, Mr Mitlesh Kumar Mobile: 7080804466, Help Line e-mail ID: support@bankauctions.com and for any property related query may contact the Authorized officer as mentioned above in office hours during the working days. (10:00AM to 5:00 PM)
5. The highest bid shall be subject to approval of HDFC Bank Limited. Authorized Officer reserves the right to accept/ reject all or any of the offers/ bids so received without assigning any reasons whatsoever. His decision shall be final & binding.
6. The prospective bidder should take cognizance of all the litigation with respect to the property in auction including Securitization Application, if any filed before Debt Recovery Tribunal. He should inquire all the case with respect to the property in auction, independently and take cognizance of it prior to submission of bid.
Note:- Although there is a pending litigation with regard to the said property viz M/s Kuber Polychem Private Limited Vs HDFC Bank Limited (SA No. 260 of 2026 before DRT-I, Delhi) is pending before DRT-I, Delhi for adjudication with regard to the said properties, there is no order staying/precluding HDFC Bank Limited.
7. (FOR DETAILED TERM AND CONDITIONS PLEASE REFER TO OUR WEBSITE www.hdfcbank.com and www.bankauctions.com)

Date: 15.09.2026, Place: Delhi

Authorised Officer, HDFC Bank Ltd.

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